

The Fab 4 Take on Europe

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10 - 29 September 2026

✈ Flights

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Karen Nicholson · Deb Gyde · Thomas Akhurst · Gary
Nicholson

Flight Summary

Date	Flight	Terminal	Airline	Route	Depart → Arrive	Cabin	Duration
Thu 10 Sept	QF162	T1 → T1	Qantas	Wellington (WLG) → Sydney (SYD)	6:05am → 7:45am	Business	3h 40m
Thu 10 Sept	QF1	T1 → T1	Qantas	Sydney (SYD) → Singapore (SIN)	2:45pm → 9:15pm	Premium Economy	8h 30m
Thu 10 - Fri 11 Sept	BA12	T1 → T5	British Airways	Singapore (SIN) → London Heathrow (LHR)	11:20/11:25pm → 6:35am +1	Premium Economy	~14h 10-15m
Fri 11 Sept	BA548	T5 → T3	British Airways	London Heathrow (LHR) → Rome Fiumicino (FCO)	8:00am → 11:35am	Business	2h 35m
Fri 11 Sept	BA548	T5 → T3	British Airways	London Heathrow (LHR) → Rome Fiumicino (FCO)	8:00am → 11:35am	Economy	2h 35m
Thu 24 Sept	BA575	n/a → T5	British Airways	Milan Linate (LIN) → London Heathrow (LHR)	3:55pm → 4:50pm	Business	1h 55m
Sun 27 - Mon 28 Sept	BA15	T5 → T1	British Airways	London Heathrow (LHR) → Singapore (SIN)	10:00pm → 6:40pm +1	Premium Economy	13h 40m
Mon 28 - Tue 29 Sept	BA15	T1 → T1	British Airways	Singapore (SIN) → Sydney (SYD)	8:20pm → 6:05am +1	Premium Economy	7h 45m
Tue 29 Sept	QF161	T1 → n/a	Qantas	Sydney (SYD) → Wellington (WLG)	9:35am → 3:45pm	Economy	3h 10m

☐ Karen & Gary only
 ☐ Deb & Tom only
 ☐ All 4 together

All flights are on 2026 dates, operated by Qantas (QF) and British Airways (BA). Reservation codes: Gary & Karen - KXFECY / EKNMYW; Deb & Tom - UWBGQP / EKH3PP (the Akhursts join the group in Sydney, so have no Wellington-Sydney sector). Frequent flyer numbers, seat assignments and check-in requirements are held in the original Sabre itinerary emails.

Sydney layover (Thu 10 Sept, ~7 hrs): Yes, you can leave the airport. As NZ passport holders, Gary & Karen are automatically granted a Special Category (subclass 444) visa on arrival, so there's no separate visa to arrange. A ~7 hour layover is comfortably above the ~5 hour minimum generally recommended to clear immigration, get into the city and back through security in time (allow ~45 min for immigration on arrival, ~60 min for security before the next departure).

Singapore transit on BA15 (Mon 28 Sept, ~1h 40m): Everyone must deplane at Changi with all carry-on items - there's no option to stay onboard. On one ticket with bags checked through you won't need to clear passport control, but you WILL need to re-clear security before boarding the onward

Sydney sector, as security is at the gate in Singapore. Queues can be long since the whole aircraft transits at once – follow the crew's instruction on what time to be back at the gate.

Trip at a Glance

Thu 10 Sep (Day 1)	Air travel CONFIRMED Gary & Karen: QF162 (Qantas) Wgtn (WLG) to Syd (T1), arrive 7.45am - FAB4: QF1 (Qantas) Syd (T1) to Singapore (T1), depart 2.45pm, PE SIN transit ~2hrs (T1) - BA12 SIN (T1) to LHR (T5) arrive 6.35am, then BA548 LHR (T5) to FCO (T3) depart 8.00am (both British Airways) - Business Gary & Karen / Economy Deb & Tom	✈
Fri 11 Sep (Day 2)	Arrival in Rome	☐☐
Sat 12 Sep (Day 3)	Rome CONFIRMED Vatican Museums & Sistine Chapel Tour (booked, Towns of Italy) Meet 7.30am at Viale Vaticano, Ref 5CJM745M	☐☐
Sun 13 Sep (Day 4)	Rome CONFIRMED Colosseum, Roman Forum & Palatine Hill Tour (booked, Gray Line Rome) Meet 2.15pm at Colle Oppio Park, Booking ID 202645831	☐☐
Mon 14 Sep (Day 5)	Rome CONFIRMED Transfer by Private Minibus to Queen Victoria - 12pm pickup confirmed Civitavecchia Cruise Ship Gate, evening departure	☐☐
Tue 15 Sep (Day 6)	Sea Day CONFIRMED Gala Evening - Red and Gold (formal)	☐☐
Wed 16 Sep (Day 7)	Marseille France CONFIRMED Marseille and the little train (booked)	☐☐
Thu 17 Sep (Day 8)	Villefranche, France CONFIRMED Monaco Old Town & Scenic Drive (booked)	☐☐
Fri 18 Sep (Day 9)	Genoa, Italy CONFIRMED Discover Genoa (booked)	☐☐
Sat 19 Sep (Day 10)	La Spezia (Florence or Pisa) CONFIRMED Easy Pisa (booked) · Gala Evening - Roaring 20s (formal)	☐☐
Sun 20 Sep (Day 11)	Sea Day	☐☐
Mon 21 Sep (Day 12)	Tuscany	☐☐
Tue 22 Sep (Day 13)	Tuscany	☐☐
Wed 23 Sep (Day 14)	Milan	☐☐
Thu 24 Sep (Day 15)	London CONFIRMED Dinner at The Lighterman confirmed (4NJL3Z4M6XN3) BA575 (British Airways) Milan Linate to London Heathrow (T5), Depart 3.55pm arrive 4.50pm, Business, all 4	☐☐
Fri 25 Sep (Day 16)	London CONFIRMED The Mousetrap (confirmed), Dinner at Albert Schloss confirmed	☐☐
Sat 26 Sep (Day 17)	London CONFIRMED Tower / Bridge Tour then Six show and then dinner	☐☐
Sun 27 Sep (Day 18)	Air Travel - Depart LHR (T5) 10.00pm CONFIRMED BA15 (British Airways) London Heathrow (T5) to Singapore (SIN T1), Premium Economy, all 4 NZ Daylight Saving starts here	✈
Mon 28 Sep (Day 19)	Air Travel - Arrive SIN (T1) 6.40pm - Depart 8.20pm CONFIRMED BA15 (British Airways) Singapore (SIN T1) to Sydney (SYD T1), Premium Economy, all 4	✈
Tue 29 Sep (Day 20)	HOME CONFIRMED FAB4 Arrive SYD (T1) 6.05am (Karen and Gary depart SYD (T1) 9.35am on QF161 (Qantas), Economy, arrive WGTN 3.45pm	✈

Rome

11 – 14 September · The Republic Hotel, Via Gaeta 61

'I' buttons link to that place's official Instagram page.

FUN FACTS

Villa Borghese Gardens were laid out from 1605 by Cardinal Scipione Borghese – nephew of Pope Paul V – as one of the first great "gardens of delight" in Europe, built purely for pleasure, art and parties rather than growing food. — [Wikipedia](#)

The Galleria Borghese inside the gardens holds Bernini's Apollo and Daphne, carved when he was just 24, and a marble statue of Napoleon's sister Pauline Bonaparte reclining semi-nude that scandalised Rome when it was unveiled in 1808. — [Galleria Borghese](#)

- | | |
|----------------------|--|
| 11:30 AM | Arrive Fiumicino Airport (FCO Terminal 3) 11.35am - flight BA548 (British Airways) from London Heathrow (T5) |
| 12:00 PM | Transfer by private minibus - airport to The Republic Hotel (~30-45 min drive depending on traffic, ~28 min best case). Confirmed as Private Minibus, pick-up at FCO Terminal 3, Meeting Point Column 3 - driver waits 1h15m after landing. Supplier: Destination Italia (tel +39 06 6228 7900). <div style="display: inline-block; background-color: #28a745; color: white; padding: 2px 5px; margin-top: 5px;">BOOKED</div> <p>Via Gaeta 61, 185 Rome</p> <div style="background-color: black; color: white; padding: 2px 5px; display: inline-block;">///sports.pocket.anchors</div> |
| 12:30 PM | Check in at The Republic Hotel, freshen up <div style="background-color: black; color: white; padding: 2px 5px; display: inline-block; margin-top: 5px;">///sports.pocket.anchors</div> |
| 1:00 PM | Piazza della Repubblica & Fontana delle Naiadi <p>Piazza della Repubblica, Rome - ~5 min walk from hotel</p> <div style="background-color: black; color: white; padding: 2px 5px; display: inline-block; margin-top: 5px;">///mouth.dished.cheaply</div> |
| 1:30 PM | Santa Maria degli Angeli e dei Martiri (built into the ancient Baths of Diocletian, free entry) <p>Piazza della Repubblica, Rome - ~5 min walk from hotel</p> <div style="background-color: black; color: white; padding: 2px 5px; display: inline-block; margin-top: 5px;">///mouth.dished.cheaply</div> |
| 2:00 PM | Free time / coffee near the hotel |
| 2:30 PM | Travel to Villa Borghese Gardens (~20 min by taxi or metro) |
| 3:00 PM - 5pm | Villa Borghese Gardens <p>Villa Borghese, Rome, Italy</p> |

5:00 PM -
6:15pm

Pre-dinner drinks - Terrazza Montemartini (rooftop bar, Palazzo Montemartini)

Visit Website: Palazzo Montemartini

Largo Giovanni Montemartini, Rome - ~10 min walk from hotel

[Website](#)

6:30 PM

Dinner - pick from the suggestions below

Lunch Suggestions (3 ideas near the hotel)

Trattoria Nonna Fortunata [///meal.courtyard.deals](http://meal.courtyard.deals)

Family-run trattoria a couple of minutes from the hotel - honest Roman classics, good value lunch menu

Via Flavia 66 - ~4 min walk

☐ **Check ahead - typically lunch & dinner, closed Sundays**

[Reviews](#)

Mercato Centrale Roma [///duck.exulted.firm](http://duck.exulted.firm)

Gourmet food hall inside Termini station - dozens of stalls (pizza, pasta, fish, gelato) under one roof, easy for a relaxed first lunch after landing

Via Giovanni Giolitti 36 (inside Roma Termini) - ~8 min walk

☐ **Daily 8am-midnight**

[Reviews](#)

Pinsere [///sporting.crashing.fussed](http://sporting.crashing.fussed)

Popular no-frills pinsa (Roman-style pizza) counter - quick, cheap, and very well rated, good for a casual bite

Via Flavia 98 - ~4 min walk

☐ **Mon-Fri 7am-3pm & 5pm-9pm (closed weekends)**

[Reviews](#)

2pm Free Time - Coffee Suggestions

Caffè Trombetta [///snails.herds.planet](http://snails.herds.planet)

Well-regarded local coffee bar near the hotel - good espresso and pastries, easy stop before heading out

Via Marsala 46 - ~5 min walk

☐ Check ahead - typically early morning to early evening, closed Sundays

Caffetteria Casina del Lago [///directly.coarser.feasts](http://directly.coarser.feasts)

Lakeside cafe inside Villa Borghese Gardens, right by the little boating lake - a nice spot for a coffee once you arrive at the park

Viale dell'Aranciera 2, Villa Borghese

☐ Check ahead - typically 9am-7pm, seasonal

Dinner Suggestions (8 ideas, within ~20 min walk of the hotel)

Trimani Il Winebar [///thuds.guarded.slate](http://thuds.guarded.slate)

Rome's original wine bar (est. 1821 as a wine merchant) - simple Roman menu, huge wine list, fair prices

Via Cernaia 37 - ~3 min walk

☐ Mon-Sat 11:30am-3pm & 5:30pm-midnight (closed Sun)

Website

Reviews

☐ Trimani started life in 1821 as a family wine merchant business - it's still run by the same Trimani family six generations later, and was the first place in the world to actually call itself a "Wine Bar".

Rifugio Romano [///decency.dumpy.squeaks](http://decency.dumpy.squeaks)

Cosy trattoria a couple of minutes from Termini - classic Roman pastas, friendly service

Via Volturmo 12 - ~6 min walk

☐ Tue-Sun 12:30pm-11pm (closed Mon)

Website

Reviews

Osteria Quarantaquattro [///mild.inquest.late](http://mild.inquest.late)

Relaxed osteria near Piazza della Repubblica - Roman staples, good value set menus

Via Aureliana 42/44 - ~6 min walk

☐ Check ahead - hours not consistently published

[Website](#)

[Reviews](#)

Pizzeria Ristoro Est! Est!! Est!!! [///between.lemons.ruins](http://between.lemons.ruins)

Rome's oldest pizzeria (since 1905) - thin-crust Roman-style pizza, great old-school atmosphere

Via Genova 32 - ~8 min walk

☐ Check ahead - typically lunch & dinner daily

[Website](#)

[Reviews](#)

☐ The odd name comes from a medieval legend: a bishop travelling to Rome sent his servant ahead to chalk "Est!" (Latin for "it is [good]") on the doors of inns with good wine. At Montefiascone the wine was so good the servant wrote "Est! Est!! Est!!!" three times - the bishop loved it so much he settled there for the rest of his life.

Osteria Barberini [///quest.shocking.hosts](http://quest.shocking.hosts)

Cosy osteria near Piazza Barberini - known for truffle dishes and classic Roman cuisine

Via della Purificazione 21 - ~17 min walk

☐ Mon-Sat 12:30-2:30pm & 7-11pm (closed Sun)

[Website](#)

[Reviews](#)

Trattoria dell'Omo [///dreams.appetite.builders](http://dreams.appetite.builders)

Probably the closest proper trattoria to Termini - traditional Roman menu that changes by the day (gnocchi on Thursdays)

Via Vicenza 18 - ~5 min walk

☐ Daily 12pm-3pm & 7pm-10:45pm

[Reviews](#)

La Matriciana dal 1870 ///span.arrow.rooks

Rome institution since 1870 opposite the Opera House - the amatriciana it's named after, plus classic carbonara

Via del Viminale 44 - ~10 min walk

☐ **Sun-Fri 12:15-3pm & 7:15-11pm (closed Sat)**

[Website](#)

[Reviews](#)

Trattoria Monti ///bandage.passion.sank

Long-running family trattoria near Piazza Vittorio serving Le Marche regional dishes - olive ascolane, tortello al rosso d'uovo. Book ahead, it's popular

Via di San Vito 13 - ~12 min walk

☐ **Check ahead - reservations recommended**

[Reviews](#)

☐ **Staying at The Republic Hotel, Rome - Via Gaeta 61, 185 Rome (+39 06 8115 7001 · therepublic@aghotels.it)**

Friday 11 Sep - Today's Places & Suggested Route



Transfer by private minibus - airport to The Republic Hotel (~30-45 min drive depending on traffic, ~28 min best case). Confirmed as Private Minibus, pick-up at FCO Terminal 3, Meeting Point Column 3 - driver waits 1h15m after landing. Supplier: Destination Italia (tel +39 06 6228 7900).

12:00 PM - Via Gaeta 61, 185 Rome

Transfer by private minibus - airport to The Republic Hotel (~30-45 min drive depending on traffic, ~28 min best case). Confirmed as Private Minibus, pick-up at FCO Terminal 3, Meeting Point Column 3 - driver waits 1h15m after landing. Supplier: Destination Italia (tel +39 06 6228 7900). → Piazza della Repubblica & Fontana delle Naiadi

Estimate · Estimate · Walk, taxi or local transport - check live maps for the exact route



Piazza della Repubblica & Fontana delle Naiadi

1:00 PM - Piazza della Repubblica, Rome - ~5 min walk from hotel

Piazza della Repubblica & Fontana delle Naiadi → Santa Maria degli Angeli e dei Martiri

Estimate · Estimate · Walk, taxi or local transport - check live maps for the exact route



Santa Maria degli Angeli e dei Martiri

1:30 PM - Piazza della Repubblica, Rome - ~5 min walk from hotel

Santa Maria degli Angeli e dei Martiri → Villa Borghese Gardens

Estimate · Estimate · Walk, taxi or local transport - check live maps for the exact route



Villa Borghese Gardens

3:00 PM - 5pm - Villa Borghese, Rome, Italy

Villa Borghese Gardens → Pre-dinner drinks - Terrazza Montemartini (rooftop bar, Palazzo Montemartini) Visit Website: Palazzo Montemartini

Estimate · Estimate · Walk, taxi or local transport - check live maps for the exact route



Pre-dinner drinks - Terrazza Montemartini (rooftop bar, Palazzo Montemartini) Visit Website: Palazzo Montemartini

5:00 PM - 6:15pm - Largo Giovanni Montemartini, Rome - ~10 min walk from hotel

Pre-dinner drinks - Terrazza Montemartini (rooftop bar, Palazzo Montemartini) Visit Website: Palazzo Montemartini → The Republic Hotel

Estimate · Estimate · Walk, taxi or local transport - check live maps for the exact route



The Republic Hotel

Return for the night

Schematic order of the day - not to scale. Times/distances/routes are estimates; check live transit apps on the day.

FUN FACTS

It's a myth that Michelangelo painted the Sistine Chapel ceiling lying flat on his back. He actually designed a custom scaffold and painted standing up, craning his neck backwards for four years – the "lying down" idea came from a mistranslated 1527 biography.

— [History.com](https://www.history.com)

St Peter's Basilica, next to the Sistine Chapel, took 120 years to build (1506-1626) and passed through the hands of 24 different architects, including Bramante, Raphael, Michelangelo and finally Bernini, who added the great colonnaded piazza. — [Wikipedia](https://en.wikipedia.org)

The Sistine Chapel ceiling you'll see this morning covers roughly 1,100 square metres and features over 300 individual figures - Michelangelo painted it almost entirely solo between 1508 and 1512, with only a handful of assistants mixing plaster and paint.

— [Vatican Museums](https://www.vaticanmuseums.org)

5:30 AM

Early breakfast at The Republic Hotel (confirm 5:30am service with hotel in advance - standard buffet runs 7:00-10:30am) **TO CONFIRM**

The Republic Hotel, Via Gaeta 61, Rome

[///sports.pocket.anchors](https://sports.pocket.anchors)

7:00 AM

Travel to Vatican meeting point (be there 15 min before tour start) **BOOKED**

Viale Vaticano, top of the stairs next to Caffè Vaticano - look for the white "Towns of Italy" sign

7:45 AM -
9:00 AM

Skip-the-Line Vatican Museums & Sistine Chapel Tour begins - Towns of Italy, Booking Ref 5CJM745M (4 adults, ~3hrs) **BOOKED**

Vatican Museums / Sistine Chapel, Vatican City

Website



WEBSITE

10:45 AM

Vatican Museums & Sistine Chapel Tour ends

12:00 PM

Lunch at Target Restaurant **OPTIONAL**

Near Piazza della Repubblica, Rome - ~8 min walk from hotel Visit Website: Ristorante Target

1:00 PM

Free afternoon in Rome - pick from the 6 suggestions below

Saturday Afternoon Suggestions (6 ideas, after lunch)

Trevi Fountain [///wiped.school.dreaming](#)

Iconic baroque fountain - toss a coin in for luck (~15 min walk from hotel)

Piazza di Trevi, Rome

Spanish Steps & Piazza di Spagna [///rungs.diverts.tractor](#)

Famous steps, great people-watching and shopping nearby (~20 min walk)

Piazza di Spagna, Rome

Pantheon [///strictly.into.evokes](#)

Best-preserved ancient Roman building, free entry (~20-25 min walk)

Piazza della Rotonda, Rome

Piazza Navona [///drank.navy.scanning](#)

Grand baroque square with Bernini's Fountain of the Four Rivers, lively cafes (~25-30 min walk or short taxi)

Piazza Navona, Rome

Galleria Borghese [///detained.planting.describe](#)

World-class Bernini/Caravaggio art collection - needs a pre-booked timed entry ticket, so only if booked in advance

Piazzale Scipione Borghese 5, Rome

[Website](#)

Vatican Necropolis (Scavi Tour) - Tomb of St Peter

[///searched.circling.supposed](#)

Guided tour through the ancient necropolis beneath St Peter's Basilica, ending at the tomb believed to hold St Peter's remains - must be booked well in advance, no photos allowed, small groups only

Meet at the Ufficio Scavi (Excavations Office), Piazza San Pietro, Vatican City

[Website](#)

[Reviews](#)

8 More Dinner Suggestions (no repeats from the 11th)

Ai Tre Scalini - Bottiglieria dal 1895

Historic Monti wine bar (since 1895) - great wines by the glass, traditional small plates, lively atmosphere

Via Panisperna 251, Monti - ~15 min walk

🕒 **Daily 12pm-10pm**

[Reviews](#)

📖 *The name means "at the three steps" - a nod to the three little steps down into its cosy, cellar-like wine bar, which has barely changed since it opened in 1895.*

La Carbonara

Rome institution since 1906, famous for its namesake dish - carbonara, amatriciana, cacio e pepe

Via Panisperna 214, Monti - ~15 min walk

🕒 **Mon-Sat 12:30-2:30pm & 7-11pm (closed Sun)**

[Reviews](#)

📖 *Ironically, this restaurant opened in 1906 - decades before food historians think the dish carbonara was even invented (most trace it to Rome in the 1940s, possibly influenced by American GI rations of eggs and bacon).*

Al Vino al Vino

Intimate Monti enoteca (since 1999) - excellent wine list by the glass, sweet-and-sour eggplant caponata

Via dei Serpenti 19, Monti - ~14 min walk

🕒 **Mon-Thu & Sun 7pm-midnight, Fri-Sat 7pm-1:30am**

[Reviews](#)

La Taverna dei Monti

Popular traditional trattoria - carbonara, cacio e pepe and other Roman staples done well

Via del Boschetto 41, Monti - ~15 min walk

☐ **Tue-Sun 12:30pm-11pm (closed Mon)**

[Reviews](#)

Alle Carrette

One of the best-loved pizzerias in Monti - good prices, lovely courtyard seating out back

Vicolo delle Carrette, Monti - ~16 min walk

☐ **Check ahead - published hours conflict between sources**

[Reviews](#)

Maharajah

Well-rated Indian restaurant in the middle of Monti - good change of pace if craving something other than Italian

Via dei Serpenti 124, Monti - ~14 min walk

☐ **Mon-Thu 12:30-3pm & 7:30pm-midnight (check ahead for weekends)**

[Website](#)

[Reviews](#)

Temakinho

Fun Brazilian-Japanese fusion (sushi meets caipirinha) - colourful spot a few steps from the Colosseum end of Monti

Via dei Serpenti 16, Monti - ~13 min walk

☐ **Daily 12-3:30pm & 7-11:30pm**

[Website](#)

[Reviews](#)

Taverna Romana

Popular family-run local spot known for authentic Roman cuisine and reasonable prices - book ahead as it fills fast

Via della Madonna dei Monti 79, Monti - ~14 min walk

☐ **Mon-Sat 12-3pm & 7:30-11pm (closed Sun)**

[Reviews](#)

Saturday 12 Sep - Today's Places & Suggested Route



The Republic Hotel

Start of day - Via Gaeta 61, 185 Rome

The Republic Hotel → Early breakfast at The Republic Hotel

Estimate · Estimate · Walk, taxi or local transport - check live maps for the exact route



Early breakfast at The Republic Hotel

5:30 AM - The Republic Hotel, Via Gaeta 61, Rome

Early breakfast at The Republic Hotel → Travel to Vatican meeting point

Estimate · Estimate · Walk, taxi or local transport - check live maps for the exact route



Travel to Vatican meeting point

7:00 AM - Viale Vaticano, top of the stairs next to Caffè Vaticano - look for the white "Towns of Italy" sign

Travel to Vatican meeting point → Skip-the-Line Vatican Museums & Sistine Chapel Tour begins - Towns of Italy, Booking Ref 5CJM745M

Estimate · Estimate · Walk, taxi or local transport - check live maps for the exact route



Skip-the-Line Vatican Museums & Sistine Chapel Tour begins - Towns of Italy, Booking Ref 5CJM745M

7:45 AM - 9:00 AM - Vatican Museums / Sistine Chapel, Vatican City

Skip-the-Line Vatican Museums & Sistine Chapel Tour begins - Towns of Italy, Booking Ref 5CJM745M → Lunch at Target Restaurant

Estimate · Estimate · Walk, taxi or local transport - check live maps for the exact route



Lunch at Target Restaurant

12:00 PM - Near Piazza della Repubblica, Rome - ~8 min walk from hotel Visit Website: Ristorante Target

Lunch at Target Restaurant → The Republic Hotel

Estimate · Estimate · Walk, taxi or local transport - check live maps for the exact route



The Republic Hotel

Return for the night

Schematic order of the day - not to scale. Times/distances/routes are estimates; check live transit apps on the day.

FUN FACTS

The Colosseum had a retractable fabric awning called the velarium, made of the same sailcloth used on Roman warships. It weighed about 24 tonnes and was rigged and operated by a special detachment of around 1,000 sailors from the Roman navy.

— [Wikipedia](#)

Beneath the Colosseum's arena floor lies the hypogeum – a two-level maze of tunnels and animal cages with as many as 80 vertical shafts and lift mechanisms that could hoist lions, bears and other beasts straight up into trapdoors in the arena. — [Wikipedia](#)

8:00 AM

Breakfast at The Republic Hotel (included, buffet 7:00-10:30am)

The Republic Hotel, Via Gaeta 61, Rome

[///sports.pocket.anchors](https://sports.pocket.anchors)

9:00 AM

Self-guided morning walk - Roman Forum viewpoint, Trajan's Column & Markets, Piazza del Campidoglio (all free, ~10 min walk to Piazza del Colosseo afterwards)

Via dei Fori Imperiali, Rome

12:30 PM

Lunch near Piazza del Colosseo - pick from the 5 suggestions below

2:15 PM

Travel to Colosseum meeting point (be there 15 min before tour start)

BOOKED

Colle Oppio Park, Via delle Terme di Tito, corner of Via Nicola Salvi - look for staff carrying the "I Love Rome" logo

2:30 PM - 4:00 PM

Colosseum, Roman Forum & Palatine Hill Tour begins - Gray Line Rome, Booking ID 202645831 (4 adults, ~3hrs)

BOOKED

Colosseum / Roman Forum / Palatine Hill, Rome

Website



WEBSITE

5:30 PM

Colosseum, Roman Forum & Palatine Hill Tour ends

Lunch Suggestions Near Piazza del Colosseo (8 ideas, before the tour)

Il Salotto del Colosseo

TripAdvisor 4.7★ - "great lunch by the Colosseum", cosy hidden gem

Via di S. Giovanni in Laterano 42, Rome - ~2 min from Piazza del Colosseo

☐ Daily 11am-11:30pm

Website

Reviews

Fuorinorma

TripAdvisor 4.8★ - "best panini in Rome", fresh charcuterie boards, quick and casual

Via dei Serpenti 178, Monti - ~10 min walk to Colosseo

☐ Mon-Sat 11:30am-11:30pm (closed Sun)

Reviews

Trattoria Luzzi

Bustling local trattoria/pizzeria, a few blocks from the Colosseum - good value, always busy

Via di San Giovanni in Laterano 88, Rome

☐ Mon, Tue, Thu-Sun 12pm-midnight (closed Wed)

Coming Out

TripAdvisor 4.6★ - relaxed all-day cafe/bar right by the Colosseum, big varied menu

Via San Giovanni in Laterano 8, Rome

☐ Check ahead - known for long/late hours but not consistently published

Le Naumachie (Naumachia)

Long-running Roman/Tuscan institution near the Colosseum, grilled mains

Via Celimontana 7, Rome

☐ Daily 11am-11:30pm

Website

Reviews

Cafè Cafè

Relaxed bistro/wine bar near the Colosseum - smoothies, salads and sandwiches, good for a lighter lunch

Via dei Santi Quattro 44, Rome

☐ **Mon & Wed-Sun 9:30am-7:45pm, Tue 9:30am-4:15pm**

[Website](#)

[Reviews](#)

Terre e Domus

Enoteca run by the Province of Rome next to Trajan's Column - ingredients sourced entirely from the Lazio region

Foro Traiano 82, Rome

☐ **Daily 9am-midnight**

[Reviews](#)

La Taverna dei Quaranta

Family-run local trattoria near the Colosseum, serving since 1984 - authentic Roman classics

Via Claudia 24, Rome

☐ **Mon-Wed 12-3:30pm & 7:30pm-midnight**

[Website](#)

[Reviews](#)

8 More Dinner Suggestions (no repeats - handy for after the Colosseum tour)

Hostaria al Boschetto

Warm, cosy Roman comfort food - a Monti favourite, fair prices

Via del Boschetto, Monti - ~15 min walk

☐ **Check ahead - hours not consistently published**

[Reviews](#)

Urbana 47

Farm-to-table Italian - seasonal, organic produce with a modern twist on Roman classics

Via Urbana 47, Monti - ~15 min walk

☐ **Daily 8:30am-midnight**

[Website](#)

La Bottega del Caffè

Lively bar/trattoria right on the prettiest square in Monti - good for a relaxed evening

Piazza Madonna dei Monti 5, Monti - ~16 min walk

☐ **Mon-Sat 8am-2am, Sun 9am-2am**

[Reviews](#)

Ornelli Black Angus Steakhouse

TripAdvisor 4.8★ - top-rated steakhouse, handy since it's right near where today's Colosseum tour finishes

Via Merulana 224 - ~20 min walk from hotel, ~5 min from the Colosseum

☐ **Closed Mondays - check ahead for exact times**

[Reviews](#)

Cuoco & Camicia

TripAdvisor 4.5★ - relaxed elegance, modern Italian cuisine, near the Colosseum end of the tour

Near Cavour/Colosseum - ~22 min walk from hotel, ~5 min from the Colosseum

☐ **Check ahead - hours not consistently published**

[Website](#)

[Reviews](#)

Trattoria Vecchia Roma

Traveller's Choice 2025 winner, est. 1916 - famous for its Amatriciana Flambé, near Piazza Vittorio

Via Ferruccio 12B/C, Esquilino - ~18 min walk

☐ **Mon-Sat 12:30-3pm & 7-11pm (closed Sun)**

[Reviews](#)

Le Caveau

Traveller's Choice-rated Italian restaurant near Piazza Vittorio - fried baby octopus, burrata, good all-rounder

Via Conte Verde 6, Esquilino - ~15 min walk

☐ **Daily 12pm-11pm**

Reviews

Hostaria Al Gladiatore

Over 200 years serving Roman classics right on Piazza del Colosseo - come for the Colosseum view as much as the carbonara

Piazza del Colosseo 5 - ~20 min walk from hotel, on the Colosseum square

☐ **Daily 7am-midnight**

Reviews

☐ **Staying at The Republic Hotel, Rome - Via Gaeta 61, 185 Rome (+39 06 8115 7001 · therepublic@aghotels.it)**

Sunday 13 Sep - Today's Places & Suggested Route



The Republic Hotel

Start of day - Via Gaeta 61, 185 Rome

The Republic Hotel → Breakfast at The Republic Hotel

Estimate · Estimate · Walk, taxi or local transport - check live maps for the exact route



Breakfast at The Republic Hotel

8:00 AM - The Republic Hotel, Via Gaeta 61, Rome

Breakfast at The Republic Hotel → Self-guided morning walk - Roman Forum viewpoint, Trajan's Column & Markets, Piazza del Campidoglio

Estimate · Estimate · Walk, taxi or local transport - check live maps for the exact route



Self-guided morning walk - Roman Forum viewpoint, Trajan's Column & Markets, Piazza del Campidoglio

9:00 AM - Via dei Fori Imperiali, Rome

Self-guided morning walk - Roman Forum viewpoint, Trajan's Column & Markets, Piazza del Campidoglio → Travel to Colosseum meeting point

Estimate · Estimate · Walk, taxi or local transport - check live maps for the exact route



Travel to Colosseum meeting point

2:15 PM - Colle Oppio Park, Via delle Terme di Tito, corner of Via Nicola Salvi - look for staff carrying the "I Love Rome" logo

Travel to Colosseum meeting point → Colosseum, Roman Forum & Palatine Hill Tour begins - Gray Line Rome, Booking ID 202645831

Estimate · Estimate · Walk, taxi or local transport - check live maps for the exact route



Colosseum, Roman Forum & Palatine Hill Tour begins - Gray Line Rome, Booking ID 202645831

2:30 PM - 4:00 PM - Colosseum / Roman Forum / Palatine Hill, Rome

Colosseum, Roman Forum & Palatine Hill Tour begins - Gray Line Rome, Booking ID 202645831 → The Republic Hotel

Estimate · Estimate · Walk, taxi or local transport - check live maps for the exact route



The Republic Hotel

Return for the night

Schematic order of the day - not to scale. Times/distances/routes are estimates; check live transit apps on the day.

Things to Consider - Rome / Cruise

Day	Item	Status	Notes
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Tuscany	Coffee/breakfast stop - Il Caffè degli Amici	OPTIONAL	Tripadvisor 4.7/5 (562 reviews). Via Roma 121, ~5 min walk from Hotel Borgo di Cortefreda Relais. See Italy Map tab.
Tuscany	Pastries/coffee stop - Pasticceria La Golosa	OPTIONAL	Tripadvisor 4.4/5 (31 reviews). Via Palazzuolo, ~7 min walk from Hotel Borgo di Cortefreda Relais. See Italy Map tab.
Sat (12)	Plan Saturday afternoon in Rome TO DO	TO CONFIRM	Free from ~10:45am after the Vatican Museums/Sistine Chapel tour
Sun (13)	Plan Sunday morning in Rome TO DO	TO CONFIRM	Free until the 2:30pm Colosseum tour
Mon (14)	Free morning in Rome before transfer	CONFIRMED	12pm minibus pickup confirmed - free morning in Rome beforehand
Wed (16)	Land excursion - Marseille, France	BOOKED	Queen Victoria shore day
Thu (17)	Land excursion - Villefranche, France	BOOKED	Queen Victoria shore day
Fri (18)	Land excursion - Genoa, Italy	BOOKED	Queen Victoria shore day
Sat (19)	Land excursion - La Spezia (Florence or Pisa)	BOOKED	Queen Victoria shore day
Rome	Choose restaurant for Veal Scaloppine al limone dinner TO DO	TO CONFIRM	Options on Rome Map tab: Cantina Cantarini da Mario, Girarrosto Fiorentino, Colline Emiliane, Trattoria Monti
Tuscany	Dinner option - Ristorante Triocco	OPTIONAL	Tripadvisor 4.6/5 (334 reviews), #2 of 20 in Barberino Val d'Elsa. Via Vittorio Veneto 48, ~5 km / short drive from hotel (in Barberino Val d'Elsa, not walking distance). See Tuscany Map tab.

Tuscany

Lunch option (en route, 21 Sep) - Agriturismo Buratta, Talamone

OPTIONAL

Tripadvisor 4.0/5 (832 reviews), #1 of 19 restaurants in Talamone. Strada Vicinale delle Casacce 65, Talamone - stop along the Civitavecchia to Tuscany drive route. See Tuscany Map tab.

Queen Victoria Cruise

14 – 21 September (7 nights, round trip from Civitavecchia) · Marseille · Villefranche · Genoa · La Spezia

'I' buttons link to that place's official Instagram page.

□ Gala Evenings – V618D (confirmed from Voyage Info, booking 3Q8W5T)

Tue 15 Sep (sea day) – **Red and Gold**

Sat 19 Sep (La Spezia/Pisa day) – **Roaring 20s**

Every other night on board is smart attire. Both gala nights are picked out in **bold red** in the itinerary table below so they can't be missed.

□ Onboard Costs & Local Taxes

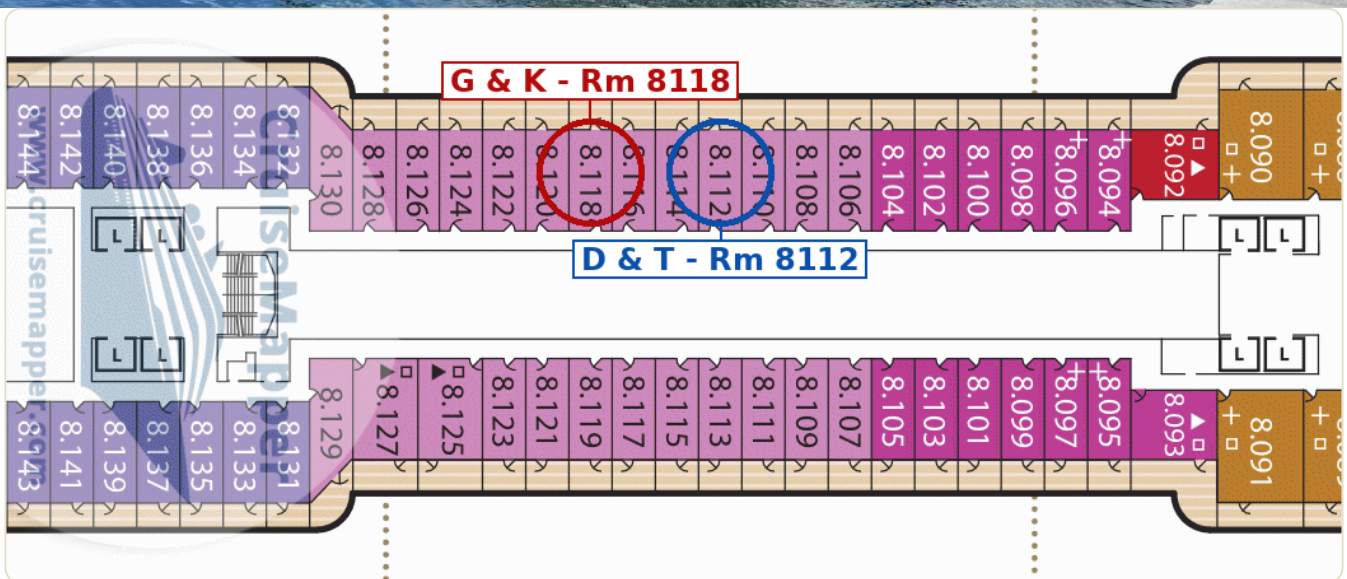
Your AU-market fare already includes port taxes and government fees – **no port on this itinerary charges a landing tax at the gangway**. Italian and French tourist taxes only apply if you sleep ashore, which you don't on any of these port days.

- **Onboard hotel/service charge:** US\$18 per person, per day – roughly **US\$252 for the two of you** across the 7-night voyage, billed to your onboard account in USD.
- **Drinks:** 18% gratuity added automatically to every bar/drinks charge on board.
- **Ashore:** entry tickets, transport and any ATM/FX conversion costs are on you – including the new €2 Trevi Fountain entry ticket if you're revisiting Rome-area sights.
- **Booking conditions clause 36** lets Cunard pass on any tourist/landing taxes introduced after booking, and change the service charge rate before you sail.

Two things worth acting on: EES biometrics have been live at EU borders since April 2026, so allow extra time at Civitavecchia on embarkation day; and My Cunard onboard tour prices close about 4 days before sailing (~10 Sep) at roughly 10% below the on-board price, so book any extra shore tours before then.

☐ Booked Tours & Port Notes

- **Wed 16 Sep - Marseille:** Little Train tour booked.
- **Thu 17 Sep - Villefranche/Monaco:** Monaco Old Town tour booked. Villefranche is a **tender port** - the ship anchors offshore and you'll be ferried in by tender boat, so allow extra time to get ashore.
- **Fri 18 Sep - Genoa:** Discover Genoa tour booked.
- **Sat 19 Sep - La Spezia:** Easy Pisa tour booked, departs 7:45am.



Deck 8 (Balcony) - our two staterooms circled

□ Our Staterooms - Queen Victoria (Deck 8, Balcony)

8118 Gary & Karen

8112 Deb & Tom

See the Deck 8 plan above for exact locations.

FUN FACTS

Civitavecchia, where you'll board Queen Victoria, was built as a Roman port around 103-110 AD on the orders of Emperor Trajan, who commissioned the famous architect Apollodorus of Damascus to design it. It was originally called Centumcellae. — [Roman Ports](#)

Civitavecchia handles well over 2 million cruise passengers a year, making it one of the busiest cruise ports in the Mediterranean, despite the town itself having a population of only around 50,000. — [Port of Civitavecchia](#)

Queen Victoria, the ship you'll board today, carries just over 2,000 passengers - modest by modern cruise-ship standards, deliberately built smaller and more traditionally styled than Cunard's flagship Queen Mary 2. — [Cunard](#)

12:00 PM**Transfer by private minibus to Queen Victoria - 12pm pickup confirmed** **BOOKED**

Civitavecchia Downtown, Via 16 Settembre 46, Cruise Ship Gate

///snipe.nipped.miss**6:00 PM****Board Queen Victoria - depart Rome (Civitavecchia)**

Civitavecchia Downtown, Via 16 Settembre 46, Cruise Ship Gate

7:00 PM**Dinner at Britannia Restaurant (confirmed for all 4)****BOOKED**

Visit Website: Queen Victoria

Website**8:00 PM****Evening Show, Royal Court Theatre****OPTIONAL**

Aboard Queen Victoria

9:30 PM**Rhubarb Gin & Pepsi Max at the Commodore Club****OPTIONAL**

Aboard Queen Victoria

**Staying aboard Queen Victoria (departs Rome)**

Monday 14 Sep - Today's Places & Suggested Route



Transfer by private minibus to Queen Victoria - 12pm pickup confirmed

12:00 PM - Civitavecchia Downtown, Via 16 Settembre 46, Cruise Ship Gate

Transfer by private minibus to Queen Victoria - 12pm pickup confirmed → Board Queen Victoria - depart Rome

Onboard · Onboard · No transfer needed - both are on the ship



Board Queen Victoria - depart Rome

6:00 PM - Civitavecchia Downtown, Via 16 Settembre 46, Cruise Ship Gate

Board Queen Victoria - depart Rome → Dinner at Britannia Restaurant

Onboard · Onboard · No transfer needed - both are on the ship



Dinner at Britannia Restaurant

7:00 PM - Visit Website: Queen Victoria

Dinner at Britannia Restaurant → Evening Show, Royal Court Theatre

Onboard · Onboard · No transfer needed - both are on the ship



Evening Show, Royal Court Theatre

8:00 PM - Aboard Queen Victoria

Evening Show, Royal Court Theatre → Rhubarb Gin & Pepsi Max at the Commodore Club

Onboard · Onboard · No transfer needed - both are on the ship



Rhubarb Gin & Pepsi Max at the Commodore Club

9:30 PM - Aboard Queen Victoria

Schematic order of the day - not to scale. Times/distances/routes are estimates; check live transit apps on the day.

□ Tonight is a Gala Evening - Red and Gold

Formal dress code on board tonight (a sea day, so plenty of time to get ready). See the Gala Evenings box in the Queen Victoria Cruise overview above for the full confirmed schedule.

FUN FACTS

Cunard's Golden Lion Pub – where you'll have pre-dinner drinks tonight – takes its design cues from the original 1938 launch programme for the RMS Queen Elizabeth, keeping a slice of proper British pub tradition alive in the middle of the ocean. — [Cunard](#)

Cunard still keeps up a 'White Star Service' tradition of formal afternoon tea served by white-gloved waiters, a custom traceable back to Samuel Cunard winning the first transatlantic mail contract in 1839. — [Cunard](#)

9:00 AM**Sea Day**

Aboard Queen Victoria

4:00 PM**Drinking Gin**

Aboard Queen Victoria

5:00 PM**Pre-dinner drinks at the Golden Lion Pub** **OPTIONAL**

Aboard Queen Victoria

6:00 PM**Dinner at Britannia Restaurant (confirmed for all 4)****BOOKED**

Visit Website: Queen Victoria

Website **I****8:00 PM****Evening Show, Royal Court Theatre** **OPTIONAL**

Aboard Queen Victoria

9:30 PM**Rhubarb Gin & Pepsi Max at the Commodore Club - Gary's Rhubarb Gin review: smooth, floral, dangerously easy to drink (9/10)** **OPTIONAL**

Aboard Queen Victoria

I**Staying aboard Queen Victoria**

Tuesday 15 Sep - Today's Places & Suggested Route



Sea Day

9:00 AM - Aboard Queen Victoria

Sea Day → Drinking Gin

Onboard · Onboard · No transfer needed - both are on the ship



Drinking Gin

4:00 PM - Aboard Queen Victoria

Drinking Gin → Pre-dinner drinks at the Golden Lion Pub

Onboard · Onboard · No transfer needed - both are on the ship



Pre-dinner drinks at the Golden Lion Pub

5:00 PM - Aboard Queen Victoria

Pre-dinner drinks at the Golden Lion Pub → Dinner at Britannia Restaurant

Onboard · Onboard · No transfer needed - both are on the ship



Dinner at Britannia Restaurant

6:00 PM - Visit Website: Queen Victoria

Dinner at Britannia Restaurant → Evening Show, Royal Court Theatre

Onboard · Onboard · No transfer needed - both are on the ship



Evening Show, Royal Court Theatre

8:00 PM - Aboard Queen Victoria

Evening Show, Royal Court Theatre → Rhubarb Gin & Pepsi Max at the Commodore Club - Gary's Rhubarb Gin review: smooth, floral, dangerously easy to drink

Onboard · Onboard · No transfer needed - both are on the ship



Rhubarb Gin & Pepsi Max at the Commodore Club - Gary's Rhubarb Gin review: smooth, floral, dangerously easy to drink

9:30 PM - Aboard Queen Victoria

Schematic order of the day - not to scale. Times/distances/routes are estimates; check live transit apps on the day.

FUN FACTS

Marseille, today's port of call, is the oldest city in France – founded around 600 BC by Greek settlers from Phocaea, who named it Massalia. That makes it roughly 2,600 years old.

— [Wikipedia](#)

Marseille soap, savon de Marseille, has been made to essentially the same olive-oil recipe since a 1688 royal decree from Louis XIV fixed the exact ingredients allowed to carry the name. — [Wikipedia](#)

Marseille's Notre-Dame de la Garde basilica, perched on the city's highest point, is topped by a 9.5-metre gilded statue of the Madonna and Child that has watched over sailors leaving and returning to the port since 1870. — [Wikipedia](#)

8:00 AM In port: Marseille, France

Marseille, France

9:00 AM Marseille and the Little Train **BOOKED**

Visit Website: Cunard Shore Excursions

[Website](#)

**5:00 PM Pre-dinner drinks at the Golden Lion Pub** **OPTIONAL**

Aboard Queen Victoria

6:00 PM Dinner at Britannia Restaurant (confirmed for all 4)

BOOKED

Visit Website: Queen Victoria

[Website](#)

**8:00 PM Evening Show, Royal Court Theatre** **OPTIONAL**

Aboard Queen Victoria

9:30 PM Rhubarb Gin & Pepsi Max at the Commodore Club - Gary's Pepsi Max review: does exactly what a Pepsi Max should do, zero surprises (7/10) **OPTIONAL**

Aboard Queen Victoria

**Staying aboard Queen Victoria**

Wednesday 16 Sep - Today's Places & Suggested Route



In port: Marseille, France

8:00 AM - Marseille, France

In port: Marseille, France → Marseille and the Little Train

Estimate · Estimate · Ashore in port - taxi, shore excursion coach or walk; confirm with your tour operator or the ship's shore excursion desk



Marseille and the Little Train

9:00 AM - Visit Website: Cunard Shore Excursions

Marseille and the Little Train → Pre-dinner drinks at the Golden Lion Pub

Estimate · Estimate · Ashore in port - taxi, shore excursion coach or walk; confirm with your tour operator or the ship's shore excursion desk



Pre-dinner drinks at the Golden Lion Pub

5:00 PM - Aboard Queen Victoria

Pre-dinner drinks at the Golden Lion Pub → Dinner at Britannia Restaurant

Estimate · Estimate · Ashore in port - taxi, shore excursion coach or walk; confirm with your tour operator or the ship's shore excursion desk



Dinner at Britannia Restaurant

6:00 PM - Visit Website: Queen Victoria

Dinner at Britannia Restaurant → Evening Show, Royal Court Theatre

Estimate · Estimate · Ashore in port - taxi, shore excursion coach or walk; confirm with your tour operator or the ship's shore excursion desk



Evening Show, Royal Court Theatre

8:00 PM - Aboard Queen Victoria

Evening Show, Royal Court Theatre → Rhubarb Gin & Pepsi Max at the Commodore Club - Gary's Pepsi Max review: does exactly what a Pepsi Max should do, zero surprises

Estimate · Estimate · Ashore in port - taxi, shore excursion coach or walk; confirm with your tour operator or the ship's shore excursion desk



Rhubarb Gin & Pepsi Max at the Commodore Club - Gary's Pepsi Max review: does exactly what a Pepsi Max should do, zero surprises

9:30 PM - Aboard Queen Victoria

Schematic order of the day - not to scale. Times/distances/routes are estimates; check live transit apps on the day.

□ Tender Port - Villefranche

Villefranche is a tender port – the ship anchors offshore and you'll be ferried in by tender boat, so allow extra time to get ashore. A soft-shoe day for the Fab 4.

FUN FACTS

Monégasques - the actual citizens of Monaco - are legally banned from gambling in their own Monte Carlo Casino, a rule dating back to the mid-1800s. The casino was built specifically to draw money from wealthy foreign visitors instead. — [Fact Republic](#)

Monaco is the world's second-smallest country after Vatican City, at just over 2 square kilometres - and it has grown roughly 20% larger since 1861 through land reclaimed from the sea. — [Wikipedia](#)

The Monaco Grand Prix, first raced in 1929, runs on ordinary public streets barricaded off once a year - drivers reach speeds of over 290 km/h just metres from the harbour where cruise ships dock. — [Wikipedia](#)

8:00 AM In port: Villefranche, France

Villefranche, France

9:00 AM Monaco and the Old Town **BOOKED**

Visit Website: Cunard Shore Excursions

[Website](#) **I****5:00 PM Pre-dinner drinks at the Golden Lion Pub** **OPTIONAL**

Aboard Queen Victoria

6:00 PM Dinner at Britannia Restaurant (confirmed for all 4)**BOOKED**

Visit Website: Queen Victoria

[Website](#) **I****8:00 PM Evening Show, Royal Court Theatre** **OPTIONAL**

Aboard Queen Victoria

9:30 PM Rhubarb Gin & Pepsi Max at the Commodore Club**OPTIONAL**

Aboard Queen Victoria

I**Staying aboard Queen Victoria**

Thursday 17 Sep - Today's Places & Suggested Route



In port: Villefranche, France

8:00 AM - Villefranche, France

In port: Villefranche, France → Monaco and the Old Town

Estimate · Estimate · Ashore in port - taxi, shore excursion coach or walk; confirm with your tour operator or the ship's shore excursion desk



Monaco and the Old Town

9:00 AM - Visit Website: Cunard Shore Excursions

Monaco and the Old Town → Pre-dinner drinks at the Golden Lion Pub

Estimate · Estimate · Ashore in port - taxi, shore excursion coach or walk; confirm with your tour operator or the ship's shore excursion desk



Pre-dinner drinks at the Golden Lion Pub

5:00 PM - Aboard Queen Victoria

Pre-dinner drinks at the Golden Lion Pub → Dinner at Britannia Restaurant

Estimate · Estimate · Ashore in port - taxi, shore excursion coach or walk; confirm with your tour operator or the ship's shore excursion desk



Dinner at Britannia Restaurant

6:00 PM - Visit Website: Queen Victoria

Dinner at Britannia Restaurant → Evening Show, Royal Court Theatre

Estimate · Estimate · Ashore in port - taxi, shore excursion coach or walk; confirm with your tour operator or the ship's shore excursion desk



Evening Show, Royal Court Theatre

8:00 PM - Aboard Queen Victoria

Evening Show, Royal Court Theatre → Rhubarb Gin & Pepsi Max at the Commodore Club

Estimate · Estimate · Ashore in port - taxi, shore excursion coach or walk; confirm with your tour operator or the ship's shore excursion desk



Rhubarb Gin & Pepsi Max at the Commodore Club

9:30 PM - Aboard Queen Victoria

Schematic order of the day - not to scale. Times/distances/routes are estimates; check live transit apps on the day.

FUN FACTS

Genoa, today's port, is traditionally held to be the birthplace of Christopher Columbus around 1451 – Columbus himself wrote in his 1498 will "yo nacio en Genoba" ("I was born in Genoa"), though the claim is still debated by historians. — [Christopher Columbus](#)

Genoa's medieval old town, the caruggi, is one of the largest and best-preserved historic centres in Europe - a dense maze of narrow lanes that helped the city earn UNESCO World Heritage status in 2006. — [UNESCO](#)

Genoa's La Lanterna lighthouse, visible from the port today, was first built in 1128 and rebuilt to its current 76-metre form in 1543 - making it one of the oldest lighthouses still operating anywhere in the world. — [Wikipedia](#)

8:00 AM**In port: Genoa, Italy**

Genoa, Italy

9:00 AM**Discover Genoa shore excursion****BOOKED**

Visit Website: Cunard Shore Excursions

Website**5:00 PM****Pre-dinner drinks at the Golden Lion Pub****OPTIONAL**

Aboard Queen Victoria

6:00 PM**Dinner at Britannia Restaurant (confirmed for all 4)****BOOKED**

Visit Website: Queen Victoria

Website**8:00 PM****Evening Show, Royal Court Theatre****OPTIONAL**

Aboard Queen Victoria

9:30 PM**Rhubarb Gin & Pepsi Max at the Commodore Club****OPTIONAL**

Aboard Queen Victoria

**10:00 PM****Churchill's Cigar Lounge, Level 10****OPTIONAL**

Aboard Queen Victoria, Level 10 (Commodore Deck)

Staying aboard Queen Victoria

Friday 18 Sep - Today's Places & Suggested Route



In port: Genoa, Italy

8:00 AM - Genoa, Italy

In port: Genoa, Italy → Discover Genoa shore excursion

Estimate · Estimate · Ashore in port - taxi, shore excursion coach or walk; confirm with your tour operator or the ship's shore excursion desk



Discover Genoa shore excursion

9:00 AM - Visit Website: Cunard Shore Excursions

Discover Genoa shore excursion → Pre-dinner drinks at the Golden Lion Pub

Estimate · Estimate · Ashore in port - taxi, shore excursion coach or walk; confirm with your tour operator or the ship's shore excursion desk



Pre-dinner drinks at the Golden Lion Pub

5:00 PM - Aboard Queen Victoria

Pre-dinner drinks at the Golden Lion Pub → Dinner at Britannia Restaurant

Estimate · Estimate · Ashore in port - taxi, shore excursion coach or walk; confirm with your tour operator or the ship's shore excursion desk



Dinner at Britannia Restaurant

6:00 PM - Visit Website: Queen Victoria

Dinner at Britannia Restaurant → Evening Show, Royal Court Theatre

Estimate · Estimate · Ashore in port - taxi, shore excursion coach or walk; confirm with your tour operator or the ship's shore excursion desk



Evening Show, Royal Court Theatre

8:00 PM - Aboard Queen Victoria

Evening Show, Royal Court Theatre → Rhubarb Gin & Pepsi Max at the Commodore Club

Estimate · Estimate · Ashore in port - taxi, shore excursion coach or walk; confirm with your tour operator or the ship's shore excursion desk



Rhubarb Gin & Pepsi Max at the Commodore Club

9:30 PM - Aboard Queen Victoria

Rhubarb Gin & Pepsi Max at the Commodore Club → Churchill's Cigar Lounge, Level 10

Estimate · Estimate · Ashore in port - taxi, shore excursion coach or walk; confirm with your tour operator or the ship's shore excursion desk



Churchill's Cigar Lounge, Level 10

10:00 PM - Aboard Queen Victoria, Level 10 (Commodore Deck)

Schematic order of the day - not to scale. Times/distances/routes are estimates; check live transit apps on the day.

☐ **Tonight is a Gala Evening - Roaring 20s**

Formal dress code on board tonight after today's La Spezia/Pisa excursion. See the Gala Evenings box in the Queen Victoria Cruise overview above for the full confirmed schedule.

FUN FACTS

The Leaning Tower of Pisa took almost 200 years to build (1173-1372) because construction was interrupted twice by war for decades at a time. Those pauses accidentally saved it – they gave the soft soil time to settle, which stopped the tower toppling before it was even finished. — [Wikipedia](#)

Before restoration work in the 1990s-2000s, the Leaning Tower of Pisa was tilting at nearly 5.5 degrees. Engineers carefully removed soil from beneath the raised side to reduce the lean to its current, more stable 3.97 degrees. — [Wikipedia](#)

8:00 AM**In port: La Spezia (Florence or Pisa)**

La Spezia, Italy

9:00 AM**Easy Pisa - 7.45am tour** **BOOKED**

Visit Website: Cunard Shore Excursions

Website**5:00 PM****Pre-dinner drinks at the Golden Lion Pub** **OPTIONAL**

Aboard Queen Victoria

6:00 PM**Dinner at Britannia Restaurant (confirmed for all 4)****BOOKED**

Visit Website: Queen Victoria

Website**8:00 PM****Evening Show, Royal Court Theatre** **OPTIONAL**

Aboard Queen Victoria

9:30 PM**Rhubarb Gin & Pepsi Max at the Commodore Club****OPTIONAL**

Aboard Queen Victoria

**Staying aboard Queen Victoria**

Saturday 19 Sep - Today's Places & Suggested Route



In port: La Spezia

8:00 AM - La Spezia, Italy

In port: La Spezia → Easy Pisa - 7.45am tour

Estimate · Estimate · Ashore in port - taxi, shore excursion coach or walk; confirm with your tour operator or the ship's shore excursion desk



Easy Pisa - 7.45am tour

9:00 AM - Visit Website: Cunard Shore Excursions

Easy Pisa - 7.45am tour → Pre-dinner drinks at the Golden Lion Pub

Estimate · Estimate · Ashore in port - taxi, shore excursion coach or walk; confirm with your tour operator or the ship's shore excursion desk



Pre-dinner drinks at the Golden Lion Pub

5:00 PM - Aboard Queen Victoria

Pre-dinner drinks at the Golden Lion Pub → Dinner at Britannia Restaurant

Estimate · Estimate · Ashore in port - taxi, shore excursion coach or walk; confirm with your tour operator or the ship's shore excursion desk



Dinner at Britannia Restaurant

6:00 PM - Visit Website: Queen Victoria

Dinner at Britannia Restaurant → Evening Show, Royal Court Theatre

Estimate · Estimate · Ashore in port - taxi, shore excursion coach or walk; confirm with your tour operator or the ship's shore excursion desk



Evening Show, Royal Court Theatre

8:00 PM - Aboard Queen Victoria

Evening Show, Royal Court Theatre → Rhubarb Gin & Pepsi Max at the Commodore Club

Estimate · Estimate · Ashore in port - taxi, shore excursion coach or walk; confirm with your tour operator or the ship's shore excursion desk



Rhubarb Gin & Pepsi Max at the Commodore Club

9:30 PM - Aboard Queen Victoria

Schematic order of the day - not to scale. Times/distances/routes are estimates; check live transit apps on the day.

FUN FACTS

Queen Victoria – the ship you're sailing on – was christened in Southampton on 10 December 2007 by Camilla, Duchess of Cornwall. The first champagne bottle swung at the hull famously failed to break (a bad omen, traditionally) before a second bottle did the job. — [Travel Weekly](#)

Queen Victoria carries a two-deck library stocked with thousands of books, plus a dedicated bookshop, card room and ballroom - deliberately echoing the classic ocean liners of the 1920s and 30s rather than a modern mega-ship. — [Cunard](#)

9:00 AM

Sea Day

Aboard Queen Victoria

4:00 PM

Drinking Gin

Aboard Queen Victoria

5:00 PM

Pre-dinner drinks at the Golden Lion Pub OPTIONAL

Aboard Queen Victoria

6:00 PM

Dinner at Britannia Restaurant (confirmed for all 4)

BOOKED

Visit Website: Queen Victoria

Website I

8:00 PM

Evening Show, Royal Court Theatre OPTIONAL

Aboard Queen Victoria

9:30 PM

Rhubarb Gin & Pepsi Max at the Commodore Club

OPTIONAL

Aboard Queen Victoria

I

Staying aboard Queen Victoria

Sunday 20 Sep - Today's Places & Suggested Route



Sea Day

9:00 AM - Aboard Queen Victoria

Sea Day → Drinking Gin

Onboard · Onboard · No transfer needed - both are on the ship



Drinking Gin

4:00 PM - Aboard Queen Victoria

Drinking Gin → Pre-dinner drinks at the Golden Lion Pub

Onboard · Onboard · No transfer needed - both are on the ship



Pre-dinner drinks at the Golden Lion Pub

5:00 PM - Aboard Queen Victoria

Pre-dinner drinks at the Golden Lion Pub → Dinner at Britannia Restaurant

Onboard · Onboard · No transfer needed - both are on the ship



Dinner at Britannia Restaurant

6:00 PM - Visit Website: Queen Victoria

Dinner at Britannia Restaurant → Evening Show, Royal Court Theatre

Onboard · Onboard · No transfer needed - both are on the ship



Evening Show, Royal Court Theatre

8:00 PM - Aboard Queen Victoria

Evening Show, Royal Court Theatre → Rhubarb Gin & Pepsi Max at the Commodore Club

Onboard · Onboard · No transfer needed - both are on the ship



Rhubarb Gin & Pepsi Max at the Commodore Club

9:30 PM - Aboard Queen Victoria

Schematic order of the day - not to scale. Times/distances/routes are estimates; check live transit apps on the day.

Cunard Voyage Info (V618D)

Day	Port	Arrives	Departs
Mon 14 Sep	Civitavecchia (depart Rome)	–	Evening
Tue 15 Sep 📅	At Sea GALA - RED AND GOLD	–	–

Wed 16 Sep	Marseille, France	Early morning	Evening
Thu 17 Sep	Villefranche, France (tender port)	Early morning	Evening
Fri 18 Sep	Genoa, Italy	Early morning	Late evening
Sat 19 Sep 📅	La Spezia (tours to Florence or Pisa) GALA - ROARING 20S	Early morning	Evening
Sun 20 Sep	At Sea	-	-
Mon 21 Sep	Civitavecchia (disembark)	Early morning	-

Ship Stats

Guests	Crew	Length
2,059	913	964.5 ft

Onboard - Things to Check Out

Venue	Notes
Gala evenings	Tue 15 Sep (Red and Gold) & Sat 19 Sep (Roaring 20s) - formal nights with themed menus, cocktails, decorations, music and dancing
Princess Grill Restaurant	Reserved table each night, elevated menu, sea views
Chart Room	Signature venue with zodiac-themed cocktails, dark woods, golden lighting
Queens Room	Fencing classes, Afternoon Tea, live music, dancing
Grill Suites Terrace/Courtyard	Outdoor sanctuary for Queens/Princess Grill Suite guests, sun loungers, drinks service

Gym	Included in fare, guests 16+, sea views, optional fitness classes/ personal training
Children's clubs	Under-18s, book via the My Voyage portal on board – games, arts and crafts, activities

Full deck plan: [View Deck Plan \(PDF\)](#)



Fair winds – the Queen Victoria at sea

Tuscany

21 – 22 September · Hotel Borgo di Cortefreda Relais, Tavarnelle Val di Pesa

'I' buttons link to that place's official Instagram page.

📌 FUN FACTS

Talamone, where you'll stop for lunch, gets a mocking mention in Dante's Purgatorio. The Sienese had just bought the port for 8,000 florins hoping to build their fortunes there, but it was plagued by silt and malaria and never really worked out. — [Princeton Dante Project](#)

Talamone's hilltop Rocca Aldobrandesca fortress, overlooking the harbour where you'll arrive, was refortified by the Sienese in the 1300s and later garrisoned by the Spanish in the 1500s as part of their coastal defences. — [Wikipedia](#)

Nearby San Gimignano once bristled with as many as 72 stone towers, built by rival medieval families competing to build the tallest as a show of wealth and power. Only 14 towers survive today, giving the town its famous 'medieval Manhattan' skyline. — [Wikipedia](#)

9:00 AM

Collect Avis hire car - Mercedes Vito (booking ref NZ759149602) BOOKED

Civitavecchia Downtown, Via 16 Settembre 46, Cruise Ship Gate

[///snipe.nipped.miss](#)

9:30 AM

Drive from Civitavecchia to Talamone (approx. 2h)

Directions: Civitavecchia to Talamone

[Directions](#)

11:30 AM

Lunch option: Agriturismo Buratta, Talamone

OPTIONAL

Directions: Agriturismo Buratta

[Website](#)

[Menu](#)

[Directions](#)

1:00 PM

Drive from Talamone to Tuscany hotel (approx. 2h)

Directions: Talamone to Tuscany

[Directions](#)

3:00 PM

Arrive Hotel Borgo di Cortefreda Relais

Via Roma 191, 50028, Tavarnelle Val Di Pesa Parking note: free onsite parking (contact hotel in advance to reserve a space)

📌 **Staying at Hotel Borgo di Cortefreda Relais, Tuscany - Via Roma 191, 50028, Tavarnelle Val Di Pesa (+39 055 807 3333 · info@borgodicortefreda.com)**

Monday 21 Sep - Today's Places & Suggested Route



Collect Avis hire car - Mercedes Vito

9:00 AM - Civitavecchia Downtown, Via 16 Settembre 46, Cruise Ship Gate

Collect Avis hire car - Mercedes Vito → Drive from Civitavecchia to Talamone

Estimate · Estimate · Walk, taxi or local transport - check live maps for the exact route



Drive from Civitavecchia to Talamone

9:30 AM - Directions: Civitavecchia to Talamone

Drive from Civitavecchia to Talamone → Lunch option: Agriturismo Buratta, Talamone

Estimate · Estimate · Walk, taxi or local transport - check live maps for the exact route



Lunch option: Agriturismo Buratta, Talamone

11:30 AM - Directions: Agriturismo Buratta

Lunch option: Agriturismo Buratta, Talamone → Drive from Talamone to Tuscany hotel

Estimate · Estimate · Walk, taxi or local transport - check live maps for the exact route



Drive from Talamone to Tuscany hotel

1:00 PM - Directions: Talamone to Tuscany

Drive from Talamone to Tuscany hotel → Arrive Hotel Borgo di Cortefreda Relais

Estimate · Estimate · Walk, taxi or local transport - check live maps for the exact route



Arrive Hotel Borgo di Cortefreda Relais

3:00 PM - Via Roma 191, 50028, Tavarnelle Val Di Pesa Parking note: free onsite parking (contact hotel in advance to reserve a space)

Arrive Hotel Borgo di Cortefreda Relais → Hotel Borgo di Cortefreda Relais

Estimate · Estimate · Walk, taxi or local transport - check live maps for the exact route



Hotel Borgo di Cortefreda Relais

Return for the night

Schematic order of the day - not to scale. Times/distances/routes are estimates; check live transit apps on the day.

FUN FACTS

The black rooster on every bottle of Chianti Classico comes from a medieval legend: Florence and Siena settled a border dispute by each sending a knight to ride out at the crow of a rooster. Florence starved theirs so it crowed early in the dark, giving their knight a head start - and Florence most of Chianti. — [Visit Tuscany](#)

Chianti Classico must legally be aged at least a year before release, and the black rooster 'Gallo Nero' seal is only allowed on wine from the original historic Chianti Classico zone - not the wider Chianti region that surrounds it. — [Consorzio Vino Chianti Classico](#)

The rows of cypress trees lining Tuscany's hillsides were originally planted as windbreaks and property boundary markers by landowners centuries ago, long before they became the region's postcard image. — [Visit Tuscany](#)

9:00 AM**Potential Breakfast/Coffee: Il Caffè degli Amici****OPTIONAL**

Directions from Hotel: Il Caffè degli Amici

[Website](#)[Menu](#)[Directions](#)**4:00 PM****Potential Pastries/Coffee: Pasticceria La Golosa****OPTIONAL**

Directions from Hotel: Pasticceria La Golosa

[Website](#)[Directions](#)**7:00 PM****Potential Restaurant: Triocco****OPTIONAL**

Directions from Hotel: Triocco

[Website](#)[Menu](#)[Directions](#)

Staying at Hotel Borgo di Cortefreda Relais, Tuscany - Via Roma 191, 50028, Tavarnelle Val Di Pesa (+39 055 807 3333 · info@borgodicortefreda.com)

Tuesday 22 Sep - Today's Places & Suggested Route



Hotel Borgo di Cortefreda Relais

Start of day - Via Roma 191, 50028, Tavarnelle Val Di Pesa

Hotel Borgo di Cortefreda Relais → Potential Breakfast/Coffee: Il Caffè degli Amici

Estimate · Estimate · Walk, taxi or local transport - check live maps for the exact route



Potential Breakfast/Coffee: Il Caffè degli Amici

9:00 AM - Directions from Hotel: Il Caffè degli Amici

Potential Breakfast/Coffee: Il Caffè degli Amici → Potential Pastries/Coffee: Pasticceria La Golosa

Estimate · Estimate · Walk, taxi or local transport - check live maps for the exact route



Potential Pastries/Coffee: Pasticceria La Golosa

4:00 PM - Directions from Hotel: Pasticceria La Golosa

Potential Pastries/Coffee: Pasticceria La Golosa → Potential Restaurant: Triocco

Estimate · Estimate · Walk, taxi or local transport - check live maps for the exact route



Potential Restaurant: Triocco

7:00 PM - Directions from Hotel: Triocco

Potential Restaurant: Triocco → Hotel Borgo di Cortefreda Relais

Estimate · Estimate · Walk, taxi or local transport - check live maps for the exact route



Hotel Borgo di Cortefreda Relais

Return for the night

Schematic order of the day - not to scale. Times/distances/routes are estimates; check live transit apps on the day.

Mercedes Drive Times - Monday 21 September

Leg	Approx. Distance	Approx. Drive Time	Notes
Civitavecchia (car collection) → Agriturismo Buratta, Talamone	~140 km	~2h 00m	Coastal route via SS1 Aurelia
Agriturismo Buratta, Talamone → Hotel Borgo di Cortefreda Relais	~140 km	~2h 00m	Via SS223 (Siena-Grosseto), then north toward Tavarnelle

Total driving, via Talamone lunch stop	~280 km	~4h 00m driving (excl. lunch)	Direct route without the detour is approx. 230 km / 3h 10m
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Estimates only – not a live routing query. Confirm via GPS/Google Maps on the day; actual times will vary with traffic and any stops.

Milan

23 September · iQ Hotel Milano

'I' buttons link to that place's official Instagram page.

FUN FACTS

In the Galleria Vittorio Emanuele II next to the Duomo, tradition says spinning three times on your right heel on a certain mosaic bull's more sensitive anatomy brings good luck. It's so popular the mosaic has needed repeated restoration from all the grinding heels.

— [VisitMilano](#)

Milan's Duomo took nearly 600 years to finish, from 1386 to 1965. Napoleon, crowned King of Italy inside it in 1805, ordered the facade rushed to completion and personally financed the work to have it ready in time. — [Wikipedia](#)

**9:00 AM -
12:10pm**

Check out of Hotel Borgo di Cortefreda Relais & drive to Milan (approx. 3h 10m)

Directions: Tuscany to Milan

[Directions](#)

12:00 PM

Arrive Milan - Check-in at iQ Hotel Milano

Via Giovanni Battista Pirelli, 5, 20124 Milan Check-in from 3:00pm - call ahead if arriving early: +39 02 8498 0810 Parking note: no private hotel parking - nearest partner garage ~100m away (fee applies, ask reception)

[Website](#)

[I](#)

**1:00 PM -
6:00pm**

Free time / sightseeing in Milan (Duomo, Galleria Vittorio Emanuele II, Navigli) [TO CONFIRM](#)

Milan city centre

**7:00 PM -
8:30pm**

Dinner in Milan [TO BOOK](#)

Options: Cantine Milano, L'Immagine Bistrot, Casa Festa Alcolica - see Italy Map tab

[Website](#)

**9:00 PM -
10:00pm**

Nightcap drinks at LiQuido Rooftop Bar [BOOKED](#)

Via Giovanni Battista Pirelli 5, 20124 Milan, Italy (rooftop of iQ Hotel Milano)
Visit TripAdvisor: LiQuido Rooftop Bar

[Website](#)

[Menu](#)

Wednesday 23 Sep - Today's Places & Suggested Route



Hotel Borgo di Cortefreda Relais

Start of day - Via Roma 191, 50028, Tavarnelle Val Di Pesa

Hotel Borgo di Cortefreda Relais → Check out of Hotel Borgo di Cortefreda Relais & drive to Milan

Estimate · Estimate · Walk, taxi or local transport - check live maps for the exact route



Check out of Hotel Borgo di Cortefreda Relais & drive to Milan

9:00 AM – 12:10pm - Directions: Tuscany to Milan

Check out of Hotel Borgo di Cortefreda Relais & drive to Milan → Arrive Milan - Check-in at iQ Hotel Milano

Estimate · Estimate · Walk, taxi or local transport - check live maps for the exact route



Arrive Milan - Check-in at iQ Hotel Milano

12:00 PM - Via Giovanni Battista Pirelli, 5, 20124 Milan Check-in from 3:00pm - call ahead if arriving early: +39 02 8498 0810 Parking note: no private hotel parking - nearest partner garage ~100m away (fee applies, ask reception)

Arrive Milan - Check-in at iQ Hotel Milano → Free time / sightseeing in Milan

Estimate · Estimate · Walk, taxi or local transport - check live maps for the exact route



Free time / sightseeing in Milan

1:00 PM – 6:00pm - Milan city centre

Free time / sightseeing in Milan → Dinner in Milan

Estimate · Estimate · Walk, taxi or local transport - check live maps for the exact route



Dinner in Milan

7:00 PM – 8:30pm - Options: Cantine Milano, L'Immagine Bistrot, Casa Festa Alcolica - see Italy Map tab

Dinner in Milan → Nightcap drinks at LiQuido Rooftop Bar

Estimate · Estimate · Walk, taxi or local transport - check live maps for the exact route



Nightcap drinks at LiQuido Rooftop Bar

9:00 PM – 10:00pm - Via Giovanni Battista Pirelli 5, 20124 Milan, Italy (rooftop of iQ Hotel Milano) Visit TripAdvisor: LiQuido Rooftop Bar

Schematic order of the day – not to scale. Times/distances/routes are estimates; check live transit apps on the day.

Alternative Options for 23 September

Four alternative full-day plans in place of the base Tuscany → Milan drive above – pick one.

Note on Option C: Venice is a significant detour east before doubling back west to Milan – approx. 610 km / ~6h 20m total driving (vs. ~1h 30m for the base plan, ~5h 15m for Option A, ~3h 40m for Option B). Also note Venice's historic centre is car-free, so the car must be left at Tronchetto or Piazzale Roma and the centre reached on foot/vaporetto. Worth confirming everyone's comfortable with the long day before booking.

OPTION A - LAKE COMO, LUNCH AT HARRY'S (23 SEP) [Total driving: 5h 15m]

FUN FACTS

Lake Como's Laglio, just along the shore from Harry's Bar Cernobbio, is home to George Clooney's 18th-century Villa Oleandra, bought in 2002 for around \$10 million and now estimated at over \$100 million. He's become an honorary citizen of the town. — [Wevillas](#)

Lake Como is one of the deepest lakes in Europe, plunging to over 400 metres in places - deep enough that its lake bed actually sits below sea level. — [Wikipedia](#)

**6:00 AM -
7:00 AM**

Check out of Hotel Borgo di Cortefreda Relais & drive to Bologna (approx. 1h 30m)

Directions: Tuscany to Bologna

Directions

**7:30 AM -
8:30am**

Arrive Bologna - Breakfast at Aroma Specialty Coffee

OPTIONAL

Via Portanova 12/b, 40123 Bologna, Italy Visit Website: Aroma Specialty Coffee (Il Piacere del Caffè)

Website

I

**8:30 AM -
11:00am**

Drive from Bologna to Como (approx. 2h 30m)

Directions: Bologna to Como

Directions

11:00 AM

Arrive Como - Como-Brunate Funicular up to Brunate (approx. 7 min ride)

Piazza Alcide de Gasperi 4, 22100 Como, Italy Visit Website: Funicolare Como-Brunate

Website

**11:30 AM -
12:30pm**

Gelato with a view at Il Balcone sul Lago Café, Brunate

OPTIONAL

Via Pissarottino 26, 22034 Brunate (Como), Italy Visit Website: Il Balcone sul Lago (Facebook)

Website

12:30 PM

Drive from Como to Cernobbio (approx. 15 min)

Directions: Como to Cernobbio

Directions

**1:00 PM -
2:30pm**

Lunch at Harry's Bar, Cernobbio (Lake Como)

OPTIONAL

Via Besana 1, 22012 Cernobbio, Como, Italy Visit Website: Harry's Bar Cernobbio

Website

Menu

I

**2:30 PM -
3:30pm**

Drive from Lake Como to Milan (approx. 1h)

Directions: Lake Como to Milan

Directions

3:30 PM

Arrive Milan - Check-in at iQ Hotel Milano

Via Giovanni Battista Pirelli, 5, 20124 Milan, Italy Check-in from 3:00pm - call ahead if arriving early: +39 02 8498 0810 Parking note: no private hotel parking - nearest partner garage ~100m away (fee applies, ask reception)

Website

I

**7:00 PM -
8:30pm**

Dinner in Milan

TO BOOK

Options: Cantine Milano, L'Immagine Bistrot, Casa Festa Alcolica - see Italy Map tab

Website

**9:00 PM -
10:00pm**

Nightcap drinks at LiQuido Rooftop Bar

BOOKED

Via Giovanni Battista Pirelli 5, 20124 Milan, Italy (rooftop of iQ Hotel Milano) Visit TripAdvisor: LiQuido Rooftop Bar

Website

Menu

□ iQ Hotel Milano, Milan (OPTION A) - Via Giovanni Battista Pirelli, 5, 20124 Milan (+39 02 8498 0810 · info@iqhotelmilano.it)

Today's Places & Suggested Route



Hotel Borgo di Cortefreda Relais

Start of day - Via Roma 191, 50028, Tavarnelle Val Di Pesa

Hotel Borgo di Cortefreda Relais → Check out of Hotel Borgo di Cortefreda Relais & drive to Bologna

Estimate · Estimate · Walk, taxi or local transport - check live maps for the exact route



Check out of Hotel Borgo di Cortefreda Relais & drive to Bologna

6:00 AM – 7:00 AM - Directions: Tuscany to Bologna

Check out of Hotel Borgo di Cortefreda Relais & drive to Bologna → Arrive Bologna - Breakfast at Aroma Specialty Coffee

Estimate · Estimate · Walk, taxi or local transport - check live maps for the exact route



Arrive Bologna - Breakfast at Aroma Specialty Coffee

7:30 AM – 8:30am - Via Portanova 12/b, 40123 Bologna, Italy Visit Website: Aroma Specialty Coffee (Il Piacere del Caffè)

Arrive Bologna - Breakfast at Aroma Specialty Coffee → Drive from Bologna to Como

Estimate · Estimate · Walk, taxi or local transport - check live maps for the exact route



Drive from Bologna to Como

8:30 AM – 11:00am - Directions: Bologna to Como

Drive from Bologna to Como → Arrive Como - Como-Brunate Funicular up to Brunate

Estimate · Estimate · Walk, taxi or local transport - check live maps for the exact route



Arrive Como - Como-Brunate Funicular up to Brunate

11:00 AM - Piazza Alcide de Gasperi 4, 22100 Como, Italy Visit Website: Funicolare Como-Brunate

Arrive Como - Como-Brunate Funicular up to Brunate → Gelato with a view at Il Balcone sul Lago Café, Brunate

Estimate · Estimate · Walk, taxi or local transport - check live maps for the exact route



Gelato with a view at Il Balcone sul Lago Café, Brunate

11:30 AM – 12:30pm - Via Pissarottino 26, 22034 Brunate (Como), Italy Visit Website: Il Balcone sul Lago (Facebook)

Gelato with a view at Il Balcone sul Lago Café, Brunate → Drive from Como to Cernobbio

Estimate · Estimate · Walk, taxi or local transport - check live maps for the exact route



Drive from Como to Cernobbio

12:30 PM - Directions: Como to Cernobbio

Drive from Como to Cernobbio → Lunch at Harry's Bar, Cernobbio

Estimate · Estimate · Walk, taxi or local transport - check live maps for the exact route



Lunch at Harry's Bar, Cernobbio

1:00 PM – 2:30pm - Via Besana 1, 22012 Cernobbio, Como, Italy Visit Website: Harry's Bar Cernobbio

Lunch at Harry's Bar, Cernobbio → Drive from Lake Como to Milan

Estimate · Estimate · Walk, taxi or local transport - check live maps for the exact route



Drive from Lake Como to Milan

2:30 PM – 3:30pm - Directions: Lake Como to Milan

Drive from Lake Como to Milan → Arrive Milan - Check-in at iQ Hotel Milano

Estimate · Estimate · Walk, taxi or local transport - check live maps for the exact route



Arrive Milan - Check-in at iQ Hotel Milano

3:30 PM - Via Giovanni Battista Pirelli, 5, 20124 Milan, Italy Check-in from 3:00pm - call ahead if arriving early: +39 02 8498 0810 Parking note: no private hotel parking - nearest partner garage ~100m away (fee applies, ask reception)

Arrive Milan - Check-in at iQ Hotel Milano → Dinner in Milan

Estimate · Estimate · Walk, taxi or local transport - check live maps for the exact route



Dinner in Milan

7:00 PM – 8:30pm - Options: Cantine Milano, L'Immagine Bistrot, Casa Festa Alcolica - see Italy Map tab

Dinner in Milan → Nightcap drinks at LiQuido Rooftop Bar

Estimate · Estimate · Walk, taxi or local transport - check live maps for the exact route



Nightcap drinks at LiQuido Rooftop Bar

9:00 PM – 10:00pm - Via Giovanni Battista Pirelli 5, 20124 Milan, Italy (rooftop of iQ Hotel Milano) Visit TripAdvisor: LiQuido Rooftop Bar

Nightcap drinks at LiQuido Rooftop Bar → iQ Hotel Milano

Estimate · Estimate · Walk, taxi or local transport - check live maps for the exact route



iQ Hotel Milano

Return for the night

Schematic order of the day – not to scale. Times/distances/routes are estimates; check live transit apps on the day.

OPTION B - FERRARI MUSEUM, MARANELLO (23 SEP) [Total driving: 3h 40m]

FUN FACTS

Ferrari's prancing horse logo wasn't Enzo Ferrari's idea originally. It came from WWI flying ace Francesco Baracca, who painted a horse on his fighter plane. After he was killed in 1918, his mother suggested the young racer Enzo Ferrari use it for luck – he kept the horse but changed its colour to black, in Baracca's memory. — [Rosso Automobili](#)

Every Ferrari road car is still largely hand-assembled at the Maranello factory, where fewer than 15 cars typically roll off the line each day - production is deliberately kept scarce. — [Ferrari](#)

**9:00 AM -
10:40am**

Check out of Hotel Borgo di Cortefreda Relais & drive to Maranello (approx. 1h 40m)

Directions: Tuscany to Maranello

[Directions](#)

**11:00 AM -
1:00pm**

Visit Museo Ferrari, Maranello OPTIONAL

Via Dino Ferrari 43, 41053 Maranello (MO), Italy Visit Website: Museo Ferrari

[Website](#) 

**1:00 PM -
2:00pm**

Lunch near Ferrari Museum, Maranello OPTIONAL

**2:00 PM -
4:00pm**

Drive from Maranello to Milan (approx. 2h)

Directions: Maranello to Milan

[Directions](#)

4:00 PM

Arrive Milan - Check-in at iQ Hotel Milano

Via Giovanni Battista Pirelli, 5, 20124 Milan, Italy Check-in from 3:00pm - call ahead if arriving early: +39 02 8498 0810 Parking note: no private hotel parking - nearest partner garage ~100m away (fee applies, ask reception)

[Website](#) 

**7:00 PM -
8:30pm**

Dinner in Milan TO BOOK

Options: Cantine Milano, L'Immagine Bistrot, Casa Festa Alcolica - see Italy Map tab

[Website](#)

**9:00 PM -
10:00pm**

Nightcap drinks at LiQuido Rooftop Bar BOOKED

Via Giovanni Battista Pirelli 5, 20124 Milan, Italy (rooftop of iQ Hotel Milano) Visit TripAdvisor: LiQuido Rooftop Bar

📍 **iQ Hotel Milano, Milan (OPTION B) - Via Giovanni Battista Pirelli, 5, 20124 Milan**
(+39 02 8498 0810 · info@iqhotelmilano.it)

Today's Places & Suggested Route

Hotel Borgo di Cortefreda Relais

Start of day - Via Roma 191, 50028, Tavarnelle Val Di Pesa

Hotel Borgo di Cortefreda Relais → Check out of Hotel Borgo di Cortefreda Relais & drive to Maranello

Estimate · Estimate · Walk, taxi or local transport - check live maps for the exact route

Check out of Hotel Borgo di Cortefreda Relais & drive to Maranello

9:00 AM – 10:40am - Directions: Tuscany to Maranello

Check out of Hotel Borgo di Cortefreda Relais & drive to Maranello → Visit Museo Ferrari, Maranello

Estimate · Estimate · Walk, taxi or local transport - check live maps for the exact route

Visit Museo Ferrari, Maranello

11:00 AM – 1:00pm - Via Dino Ferrari 43, 41053 Maranello (MO), Italy Visit Website: Museo Ferrari

Visit Museo Ferrari, Maranello → Drive from Maranello to Milan

Estimate · Estimate · Walk, taxi or local transport - check live maps for the exact route

Drive from Maranello to Milan

2:00 PM – 4:00pm - Directions: Maranello to Milan

Drive from Maranello to Milan → Arrive Milan - Check-in at iQ Hotel Milano

Estimate · Estimate · Walk, taxi or local transport - check live maps for the exact route

Arrive Milan - Check-in at iQ Hotel Milano

4:00 PM - Via Giovanni Battista Pirelli, 5, 20124 Milan, Italy Check-in from 3:00pm - call ahead if arriving early: +39 02 8498 0810 Parking note: no private hotel parking - nearest partner garage ~100m away (fee applies, ask reception)

Arrive Milan - Check-in at iQ Hotel Milano → Dinner in Milan

Estimate · Estimate · Walk, taxi or local transport - check live maps for the exact route

Dinner in Milan

7:00 PM – 8:30pm - Options: Cantine Milano, L'Immagine Bistrot, Casa Festa Alcolica - see Italy Map tab

Dinner in Milan → Nightcap drinks at LiQuido Rooftop Bar

Estimate · Estimate · Walk, taxi or local transport - check live maps for the exact route

Nightcap drinks at LiQuido Rooftop Bar

9:00 PM – 10:00pm - Via Giovanni Battista Pirelli 5, 20124 Milan, Italy (rooftop of iQ Hotel Milano) Visit TripAdvisor: LiQuido Rooftop Bar

Nightcap drinks at LiQuido Rooftop Bar → iQ Hotel Milano

Estimate · Estimate · Walk, taxi or local transport - check live maps for the exact route

iQ Hotel Milano

Return for the night

Schematic order of the day - not to scale. Times/distances/routes are estimates; check live transit apps on the day.

OPTION C - VENICE LUNCH (23 SEP) [Total driving: 6h 20m]

FUN FACTS

Venice has no cars at all in its historic centre – it's built across 118 small islands linked by more than 400 bridges, and the only way around is on foot or by boat. That's exactly why you'll need to park at Tronchetto or Piazzale Roma before walking in. — [Wikipedia](#)

Venice is slowly sinking at roughly 1-2mm a year while the Adriatic rises around it, which is why the city completed the MOSE flood barrier system in 2020 to hold back high tides during 'acqua alta'. — [Wikipedia](#)

**6:00 AM -
9:30am**

Check out of Hotel Borgo di Cortefreda Relais & drive to Venice (approx. 3h 30m)

Directions: Tuscany to Venice

[Directions](#)

9:30 AM

Arrive Venice - park at Tronchetto/Piazzale Roma (historic centre is car-free)

Tronchetto Parking, Isola del Tronchetto, 30135 Venice, Italy

[Website](#)

[Directions](#)



**10:00 AM -
12:30pm**

Free time - explore St Mark's Square & Rialto Bridge

OPTIONAL

**12:30 PM -
2:00pm**

Lunch in Venice

TO BOOK

[Website](#)

**2:00 PM -
4:50pm**

Drive from Venice to Milan (approx. 2h 50m)

Directions: Venice to Milan

[Directions](#)

5:00 PM

Arrive Milan - Check-in at iQ Hotel Milano

Via Giovanni Battista Pirelli, 5, 20124 Milan, Italy Check-in from 3:00pm - call ahead if arriving early: +39 02 8498 0810 Parking note: no private hotel parking - nearest partner garage ~100m away (fee applies, ask reception)

[Website](#)



**7:00 PM -
8:30pm**

Dinner in Milan

TO BOOK

Options: Cantine Milano, L'Immagine Bistrot, Casa Festa Alcolica - see Italy Map tab

[Website](#)

Nightcap drinks at LiQuido Rooftop Bar

BOOKED

9:00 PM -
10:00pm

Via Giovanni Battista Pirelli 5, 20124 Milan, Italy (rooftop of iQ Hotel Milano)
Visit TripAdvisor: LiQuido Rooftop Bar

Website

Menu

📍 **iQ Hotel Milano, Milan (OPTION C) - Via Giovanni Battista Pirelli, 5, 20124 Milan**
(+39 02 8498 0810 · info@iqhotelmilano.it)

Today's Places & Suggested Route



Hotel Borgo di Cortefreda Relais

Start of day - Via Roma 191, 50028, Tavarnelle Val Di Pesa

Hotel Borgo di Cortefreda Relais → Check out of Hotel Borgo di Cortefreda Relais & drive to Venice

Estimate · Estimate · Walk, taxi or local transport - check live maps for the exact route



Check out of Hotel Borgo di Cortefreda Relais & drive to Venice

6:00 AM – 9:30am - Directions: Tuscany to Venice

Check out of Hotel Borgo di Cortefreda Relais & drive to Venice → Arrive Venice - park at Tronchetto/Piazzale Roma

Estimate · Estimate · Walk, taxi or local transport - check live maps for the exact route



Arrive Venice - park at Tronchetto/Piazzale Roma

9:30 AM - Tronchetto Parking, Isola del Tronchetto, 30135 Venice, Italy

Arrive Venice - park at Tronchetto/Piazzale Roma → Drive from Venice to Milan

Estimate · Estimate · Walk, taxi or local transport - check live maps for the exact route



Drive from Venice to Milan

2:00 PM – 4:50pm - Directions: Venice to Milan

Drive from Venice to Milan → Arrive Milan - Check-in at iQ Hotel Milano

Estimate · Estimate · Walk, taxi or local transport - check live maps for the exact route



Arrive Milan - Check-in at iQ Hotel Milano

5:00 PM - Via Giovanni Battista Pirelli, 5, 20124 Milan, Italy Check-in from 3:00pm - call ahead if arriving early: +39 02 8498 0810 Parking note: no private hotel parking - nearest partner garage ~100m away (fee applies, ask reception)

Arrive Milan - Check-in at iQ Hotel Milano → Dinner in Milan

Estimate · Estimate · Walk, taxi or local transport - check live maps for the exact route



Dinner in Milan

7:00 PM – 8:30pm - Options: Cantine Milano, L'Immagine Bistrot, Casa Festa Alcolica - see Italy Map tab

Dinner in Milan → Nightcap drinks at LiQuido Rooftop Bar

Estimate · Estimate · Walk, taxi or local transport - check live maps for the exact route



Nightcap drinks at LiQuido Rooftop Bar

9:00 PM – 10:00pm - Via Giovanni Battista Pirelli 5, 20124 Milan, Italy (rooftop of iQ Hotel Milano) Visit TripAdvisor: LiQuido Rooftop Bar

Nightcap drinks at LiQuido Rooftop Bar → iQ Hotel Milano

Estimate · Estimate · Walk, taxi or local transport - check live maps for the exact route



iQ Hotel Milano

Return for the night

Potential Dinner Restaurants – Milan (23 September, all 3 plans)

All confirmed open on a Wednesday. The first three (Cantine Milano, L'Immagine, Casa Festa) were the original shortlist; the five below (Osteria Cornalia, Da Gigi, Osteria Nanin - Torriani, Giannino dal 1899, Pizza Shambò) are all 4-5 star Italian/Mediterranean options and much closer to the hotel (6-12 min walk, except Pizza Shambò at ~25 min). Hours and ratings sourced online – please reconfirm nearer the date. Distances are estimates only, from iQ Hotel Milano.

Cantine Milano

Open Wed: 12:00–3:00pm & 6:00pm–12:30am

Via Trau 1, 20159 Milano

□ ~1.8 km from iQ Hotel Milano · ~20 min walk / ~7 min taxi · Walk via Via Sammartini, or short taxi

[Website](#)[Menu](#)[Map](#)[I](#)

L'Immagine Ristorante Bistrot

Open Wed: 6:00–10:30pm (dinner only)

Via Varesina 61, 20156 Milano

□ ~4.5 km from iQ Hotel Milano · ~15 min taxi / ~25 min metro + walk · Taxi, or M5 to Portello then ~10 min walk

[Website](#)[Menu](#)[Map](#)[I](#)

Casa Festa - Pizzeria Alcolica

Open Wed: 11:30am–3:00pm & 6:30–11:30pm

Viale Bligny 42, 20136 Milano

□ ~4.8 km from iQ Hotel Milano · ~18 min taxi / ~25 min metro · Taxi, or M3 toward Porta Romana/Lodi then ~8 min walk

[Website](#)[Menu](#)[Map](#)[I](#)

Osteria Cornalia

TripAdvisor 4.6★ (362 reviews) · Open Wed: 12:00–3:00pm & 7:00pm–12:00am

Via Emilio Cornalia 16, 20124 Milano

□ ~0.6 km from iQ Hotel Milano · ~8 min walk · Walk via Via Napo Torriani/Via Sammartini

[Website](#)[Menu](#)[Map](#)[I](#)

Da Gigi Ristorante & Pizzeria

TheFork 8.9/10 · Open Wed: 12:00pm–11:00pm (non-stop)

Via Mauro Macchi 2, 20124 Milano

□ ~0.5 km from iQ Hotel Milano · ~7 min walk · Walk via Via Vittor Pisani/Via Mauro Macchi

[Website](#)[Menu](#)[Map](#)[I](#)

Osteria Nanin - Torriani

TripAdvisor 4.0★ (97 reviews) · Open Wed: 12:00–3:00pm & 7:00–10:45pm

Via Napo Torriani 10, 20124 Milano

📍 ~0.45 km from iQ Hotel Milano · ~6 min walk · Walk via Via Napo Torriani

[Website](#)

[Menu](#)

[Map](#)

[I](#)

Giannino dal 1899

TripAdvisor 4.3★ (303 reviews) · Open Wed: 12:00–3:00pm & 7:00–11:30pm

Via Vittor Pisani 6, 20124 Milano

📍 ~0.9 km from iQ Hotel Milano · ~12 min walk · Walk via Via Vittor Pisani towards Piazza della Repubblica

[Website](#)

[Menu](#)

[Map](#)

[I](#)

Pizza Shambò

TripAdvisor 4.6★ (229 reviews) · Open Wed: 12:00–3:00pm & 6:00–11:00pm

Via Edolo 1, 20125 Milano

📍 ~2.0 km from iQ Hotel Milano · ~25 min walk / ~10 min taxi · Taxi, or bus/tram towards Via Porpora

[Website](#)

[Menu](#)

[Map](#)

[I](#)

London

24 – 27 September · The Level at Meliá White House

'I' buttons link to that place's official Instagram page.

Getting Around: Tube Map & Travel Pass

Nearest station to the hotel: Great Portland Street (Circle, Hammersmith & City, Metropolitan lines) – approx. 2-3 min walk (~0.2 km), directly opposite The Level at Meliá White House.

[CLICK HERE for the Official TfL Tube Map \(PDF\)](#)

Getting a travel pass for the few days:

Contactless bank card / Apple Pay / Google Pay – simplest option for most visitors. Just tap in and out at the yellow readers on the Tube, buses, DLR, Overground and Elizabeth line – no need to buy anything in advance. Fares are automatically capped at around £8.90/day for Zones 1-2 (2026 rate), so a few days of sightseeing between Zone 1 (central London) and Zone 2 (Regent's Park/Camden area) should never cost more than the daily cap, even if you tap in and out a lot. Check your bank doesn't charge foreign transaction fees before relying on this.

Visitor Oyster card – order online before you fly (from about £5 plus however much credit you preload) or buy a standard Oyster card at any station on arrival (£7 refundable deposit). Works exactly like contactless with the same daily cap, and avoids any card fees or acceptance issues. Top up at station machines or the TfL Oyster app.

7 Day Travelcard – only worth considering if doing lots of travel every single day; for a 4-day stay like this one, pay-as-you-go (contactless or Oyster) with the daily cap works out cheaper and more flexible.

[Order a Visitor Oyster Card](#)

[Current TfL Fares](#)

FUN FACTS

Tonight's dinner spot, The Lighterman, is named after the Victorian "lightermen" who steered flat-bottomed barges (called lighters) along the Regent's Canal right outside, ferrying goods through this once-industrial part of King's Cross. — [King's Cross](#)

Regent's Canal, which runs right past tonight's dinner spot, was built in the 1810s-1820s and named for the Prince Regent (later George IV). It once floated coal and building materials into London before being revived as a leisure towpath. — [Wikipedia](#)

 Sites within 20m

 Shops within 20m

12:00 PM

Return hire car - Mercedes Vito (booking ref NZ759149602) BOOKED

Milan Linate Airport Directions from iQ Hotel Milano

[Directions](#)

3:55 PM

Flight BA575 (British Airways) Milan Linate to London Heathrow (T5) - arrives 4:50pm

Milan Linate (LIN) to London Heathrow (LHR Terminal 5)

5:15 PM

Luxury Private Vehicle transfer to hotel - The Traveling Group / London Travel In (office +44 (0)20 8049 4300, emergency +44 7733 448902) (booking ref 190826)

BOOKED

Direct from Heathrow Terminal 5 (Meeting Point South, by Caffè Nero) to The Level at Meliá White House

6:00 PM

Arrive at The Level at Meliá White House - check in / drop bags (tight connection before dinner - see Audit)

Longford Street, Regent's Park, London NW1 3UP

[///baked.belly.neck](https://baked.belly.neck)

4:30 PM -
5:00 PM

Tapas and Gin for Deb (likely won't fit before dinner now BA575's official time is later - reconsider or move to another evening)

6:30 PM -
7:00 PM

Dinner at The Lighterman (confirmation 4NJL3Z4M6XN3)

BOOKED

3 Granary Square, London N1C 4BH (~1 mile / 20 min walk from hotel)

 020 3846 3400 [///guides.riots.trader](https://guides.riots.trader)

(If we're early, we could grab a quick Gin & Pepsi downstairs first 😊)

[Website](#)

[Menu](#)

[TripAdvisor](#)

[I](#)



WEBSITE

After The Lighterman: Nightcap Options

Estimates only – check live transit apps on the day.

The Parcel Yard

Grade I listed Fuller's pub inside King's Cross station itself

King's Cross Station, London N1 9AL

▢ **From The Lighterman: ~8 min walking**

▢ **To The Melia: ~15 min - Circle/Hammersmith & City/Metropolitan line direct from King's Cross St Pancras to Great Portland Street (2 stops), then ~3 min walk**

Map

Website

Menu

TripAdvisor



Big Chill Bar

Three-storey bar/club with a roof terrace, near the station

257-259 Pentonville Rd, London N1 9NL

▢ **From The Lighterman: ~10 min walking**

▢ **To The Melia: ~15 min - Circle/Hammersmith & City/Metropolitan line direct from King's Cross St Pancras to Great Portland Street (2 stops), then ~3 min walk**

Map

Website

TripAdvisor



The Racketeer

Independent, family-run cocktail and wine bar

105 King's Cross Rd, London WC1X 9LR

▢ **From The Lighterman: ~12 min walking**

▢ **To The Melia: ~15 min - Circle/Hammersmith & City/Metropolitan line direct from King's Cross St Pancras to Great Portland Street (2 stops), then ~3 min walk**

Map

Website

Menu

TripAdvisor



Spiritland King's Cross

Music-focused listening bar with a serious sound system and a well-executed cocktail list

9-10 Stable St, London N1C 4AB

▮ **From The Lighterman: ~2 min walking**

▮ **To The Melia: ~15 min - Circle/Hammersmith & City/Metropolitan line direct from King's Cross St Pancras to Great Portland Street (2 stops), then ~3 min walk**

Map

Website

TripAdvisor



▮ **Staying at The Level at Melia White House - Longford Street, Regents Park, London NW1 3UP (+44 20 7391 3000 · melia.white.house@melia.com)**

Thursday 24 Sept - Today's Places & Suggested Routes



iQ Hotel Milano

Start of day - check out

iQ Hotel Milano → Milan Linate Airport

~20 min · ~8 km · Drive: iQ Hotel Milano to Milan Linate Airport (car return)



Milan Linate Airport

12:00pm - Return hire car

Milan Linate Airport → London Heathrow Airport (Terminal 5)

~1h 55m flight (dep 3:55pm, arr 4:50pm) · ~1,000 km · Flight BA575 (British Airways), Milan Linate to London Heathrow (T5) (~55 min apart on local clocks due to the UK/Italy time difference)



London Heathrow Airport (Terminal 5)

4:50pm - Arrive on flight BA575

London Heathrow Airport (Terminal 5) → The Level at Melia White House

~70 min total · ~24 km · Immigration/border and baggage at Heathrow T5 (~25 min), then meet the Luxury Private Vehicle driver at Meeting Point South, by Caffè Nero, for the transfer (The Traveling Group / London Travel In, ref 190826) direct to The Level at Meliá White House (~45 min drive)



The Level at Melia White House

6:00pm - Arrive, check in / drop bags

The Level at Melia White House → The Lighterman, Granary Square

~20 min · ~1.6 km · Walk towards King's Cross/Granary Square (or ~10 min taxi)



The Lighterman, Granary Square

6:30pm - Dinner

The Lighterman, Granary Square → The Level at Melia White House

~20-25 min · ~1.6 km · Walk back via Euston Road (or ~10 min taxi)



The Level at Melia White House

Return for the night

Schematic order of the day - not to scale. Times/distances/routes are estimates; check live transit apps on the day.

FUN FACTS

The Mousetrap, playing tonight, is the world's longest continuously-running play - it opened in 1952 and passed 30,000 performances in 2025. By long tradition, the audience is asked at the end of every single show never to reveal the killer's identity. — [Wikipedia](#)

The V&A Museum was founded in 1852 using profits from the Great Exhibition of 1851, and its collection has since grown to more than 2.8 million objects spanning 5,000 years of art and design. — [V&A](#)

The V&A's Cast Courts hold a full plaster cast of Rome's Trajan's Column, taken in the 1860s - it's so tall it had to be split into two pieces just to fit under the gallery ceiling. — [V&A](#)

Sites within 20m **Shops within 20m**

8:00 AM - 8:30 AM **Breakfast at The Level**

9:30 AM **Potential Victoria and Albert Museum** **OPTIONAL**
Directions from Hotel: V&A Museum
[///spots.mugs.cards](#)
Directions **I**

12:00 PM **Potential Early Lunch at Harry's Knightsbridge** **OPTIONAL**
Directions from Hotel: Harry's Knightsbridge
[///icon.spends.third](#)
Menu **TripAdvisor** **Directions**

Harry's Bar-style venues take their name and dolce vita aesthetic from the original Harry's Bar in Venice, opened in 1931 - said to be where the Bellini cocktail and carpaccio were both invented. — [Wikipedia](#)

1:00 PM **Free time wandering around Oxford Street**
Oxford Street: [oxfordstreet.co.uk](#)
Website **I**

POTENTIAL SHOPS TO LOOK AT:

Primark	Address	Website
14-28 Oxford Street, London W1D 1AR		
Uniqlo	Address	Website
311 Oxford Street, London W1C 2HP		
Selfridges	Address	Website
400 Oxford Street, London W1A 1AB		

John Lewis

[Address](#)[Website](#)

300 Oxford Street, London W1C 1DX

Hamleys

[Address](#)[Website](#)

188-196 Regent Street, London W1B 5BT

Nike Town London

[Address](#)[Website](#)

236 Oxford Street, London W1C 1DE

Adidas Flagship Store

[Address](#)[Website](#)

425 Oxford Street, London W1C 2PG

Zara Oxford Street

[Address](#)[Website](#)

460-490 Oxford Street, London W1C 1AT

HMV

[Address](#)[Website](#)

363 Oxford Street, London W1C 2LA

Liberty London

[Address](#)[Website](#)

Great Marlborough St / Regent Street, London W1B 5AH

ALSO WORTH A LOOK:

RS No.9 Carnaby (Official Rolling Stones Store)

[///catch.future.librarian](#)

The Rolling Stones' official flagship store - clothing, vinyl and memorabilia, plus a Ronnie Wood art exhibition in the basement (~12 min walk via Regent Street/Carnaby Street)

9 Carnaby St, Carnaby, London W1F 9PE

☐ **Mon-Sat 11am-7pm, Sun 12pm-6pm**

[Map](#)

► **Play "You Can't Always Get What You Want"**

**4:30 PM -
5:30 PM**

Dinner at Albert Schloss (booked, ref DMN-16959374828)

BOOKED

20-24 Shaftesbury Avenue, London W1D 7EU

☐ 020 8165 0000 [///assist.given.desk](#)

[Menu](#)[TripAdvisor](#)[I](#)



WEBSITE

□ *Albert's Schloss is one of a small chain of Alpine-Bavarian bier hall/cabaret venues from The New World Trading Company - the original opened in Manchester in 2017, with the Soho branch spread across several floors of a former Soho building near Piccadilly Circus. — Albert's Schloss*

6:30 PM

Need to be at Mousetrap by 6:30pm to get in

BOOKED

St Martin's Theatre, West Street, London WC2H 9NZ



WEBSITE

**7:30 PM -
10pm**

The Mousetrap begins (confirmed ref T071226139201)

BOOKED

St Martin's Theatre, West Street, London WC2H 9NZ

///trains.areas.nights

After The Mousetrap: Nightcap Options

Estimates only – check live transit apps on the day.

Covent Garden Social Club **///begins.jumpy.bake**

Original London Cocktail Club venue, now independent

6-7 Great Newport St, London WC2H 7JB

□ **From St Martin's Theatre: ~2 min walking**

□ **To The Melia: ~25 min - Piccadilly line from Leicester Square to Piccadilly Circus, change to Bakerloo to Great Portland Street, then ~3 min walk**

Map

Website

TripAdvisor

Phoenix Artist Club **///meant.costs.defend**

Theatrical cocktail bar and cabaret club beneath the Phoenix Theatre

1 Phoenix St, London WC2H 8BU

▮ **From St Martin's Theatre: ~3 min walking**

▮ **To The Melia: ~25 min - Piccadilly line from Leicester Square to Piccadilly Circus, change to Bakerloo to Great Portland Street, then ~3 min walk**

Map

Website

TripAdvisor

The Alchemist St Martin's Lane

Theatrical cocktails and post-theatre menu, right around the corner

63-66 St Martin's Ln, London WC2N 4JS

▮ **From St Martin's Theatre: ~4 min walking**

▮ **To The Melia: ~25 min - Piccadilly line from Leicester Square to Piccadilly Circus, change to Bakerloo to Great Portland Street, then ~3 min walk**

Map

Website

TripAdvisor

American Bar at The Savoy

The original 1893 cocktail bar - a London institution, book ahead

The Savoy, Strand, London WC2R 0EU

▮ **From St Martin's Theatre: ~10 min walking**

▮ **To The Melia: ~25 min - Piccadilly line from Covent Garden to Piccadilly Circus, change to Bakerloo to Great Portland Street, then ~3 min walk**

Map

Website

TripAdvisor

▮ **Staying at The Level at Melia White House - Longford Street, Regents Park, London NW1 3UP (+44 20 7391 3000 · melia.white.house@melia.com)**

Friday 25 Sept - Today's Places & Suggested Routes



The Level at Melia White House

Start of day - Breakfast 8:00am

The Level at Melia White House → V&A Museum

~30-35 min · ~6.5 km · Bakerloo line to Piccadilly Circus, change to Piccadilly line to South Kensington, then ~5 min walk (or Circle line via Baker Street, one change)



V&A Museum

9:30am

V&A Museum → Harry's Knightsbridge

~12-15 min · ~1.1 km · Walk via Brompton Road, or 1 stop on the Piccadilly line, South Kensington to Knightsbridge



Harry's Knightsbridge

12:00pm - Early lunch

Harry's Knightsbridge → Oxford Street

~10-12 min · ~3.2 km · Piccadilly line to Green Park, change to Victoria line to Oxford Circus



Oxford Street

1:00pm - Free time / shopping

Oxford Street → Albert Schloss, Shaftesbury Avenue

~15 min · ~1.3 km · Walk down Regent Street/Shaftesbury Avenue, or 1 stop Central line to Tottenham Court Road + short walk



Albert Schloss, Shaftesbury Avenue

4:30pm - Dinner

Albert Schloss, Shaftesbury Avenue → St Martin's Theatre

~6-8 min · ~0.5 km · Walk along Shaftesbury Avenue



St Martin's Theatre

6:30pm - The Mousetrap

St Martin's Theatre → The Level at Melia White House

~20-25 min · ~3.3 km · Piccadilly line: Leicester Square to Piccadilly Circus, change to Bakerloo line to Regent's Park, then ~5 min walk



The Level at Melia White House

Return for the night (after 10:00pm)

Schematic order of the day - not to scale. Times/distances/routes are estimates; check live transit apps on the day.

FUN FACTS

The original [Hard Rock Cafe](#) in London opened on June 14, 1971, inside a deserted Rolls-Royce dealership. The founders only received a 6-month lease because their landlord did not think an American-style burger joint would last.

The ravens at the Tower of London have had their wings trimmed since at least the 1600s, following the legend that the kingdom will fall if they ever leave. Traditionally at least six are kept there, plus one in reserve. — [Historic Royal Palaces](#)

Six, the West End musical you're seeing tonight, reimagines the six wives of Henry VIII as a girl-group pop concert. It began life as a student production at Cambridge University in 2017 before transferring to the West End in 2019. — [Wikipedia](#)

 Sites within 20m

 Shops within 20m

7:30 AM -
8:00 AM

Breakfast at The Level

9:00 AM -
10:45 AM

Tower of London Tour (#33605663)

BOOKED

Tower of London, London EC3N 4AB

[///swift.blitz.funds](http://swift.blitz.funds)

[Website](#)
[TripAdvisor](#)
[Directions](#)


10:45 AM -
11:30 AM

River Tour (#33605662)

BOOKED

Tower Bridge Quay, St Katharine's Way, London E1W 1LD

[///dunes.copy.miles](http://dunes.copy.miles)

[Website](#)
[TripAdvisor](#)
[Directions](#)


12:30 PM -
2:15 PM

Lunch near Tower Bridge / St Katharine Docks (see suggestions below)

OPTIONAL

3:00 PM

Need to be at Vaudeville Theatre by 3:00pm (1hr before show)

BOOKED

Vaudeville Theatre, Strand, London WC2R 0NH

[///diner.donor.rails](http://diner.donor.rails)

4:00 PM -
5:15pm

Six the Musical begins - Stalls G8, G9, G10, G11 (4 adults, 1hr 15min) - Headout booking #32832547 (Gary Nicholson)

BOOKED

Vaudeville Theatre, Strand, London WC2R 0NH



 *SIX started life as a low-budget student production at Cambridge University in 2017, written by two undergraduates, Toby Marlow and Lucy Moss, who were still in*

their early twenties. It transferred to the West End in 2019 and has since played on Broadway and around the world. — [Wikipedia](#)

5:30 PM -
6:30pm

Visit Waterstones Piccadilly OPTIONAL

Directions from Hotel: Waterstones Piccadilly

///blank.buns.bump

Website

Directions



□ This shop opened in 1936 as Simpsons of Piccadilly, then Britain's largest menswear store, designed by modernist architect Joseph Emberton. Waterstones took it over in 1999 and it's now Europe's largest bookshop, with over 8 miles of shelving across 6 floors. — [Wikipedia](#)

6:45pm -
8:15pm

Dinner at Hard Rock Cafe London (confirmation #496211, via OpenTable) BOOKED



150 Old Park Lane, Mayfair, London W1K 1QZ

□ 0044 20 7514 1700

///month.wakes.tests

Website

Menu

Manage on OpenTable



WEBSITE

Lunch Suggestions (12:30-2:15pm)

8 options in two areas – eat near the end of the River Tour, or head straight towards the Strand ready for Six at 4pm.

4 near the River Tour end (Tower Bridge / St Katharine Docks, 5-8 min walk):

The Dickens Inn ///client.regime.thanks

Historic 18th-century dockside pub - Tavern Bar downstairs, Poplars restaurant with balcony views upstairs

Marble Quay, St Katharine's Way, London E1W 1UH

□ Mon-Tue 12pm-10pm, Wed 12pm-11pm, Thu-Fri 10am-11pm, Sat 10am-11:30pm, Sun 10am-10pm

□ 020 7488 2208

Map

Reviews

Coppa Club Tower Bridge [///search.teams.herds](https://search.teams.herds)

Riverside terrace and iconic igloos with Tower Bridge views - all-day dining, brunch and lunch bowls

3 Three Quays Walk, Lower Thames Street, London EC3R 6AH

☐ **Mon-Thu 9am-11pm, Fri-Sat 9am-12am, Sun 9am-10pm**

☐ **020 8016 9227**

Map

Reviews

Honest Burgers St Katharine Docks [///tracks.salt.toward](https://tracks.salt.toward)

British smashed-beef burgers and rosemary salted chips, right on the marina

1 Commodity Quay, London E1W 1AZ

☐ **Mon-Tue 11am-10pm, Wed-Sat 11am-11pm, Sun 11am-10pm**

☐ **020 4542 0590**

Map

Reviews

The Hung, Drawn & Quartered [///anyway.ledge.look](https://anyway.ledge.look)

Fuller's pub on the corner of Great Tower Street, right by the Tower - classic pub food, cask ale, full bar

26-27 Great Tower Street, London EC3R 5AQ

☐ **Mon-Fri 11am-11pm, Sat 12pm-10pm, Sun 12pm-6pm**

☐ **020 7626 6123**

Map

Reviews

4 nearer the Strand (handy walk to Vaudeville Theatre for Six):

The Coal Hole [///object.cups.gates](https://object.cups.gates)

Historic Nicholson's pub - once the Savoy's coal cellar, now classic pub food, pies and real ale

91-92 Strand, London WC2R 0DW

☐ **Sun-Wed 10am-11pm, Thu 10am-11:30pm, Fri-Sat 10am-12am**

☐ **020 7379 9883**

Map

Reviews

The Harp ///mild.knee.echo

Award-winning Fuller's ale house - traditional ciders and perries, no food kitchen but a classic pre-theatre pint

47 Chandos Place, Covent Garden, London WC2N 4HS

☐ **Mon-Sat 11am-11pm, Sun 12pm-8pm**

☐ **020 7836 0291**

Map

Reviews

Dishoom Covent Garden ///holds.weedy.sand

Bombay-style cafe - all-day breakfast, bacon naan rolls, biryani; expect a queue at peak times

12 Upper St Martin's Lane, London WC2H 9FB

☐ **Mon-Thu 8am-11pm, Fri 8am-12am, Sat 9am-12am, Sun 9am-11pm**

☐ **020 7420 9320**

Map

Reviews

Hawksmoor Seven Dials ///puns.drip.acting

British steakhouse - Sunday roasts, steaks and a well-regarded weekend brunch

11 Langley Street, London WC2H 9JG

☐ **Mon-Thu 12pm-3pm & 5pm-10:30pm, Fri-Sat 12pm-3pm & 5pm-11pm, Sun 12pm-9:30pm**

☐ **020 7420 9390**

Map

Reviews

After Hard Rock: Nightcap Options

Estimates only – check live transit apps on the day.

4 bars near Hard Rock Cafe:

Rivoli Bar at The Ritz **///jazz.choice.factories**

Art Deco hotel cocktail bar - Ritz signature serves, entered via the main lobby

150 Piccadilly, London W1J 9BR

📏 From Hard Rock: ~15 min walking

📏 To The Melia: ~25 min - walk to Green Park, Piccadilly/Victoria line to Oxford Circus, change to Bakerloo, then ~5 min walk

Map

TripAdvisor

The Connaught Bar **///tamed.zooms.pest**

World-famous cocktail bar - a Mayfair institution, book ahead

Carlos Pl, Mayfair, London W1K 2AL

📏 From Hard Rock: ~12 min walking

📏 To The Melia: ~25 min - walk to Bond Street, Central line to Oxford Circus, change to Bakerloo, then ~5 min walk

Map

TripAdvisor

Dukes Bar **///less.candy.award**

Legendary martini bar (since 1908) - birthplace of the 'Vesper' martini style

35 St James's Pl, London SW1A 1NY

📏 From Hard Rock: ~15 min walking

📏 To The Melia: ~30 min - walk to Green Park, Piccadilly line to Piccadilly Circus, change to Bakerloo, then ~5 min walk

Map

TripAdvisor

Blue Bar at The Berkeley **///flame.fears.retail**

Sophisticated hotel cocktail bar in Knightsbridge, David Collins-designed interior

Wilton Pl, Knightsbridge, London SW1X 7RL

📏 From Hard Rock: ~26 min walking

📏 To The Melia: ~30 min - walk to Hyde Park Corner, Piccadilly line to Piccadilly Circus, change to Bakerloo, then ~5 min walk

Map

TripAdvisor

4 bars near The Melia:

The Lucky Pig

Speakeasy-style basement cocktail bar, just off Great Portland Street

5 Clipstone St, London W1W 6BB

▢ From The Melia: ~6 min walking

▢ To Hard Rock: ~25 min - Bakerloo line from Regent's Park/Great Portland Street to Piccadilly Circus, change to Piccadilly line to Hyde Park Corner, then ~5 min walk

Map

TripAdvisor

The George, Fitzrovia

///moss.fend.agrees

Grade II listed 18th-century corner pub with an ornate Italianate facade

55 Great Portland St, London W1W 7LQ

▢ From The Melia: ~5 min walking

▢ To Hard Rock: ~25 min - Bakerloo line from Regent's Park/Great Portland Street to Piccadilly Circus, change to Piccadilly line to Hyde Park Corner, then ~5 min walk

Map

TripAdvisor

Artesian at The Langham

///nights.truly.squad

Multi-award-winning hotel cocktail bar - voted World's Best Bar for years running

1c Portland Pl, London W1B 1JA

▢ From The Melia: ~13 min walking

▢ To Hard Rock: ~20 min - Bakerloo line from Regent's Park/Great Portland Street to Piccadilly Circus, change to Piccadilly line to Hyde Park Corner, then ~5 min walk

Map

Website

Menu

TripAdvisor

The Social

Long-running Fitzrovia bar and music venue, intimate upstairs bar plus basement gigs/DJ sets

5 Little Portland St, London W1W 7JD

▢ From The Melia: ~9 min walking

▢ To Hard Rock: ~25 min - Bakerloo line from Regent's Park/Great Portland Street to Piccadilly Circus, change to Piccadilly line to Hyde Park Corner, then ~5 min walk

Map

Website

TripAdvisor

□ **Staying at The Level at Melia White House - Longford Street, Regents Park, London NW1 3UP (+44 20 7391 3000 · melia.white.house@melia.com)**

Saturday 26 Sept - Today's Places & Suggested Routes



The Level at Melia White House

Start of day - Longford Street, Regents Park

The Level at Melia White House → Tower of London

~30-35 min · ~5.7 km · Circle line: Great Portland Street to Tower Hill



Tower of London

9:00am - Tower of London, London EC3N 4AB - Tower of London Tour

Tower of London → Tower Bridge Quay

~5-8 min · ~0.5 km · Walk from the Tower of London to Tower Bridge Quay, St Katharine's Way



Tower Bridge Quay

10:45am - St Katharine's Way, London E1W 1LD - River Tour

Tower Bridge Quay → Vaudeville Theatre, Strand

~20-25 min · ~3.0 km · Walk to Tower Hill, Circle/District line to Embankment, then ~5 min walk up the Strand



Vaudeville Theatre, Strand

3:00pm - Six the Musical

Vaudeville Theatre, Strand → Waterstones Piccadilly

~12-15 min · ~1.1 km · Walk via Trafalgar Square/Haymarket, or Covent Garden to Piccadilly Circus (1 stop, Piccadilly line) + short walk



Waterstones Piccadilly

5:30pm

Waterstones Piccadilly → Hard Rock Cafe London, Old Park Lane

~12-15 min · ~1.3 km · Walk along Piccadilly towards Hyde Park Corner, or Piccadilly Circus to Hyde Park Corner (1 stop, Piccadilly line) + short walk



Hard Rock Cafe London, Old Park Lane

6:45pm - Dinner

Hard Rock Cafe London, Old Park Lane → The Level at Melia White House

~20-25 min · ~3.4 km · Piccadilly line: Hyde Park Corner to Piccadilly Circus, change to Bakerloo line to Regent's Park, then ~5 min walk



The Level at Melia White House

Return for the night

Schematic order of the day - not to scale. Times/distances/routes are estimates; check live transit apps on the day.

Sunday 27th September (Day 18)

AIR TRAVEL - DEPART LHR (T5) 10.00PM

📌 FUN FACTS

When Heathrow first opened to passengers in 1946, the "terminal" was literally a row of ex-military tents along the Bath Road, furnished with floral armchairs, small tables of fresh flowers and even a branch of WH Smith – 63,000 passengers passed through in its first year. — [Business Traveller](#)

The Castle pub in Farringdon (today's Option 1 lunch) is the only pub in London licensed as a pawnbroker - supposedly granted personally by King George IV after he pawned his watch there to settle a gambling debt. — [Wikipedia](#)

Heathrow, where you'll fly out from tonight, handles more international passengers than any other airport on Earth - despite operating from just two runways, making it one of the busiest dual-runway airports in the world. — [Heathrow Airport](#)

📌 Sites within 20m

📌 Shops within 20m

8:00 AM - Breakfast at The Level
8:30 AM

7:00 PM Leave for Airport

10:00 PM Depart London Heathrow (T5) at 10.00pm - BA15 (British Airways) LHR (T5) to SIN (T1) PE, then BA15 SIN (T1) to SYD (T1) PE
Heathrow Airport, Hounslow TW6 1EW

Option 1: Lunch at The Castle or The Sir John Oldcastle, Farringdon

Two pub options right by Farringdon station – a laid-back lunch stop before heading to the airport.

Getting there: Great Portland Street → Farringdon on the Metropolitan/Circle/Hammersmith & City line, direct (no change), ~6 min journey, then ~2-3 min walk from Farringdon station to either pub.

The Castle ///range.return.colleague

Grade II listed pub & restaurant, est. 1865 – British pub food, craft beer, full bar, only pawnbroker's licence in London

34-35 Cowcross St, Farringdon, London EC1M 6DB

📌 Sun 12pm-10:30pm (check ahead for any Sept 2026 changes)

📌 +44 20 7553 7621

Website

Menu

Map

I

The Sir John Oldcastle [///twin.milk.hurry](https://twin.milk.hurry)

JD Wetherspoon pub, named after the historical figure said to have inspired Shakespeare's Falstaff – British pub food, full bar, right next to Farringdon station

29-35 Farringdon Rd, Farringdon, London EC1M 3JF

☐ **Sun 8am-11:30pm (check ahead for any Sept 2026 changes)**

☐ **020 7242 1013**

[Website](#)[Map](#)[TripAdvisor](#)

Things to Consider - London

Day	Item	Status	Notes
Sat (26)	Tower of London + Crown Jewels + River Tour (combo)	BOOKED	Headout booking #33605663 (Crown Jewels, 9:00 AM) + #33605662 (River Tour, 10:45 AM), 4 adults - Gary has tickets on app on phone
Sat (26)	Six the Musical tickets	BOOKED	Vaudeville Theatre, 4:00pm (1hr 15min), Stalls G8-G11 (4 adults) - Headout booking #32832547, purchased by Gary Nicholson
Sat (26)	Book dinner reservation - Hard Rock Cafe London TO DO	TO BOOK	150 Old Park Lane, Mayfair, London W1K 1QZ - cafe.hardrock.com/london - after the Six show (ends 5:15pm)
Sun (27)	Confirm transfer to airport TO DO	TO CONFIRM	Leaving hotel 7:00pm for 10:00pm LHR departure

Within 20 Minutes of the Melia on foot

20 things to do within roughly a 20-minute walk of The Level at Meliá White House, Longford Street. Walk times are estimates – check live maps nearer the time.

The Regent's Park

Royal park right across the road - gardens, boating lake, rose garden (~1-2 min walk)

Chester Rd, London NW1 4NR

☎ 0300 061 2300

Map

London Zoo

World-famous zoo, inside Regent's Park (~15 min walk)

Outer Circle, Regent's Park, London NW1 4RY

☎ 0344 225 1826

Map

Regent's Park Open Air Theatre

Outdoor theatre - plays, concerts, events, seasonal (~15 min walk)

Inner Circle, Regent's Park, London NW1 4NU

☎ 0333 400 3562

Map

Sherlock Holmes Museum

Recreated Victorian rooms at the famous '221B' address (~10 min walk)

221b Baker St, London NW1 6XE

☎ 020 7224 3688

Map

Madame Tussauds London

Waxworks - celebrities, royals, film characters (~10 min walk)

Marylebone Rd, London NW1 5LR

☎ 0207 487 0350

Map

Baker Street

Iconic street, tube station, shops and cafes (~9 min walk)

Baker St, London NW1

Map

Marylebone High Street

Boutique shops, cafes and Daunt Books' famous store (~14 min walk)

Marylebone High St, London W1U

Map

The Wallace Collection

Free national museum - art, armour and furniture (~16 min walk)

Hertford House, Manchester Square, London W1U 3BN

☎ 020 7563 9500

Map

BBC Broadcasting House

Iconic Art Deco home of the BBC (~9 min walk)

Portland Pl, London W1A 1AA

☎ 0370 010 0222

Map

All Souls Church, Langham Place

Nash's striking circular church next to the BBC (~9 min walk)

2 All Souls Pl, London W1B 3DA

☎ 020 7580 3522

Map

RIBA (Royal Institute of British Architects)

Free exhibitions, cafe and bookshop (~8 min walk)

66 Portland Pl, London W1B 1AD

☎ +44 (0)20 7307 5355

Map

Great Portland Street shops & cafes

Right outside the hotel - cafes, restaurants, shops (~1-2 min walk)

Great Portland St, London W1W

Map

Charlotte Street, Fitzrovia

Buzzy strip of restaurants and bars (~15 min walk)

Charlotte St, London W1T

Map

Regent's Canal towpath

Scenic canal walk along the edge of Regent's Park (~12 min walk)

Regent's Canal, London NW1

Map

Euston Square & UCL area

University quarter with green squares (~10 min walk)

Euston Square Gardens, London NW1 2EF

Map

Wellcome Collection

Free museum exploring medicine, art and science (~10 min walk)

183 Euston Rd, London NW1 2BE

☎ 020 7611 2222

Map

London Central Mosque

Striking gold-domed mosque on the edge of Regent's Park (~14 min walk)

146 Park Rd, London NW8 7RG

☎ 020 7725 2152

Map

Cumberland Terrace

One of Regent's Park's grandest Nash terraces (~12 min walk)

Cumberland Terrace, London NW1 4HE

Map

Oxford Circus & top of Oxford Street

Flagship shopping - Regent Street meets Oxford Street (~17 min walk)

Oxford Circus, London W1B

Map

Primrose Hill

Park hill with panoramic skyline views over London (~19 min walk)

Primrose Hill, London NW1 4NR

Map

20 Shops to See in London

A top-20 pick of iconic London shops, department stores and markets – not all are near the hotel, so check travel time before heading out.

Harrods

Flagship luxury department store, iconic since 1834

87-135 Brompton Rd, Knightsbridge, London SW1X 7XL

☐ **Mon-Sat 10am-9pm, Sun 11:30am-6pm**

☐ **+44 (0)20 7730 1234**

Map

Selfridges

Legendary Oxford Street department store

400 Oxford St, London W1A 1AB

☐ **Mon-Fri 10am-10pm, Sat 10am-9pm, Sun 11:30am-6pm**

☐ **020 7160 6222**

Map

Liberty London

Tudor-revival department store, famous for its prints

Great Marlborough St, London W1B 5AH

☐ **Mon-Sat 10am-8pm, Sun 12pm-6pm**

☐ **020 7734 1234**

Map

Fortnum & Mason

Royal grocer since 1707 - hampers, tea, food halls

181 Piccadilly, London W1A 1ER

☐ **Mon-Sat 10am-8pm, Sun 11:30am-6pm**

☐ **020 7734 8040**

Map

Hamleys

World's oldest and largest toy shop

188-196 Regent St, London W1B 5BT

☐ **Mon-Sat 10am-9pm, Sun 12pm-6pm**

☐ **0371 704 1977**

[Map](#)

John Lewis Oxford Street

Flagship department store

300 Oxford St, London W1C 1DX

☐ **Mon-Wed & Fri-Sat 9:30am-8pm, Thu 9:30am-9pm, Sun 12pm-6pm**

☐ **0345 608 0677**

[Map](#)

Daunt Books Marylebone

Beautiful Edwardian travel bookshop

83 Marylebone High St, London W1U 4QW

☐ **Mon-Sat 9am-7:30pm, Sun 11am-6pm**

☐ **020 7224 2295**

[Map](#)

Waterstones Piccadilly

Europe's largest bookshop

203-206 Piccadilly, London W1J 9HD

☐ **Mon-Sat 9am-10pm, Sun 12pm-6:30pm**

☐ **020 7851 2400**

[Map](#)

Burlington Arcade

Historic covered luxury shopping arcade

51 Piccadilly, London W1J 0QJ

☐ **Mon-Sat 8am-8pm, Sun 11am-6pm**

☐ **020 7493 1764**

[Map](#)

Regent Street

Iconic curved shopping street, flagship stores

Regent St, London W1B

☐ **Varies by store (most 10am-7/8pm, Sun 12pm-6pm)**

☐ **Varies by store**

[Map](#)

Camden Market

Alternative fashion, crafts and street food stalls

Camden Lock Pl, London NW1 8AF

☐ **Daily 10am-6pm (some stalls/evenings vary)**

☐ **020 3763 9999**

[Map](#)

Portobello Road Market

Antiques, vintage and fashion market

Portobello Rd, London W11 1LJ

☐ **Mon-Sat approx. 8am-7pm (Sat is main trading day)**

☐ **020 7727 7684**

[Map](#)

Borough Market

Historic food market

8 Southwark St, London SE1 1TL

☐ **Mon-Fri 10am-5pm (limited), Sat 8am-5pm, Sun 10am-3pm**

☐ **020 7407 1002**

Map

Covent Garden Market

Boutiques, crafts market, street performers

The Piazza, Covent Garden, London WC2E 8RF

☐ **Mon-Fri 10am-8pm, Sat 9am-8pm, Sun 12pm-6pm**

☐ **020 7395 3765**

Map

New Bond Street

Luxury flagship boutiques - Chanel, Tiffany & more

New Bond St, London W1S

☐ **Varies by store (most 10am-6/7pm, Sun 12pm-6pm)**

☐ **Varies by store**

Map

Foyles Charing Cross Road

Famous independent bookshop

107 Charing Cross Rd, London WC2H 0DT

☐ **Mon-Sat 9:30am-9pm, Sun 11:30am-6pm**

☐ **020 7437 5660**

Map

M&M's World

Multi-storey confectionery flagship store

1 Swiss Ct, London W1D 6AP

☐ **Mon-Sat 10am-9pm, Sun 12pm-6pm**

☐ **020 7025 7171**

[Map](#)

LEGO Store Leicester Square

Flagship LEGO store

3 Swiss Ct, London W1D 6AP

☐ **Mon-Sat 10am-10pm, Sun 12pm-6pm**

☐ **020 7839 3480**

[Map](#)

Apple Store Regent Street

Flagship Apple store in a historic building

235 Regent St, London W1B 2EL

☐ **Mon-Fri 10am-9pm, Sat 10am-8pm, Sun 10am-6pm**

☐ **020 7153 9000**

[Map](#)

Primark Oxford Street

World's largest Primark store

14-28 Oxford St, Fitzrovia, London W1D 1AU

☐ **Mon-Sat 8am-10pm, Sun 11:30am-6pm**

☐ **020 7580 5510**

[Map](#)

20 Shops within 15 Minutes of Piccadilly Circus

20 shops, arcades and shopping streets all within roughly a 15-minute walk of Piccadilly Circus tube station. Walk times are estimates – check live maps nearer the time.

Fortnum & Mason

Royal grocer since 1707 - hampers, tea, food halls (~2 min walk)

181 Piccadilly, London W1A 1ER

☐ **Mon-Sat 10am-8pm, Sun 11:30am-6pm**

☐ **020 7734 8040**

[Map](#)

Hatchards

UK's oldest bookshop (est. 1797), five floors, right next to Fortnum's (~2 min walk)

187 Piccadilly, London W1J 9LE

☐ **Mon-Sat 9:30am-8pm, Sun 10:30am-6pm**

[Website](#)

[Map](#)

Waterstones Piccadilly

Europe's largest bookshop (~3 min walk)

203-206 Piccadilly, London W1J 9HD

☐ **Mon-Sat 9am-10pm, Sun 12pm-6:30pm**

☐ **020 7851 2400**

[Map](#)

Burlington Arcade

Historic 1819 covered luxury shopping arcade with uniformed Beadles (~4 min walk)

51 Piccadilly, London W1J 0QJ

☐ **Mon-Sat 8am-8pm, Sun 11am-6pm**

☐ **020 7493 1764**

[Map](#)

Penhaligon's

British perfumer established 1870, inside Burlington Arcade (~4 min walk)

16-17 Burlington Arcade, London W1J 0PL

☐ **Check ahead - hours vary**

☐ **020 7629 1416**

[Website](#)

[Map](#)

Prince's Arcade

Victorian shopping arcade linking Piccadilly to Jermyn Street (~4 min walk)

8-10 Prince's Arcade, Piccadilly, London SW1Y 6DS

☐ **Varies by store**

[Map](#)

Lillywhites

Flagship five-floor sports store, oldest in the UK (est. 1863), right on Piccadilly Circus (~1 min walk)

24-36 Regent St, London SW1Y 4QF

☐ **Mon-Sat 9:30am-10pm, Sun 12pm-6pm**

☐ **0844 332 5602**

[Website](#)

[Map](#)

Hamleys

World's oldest and largest toy shop (~7 min walk)

188-196 Regent St, London W1B 5BT

☐ **Mon-Sat 10am-9pm, Sun 12pm-6pm**

☐ **0371 704 1977**

[Map](#)

Apple Store Regent Street

Flagship Apple store in a historic building (~9 min walk)

235 Regent St, London W1B 2EL

☐ **Mon-Fri 10am-9pm, Sat 10am-8pm, Sun 10am-6pm**

☐ **020 7153 9000**

[Map](#)

Liberty London

Tudor-revival department store, famous for its prints (~8 min walk)

Great Marlborough St, London W1B 5AH

☐ **Mon-Sat 10am-8pm, Sun 12pm-6pm**

☐ **020 7734 1234**

[Map](#)

Regent Street

Iconic curved shopping street, flagship stores end to end (~1-9 min walk)

Regent St, London W1B

☐ **Varies by store (most 10am-7/8pm, Sun 12pm-6pm)**

[Map](#)

Carnaby Street

Swinging-60s fashion street, now independent boutiques and big brands (~8 min walk)

Carnaby St, London W1F

☐ **Varies by store (most 10am-7pm, Sun 12-6pm)**

[Website](#)

[Map](#)

Jermyn Street

London's shirtmaking street - Turnbull & Asser and other historic tailors (~5 min walk)

71-72 Jermyn St, London SW1Y 6PF

☐ **Mon-Fri 9am-6pm, Sat 9:30am-6pm (closed Sun)**

☐ **020 7808 3000**

[Website](#)

[Map](#)

Savile Row

The world-famous bespoke tailoring street (~10 min walk)

32 Old Burlington St / 17 Clifford St, London W1S

☐ **Mon-Fri 8:30am-5pm (haberdashery also open Sat 10:30am-4pm)**

[Website](#)

[Map](#)

M&M's World

Multi-storey confectionery flagship store, Leicester Square (~6 min walk)

1 Swiss Ct, London W1D 6AP

☐ **Mon-Sat 10am-9pm, Sun 12pm-6pm**

☐ **020 7025 7171**

[Map](#)

LEGO Store Leicester Square

Flagship LEGO store (~6 min walk)

3 Swiss Ct, London W1D 6AP

☐ **Mon-Sat 10am-10pm, Sun 12pm-6pm**

☐ **020 7839 3480**

[Map](#)

Foyles Charing Cross Road

Famous independent bookshop, five floors (~9 min walk)

107 Charing Cross Rd, London WC2H 0DT

☐ **Mon-Sat 9:30am-9pm, Sun 11:30am-6pm**

☐ **020 7437 5660**

[Map](#)

Covent Garden Market

Boutiques, craft market, street performers (~10 min walk)

The Piazza, Covent Garden, London WC2E 8RF

☐ **Mon-Fri 10am-8pm, Sat 9am-8pm, Sun 12pm-6pm**

☐ **020 7395 3765**

[Map](#)

New Bond Street

Luxury flagship boutiques - Chanel, Tiffany & more (~10 min walk)

New Bond St, London W1S

☐ **Varies by store (most 10am-6/7pm, Sun 12pm-6pm)**

[Map](#)

St James's Market

Small modern food-and-shopping precinct behind Waterstones (~4 min walk)

St James's Market, London SW1Y 4AH

☐ **Varies by outlet**

Map

20 Things to Do within 15 Minutes of Piccadilly Circus

20 sights, galleries, parks and landmarks all within roughly a 15-minute walk of Piccadilly Circus tube station. Walk times are estimates – check live maps nearer the time.

Piccadilly Circus & the Shaftesbury Memorial (Eros)

///tidy.loyal.public

The famous statue and video-screen hub itself - starting point for everything below

Piccadilly Circus, London W1J

Map

St James's Church Piccadilly

Wren-designed church (1684) with a leafy courtyard and craft/antiques market most days

197 Piccadilly, London W1J 9LL

Website

Map

Royal Academy of Arts

Major art exhibitions inside historic Burlington House - free courtyard and permanent collection displays

Burlington House, Piccadilly, London W1J 0BD

☐ **Tue-Thu & Sun 10am-6pm, Fri-Sat 10am-9pm (closed Mon)**

☐ **020 7300 8090**

Website

Map

Leicester Square

Cinemas, half-price theatre ticket booth (TKTS) and street entertainers

Leicester Square, London WC2H 7NA

[Map](#)

Chinatown London

Pagoda gates, dim sum and Chinese bakeries around Gerrard Street

Gerrard St, London W1D 5PW

[Map](#)

Soho Square

Small leafy square in the heart of Soho, good for a sit-down break

Soho Square, London W1D 3QP

[Map](#)

Trafalgar Square

Nelson's Column, the four bronze lions and the famous fourth plinth artwork

Trafalgar Square, London WC2N 5DN

[Map](#)

National Gallery

World-class collection of Western European paintings - free entry to the permanent collection

Trafalgar Square, London WC2N 5DN

🕒 **Daily 10am-6pm, Fri until 9pm**

[Website](#)

[Map](#)

National Portrait Gallery

Portraits of famous Britons through history - free entry to the permanent collection

St Martin's Place, London WC2H 0HE

🕒 **Daily 10:30am-6pm, Fri-Sat until 9pm**

[Website](#)

[Map](#)

St James's Park

One of London's prettiest royal parks - lake, pelicans, views to Buckingham Palace

St James's Park, London SW1A 2BJ

[Map](#)

Green Park

Quiet, tree-lined royal park between Piccadilly and Buckingham Palace

Green Park, London SW1A 1BW

[Map](#)

The Ritz London

Legendary 1906 hotel - iconic Louis XVI-style facade, famous afternoon tea (book well ahead)

150 Piccadilly, London W1J 9BR

[Website](#)

[Map](#)

Spencer House

Princess Diana's ancestral family home - 18th-century state rooms, open select days

27 St James's Place, London SW1A 1NR

[Website](#)

[Map](#)

Christie's

World-famous auction house - free public viewing rooms before major sales

8 King St, St James's, London SW1Y 6QT

[Website](#)

[Map](#)

Handel & Hendrix House

Composer Handel's Georgian home next door to where Jimi Hendrix once lived - small museum

25 Brook St, London W1K 4HB

☐ **Wed-Sun 10am-5pm (closed Mon-Tue)**

☐ **020 7495 1685**

[Website](#)

[Map](#)

The Photographers' Gallery

London's leading photography gallery - free exhibitions on the ground floor

16-18 Ramillies St, London W1F 7LW

☐ **Mon-Wed & Sat 10:30am-6pm, Thu-Fri 10:30am-8pm, Sun 11am-6pm**

[Website](#)

[Map](#)

Covent Garden Piazza

Street performers, market stalls and the Royal Opera House

The Piazza, Covent Garden, London WC2E 8RF

[Map](#)

Shaftesbury Avenue Theatreland

London's main theatre strip - Lyric, Apollo, Gielgud, Queen's and more, all in a row

Shaftesbury Ave, London W1D

[Map](#)

Waterloo Place & Duke of York Column

Grand statue-lined avenue with steps down toward The Mall and St James's Park

Waterloo Place, London SW1Y 5AY

[Map](#)

Berkeley Square

Mayfair's grand garden square, lined with plane trees - of 'nightingale sang' fame

Berkeley Square, London W1J 6BR

[Map](#)

Cars Baby Cars

Supercar and luxury-marque showrooms clustered around Berkeley Square, Mayfair – all within roughly a 15-minute walk of Piccadilly Circus.

Rolls-Royce Motor Cars London

Flagship Rolls-Royce showroom on the corner of Berkeley Street and Stratton Street (~10 min walk)

50 Berkeley St, London W1J 8HD

[Website](#)[Map](#)

Jack Barclay Bentley

London's oldest Bentley dealership (since 1927), on Berkeley Square (~10 min walk)

18 Berkeley Square, London W1J 6AE

[Website](#)[Map](#)

H.R. Owen Ferrari Mayfair

Official Ferrari flagship showroom, Berkeley Square (~10 min walk)

15-17 Berkeley Square, London W1J 6EG

[Website](#)[Map](#)

Lamborghini Mayfair

H.R. Owen flagship Lamborghini showroom, Berkeley Square (~10 min walk)

20 Berkeley Square, London W1J 6BR

[Website](#)[Map](#)

Volvo Cars Central London

Official Volvo showroom and service centre, Swiss Cottage (a drive/tube ride, not walkable)

1 Northways Parade, Finchley Rd, London NW3 5EN

[Website](#)[Map](#)

Mercedes-Benz of Chelsea

Official Mercedes-Benz showroom on Wandsworth Bridge (a drive/tube ride, not walkable)

Jews Row, Wandsworth, London SW18 1TB

[Website](#)[Map](#)

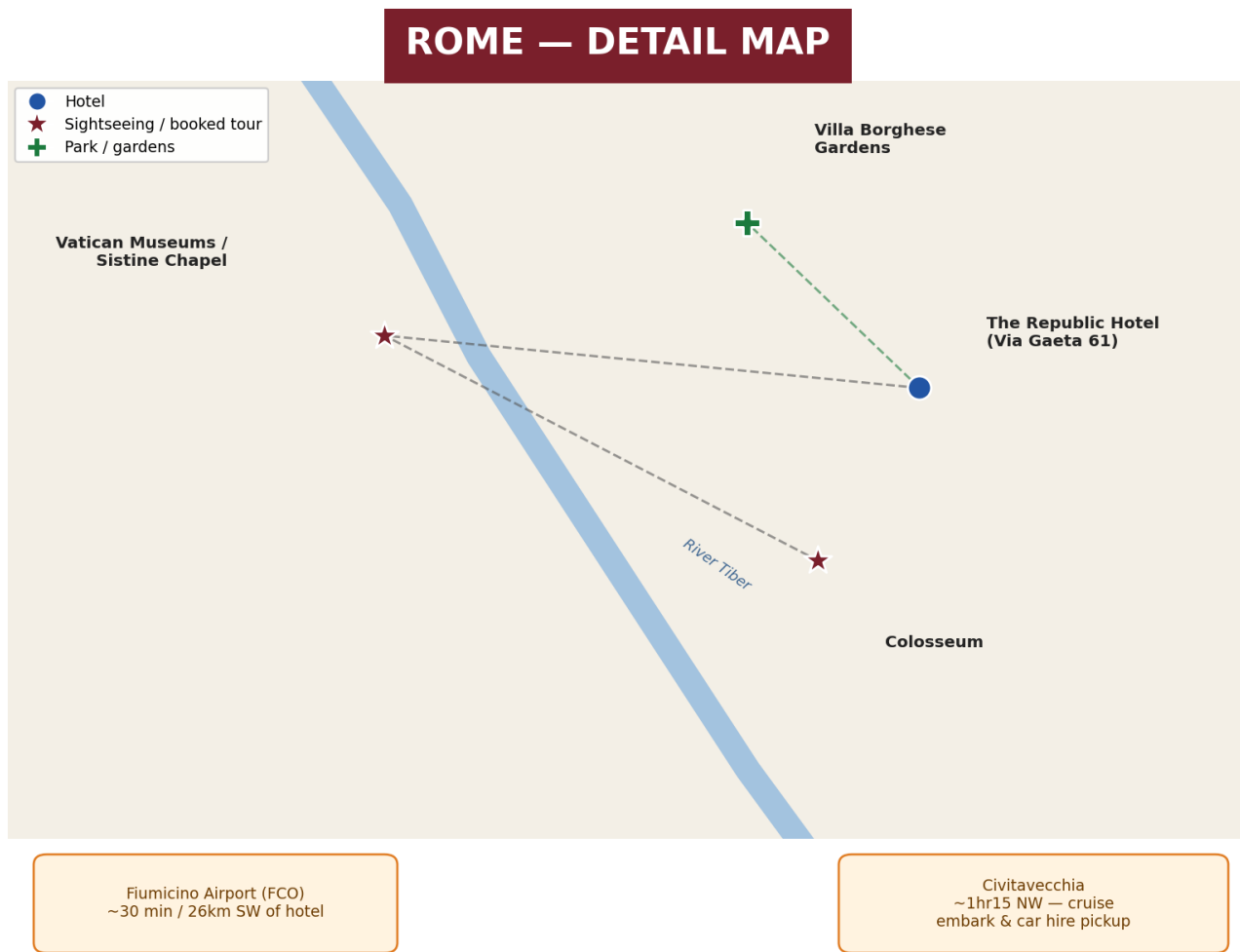
Rolls-Royce, Bentley, Ferrari and Lamborghini are all genuinely walkable from Piccadilly Circus around Berkeley Square, Mayfair. Volvo and Mercedes-Benz are London dealerships but sit further out (Swiss Cottage and Wandsworth) - worth a taxi/tube rather than a walk. Zeekr doesn't have a UK showroom yet - its London launch is expected later in 2026.

Places & Maps

Schematic maps and place lists from the itinerary, with website and review links.

'I' buttons link to that place's official Instagram page.

Rome



Schematic map (not to scale / not live map tiles) — for trip planning reference only

Schematic map – approximate positions, not to scale

The Republic Hotel

Hotel (11-14 Sep)

Via Gaeta 61, 185 Rome

Map

Fiumicino Airport (FCO)

Airport - arrival

Fiumicino Airport, Rome

Map

I

Vatican Museums / Sistine Chapel

Sightseeing - booked (Sat 12 Sep, 7:45am, ~3hrs, Towns of Italy, Ref 5CJM745M)

Vatican Museums, Vatican City

Map

I

Villa Borghese Gardens

Sightseeing (Fri 11 Sep, 3-5pm)

Villa Borghese, Rome, Italy

Map

Colosseum

Sightseeing - booked (Sun 13 Sep, 2:30pm, ~3hrs, Roman Forum & Palatine Hill, Gray Line Rome, Booking ID 202645831)

Piazza del Colosseo, 1, 00184 Roma RM, Italy

Map

I

Civitavecchia

Cruise embark / car hire (Mon 14 & Mon 21 Sep)

Via 16 Settembre 46, Civitavecchia

Map

Cantina Cantarini da Mario

Restaurant candidate - veal scaloppine al limone (Tripadvisor 3.9/5)

Piazza Sallustio 24, 00187 Roma

[Menu](#)[Map](#)[Reviews](#)[I](#)

Girarrosto Fiorentino

Restaurant candidate - veal specialities (Google 4.4/5)

Via Sicilia 46, 00187 Roma

[Menu](#)[Map](#)[Reviews](#)[I](#)

Colline Emiliane

Restaurant candidate - veal specialities (Tripadvisor 4.5/5)

Via degli Avignonesi 22, 00187 Roma

[Menu](#)[Map](#)[Reviews](#)[I](#)

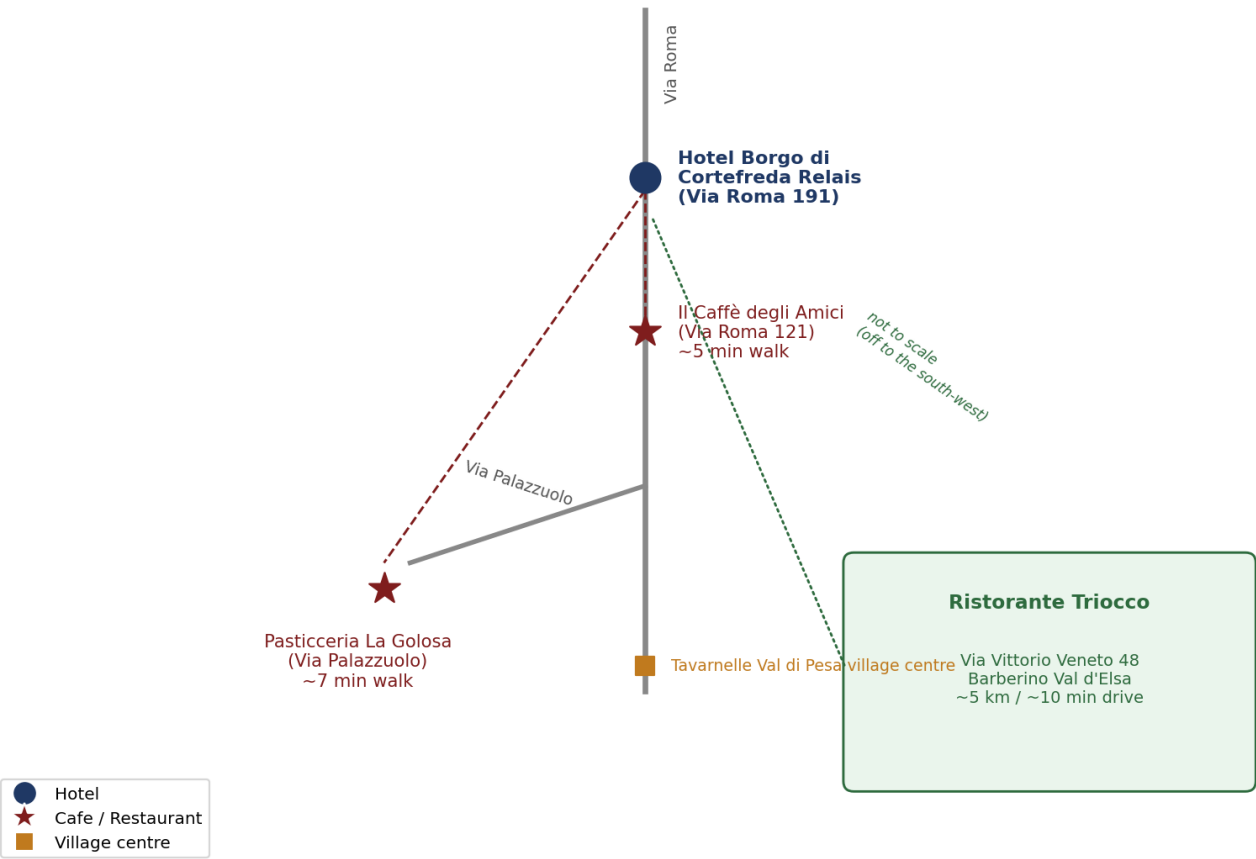
Trattoria Monti

Restaurant candidate - classic Marche/Roman cuisine (top ~4% of Rome restaurants)

Via di San Vito 13/a, 00185 Roma

[Menu](#)[Map](#)[Reviews](#)

Tavarnelle Val di Pesa — Hotel Area



Schematic map – approximate positions, not to scale

Hotel Borgo di Cortefreda Relais

Hotel (14-16 Sep)

Via Roma 191, 50028, Tavarnelle Val Di Pesa

Map I

Il Caffè degli Amici

Cafe/restaurant - potential place to go (Tripadvisor 4.7/5, 562 reviews)

Via Roma 121, 50028 Tavarnelle Val di Pesa

Menu Map Reviews I

Pasticceria La Golosa

Pastry shop/cafe - potential place to go (Tripadvisor 4.4/5, 31 reviews)

Via Palazzuolo, 50028 Tavarnelle Val di Pesa

[Map](#)[Reviews](#)

Ristorante Triocco

Dinner option - potential place to go (Tripadvisor 4.6/5, 334 reviews, #2 of 20 in Barberino Val d'Elsa)

Via Vittorio Veneto 48, 50021 Barberino Val d'Elsa, Barberino Tavarnelle

[Menu](#)[Map](#)[Reviews](#)[I](#)

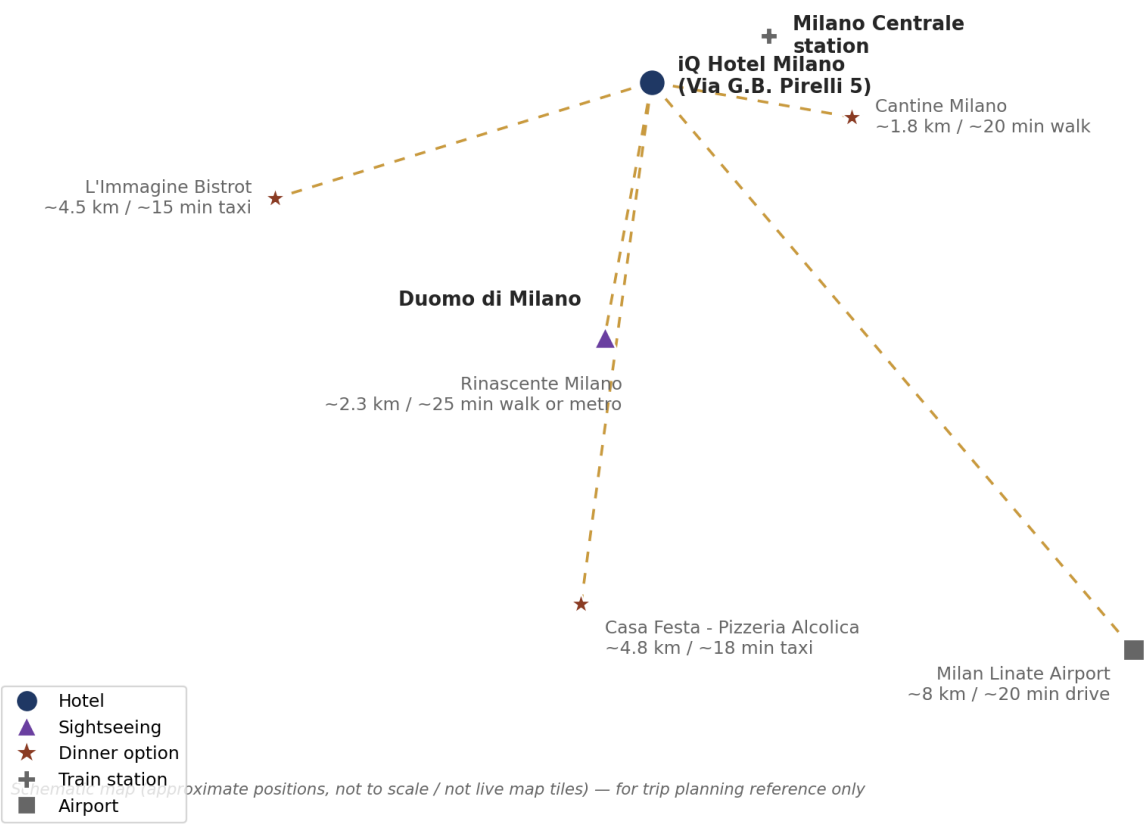
Agriturismo Buratta

Lunch option - potential stop en route from Civitavecchia (Tripadvisor 4.0/5, 832 reviews, #1 of 19 in Talamone)

Strada Vicinale delle Casacce, 65, 58010 Talamone, Orbetello

[Menu](#)[Map](#)[Reviews](#)

Milan — Detail Map



Schematic map – approximate positions, not to scale

iQ Hotel Milano

Hotel

Via Giovanni Battista Pirelli, 5, 20124 Milan

Map

I

Milan Linate Airport

Airport (car return)

Milan Linate Airport

Map

I

Rinascente Milano

Department store / Shopping

Piazza del Duomo, 20121 Milan

Map

I

Fornasetti (flagship store)

Potential shop - official Fornasetti flagship, iconic Italian design house (~3.5 km / ~45 min walk from hotel, or ~10-15 min by taxi/metro)

Via Senato 2, 20121 Milan (near Corso Venezia)

🕒 10:00am-7:30pm (confirm exact days, especially Sundays)

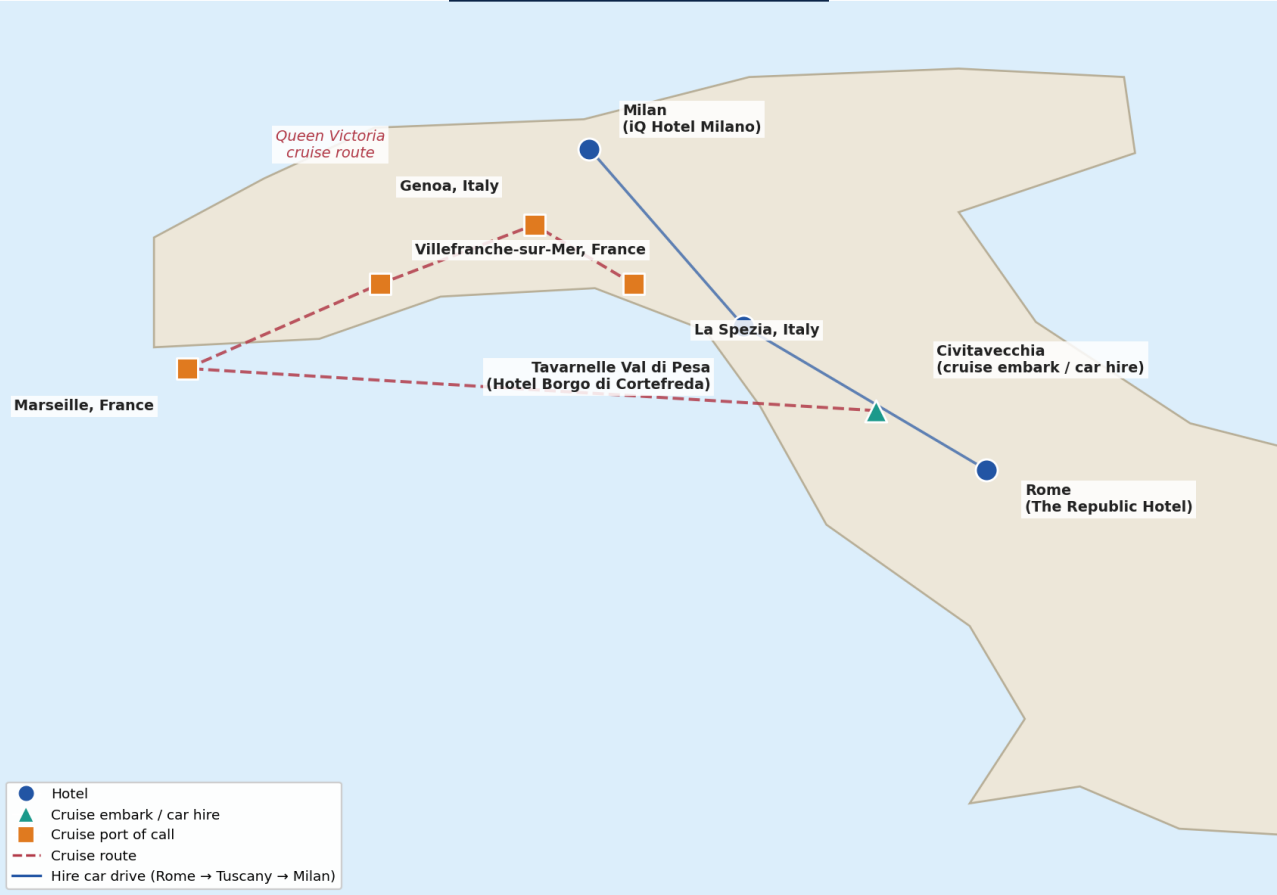
Website

Map

I

Italy Overview (cruise ports & drive route)

ITALY — TRIP MAP



Schematic map (approximate positions, not to scale / not live map tiles) — for trip planning reference only

Schematic map – approximate positions, not to scale

The Republic Hotel

Hotel

Via Gaeta 61, 185 Rome

Map

Civitavecchia (cruise embark / car hire)

Port / Car hire

Via 16 Settembre 46, Civitavecchia

Map

Hotel Borgo di Cortefreda Relais

Hotel

Via Roma 191, 50028, Tavarnelle Val Di Pesa

Map

I

Marseille, France

Cruise port of call

Marseille, France

Map

I

Villefranche-sur-Mer, France

Cruise port of call

Villefranche-sur-Mer, France

Map

I

Genoa, Italy

Cruise port of call

Genoa, Italy

Map

I

La Spezia, Italy

Cruise port of call

La Spezia, Italy

Map

I

Il Caffè degli Amici

Cafe/restaurant - potential place to go (Tripadvisor 4.7/5, 562 reviews)

Via Roma 121, 50028 Tavarnelle Val di Pesa

Menu

Map

I

Pasticceria La Golosa

Pastry shop/cafe - potential place to go (Tripadvisor 4.4/5, 31 reviews)

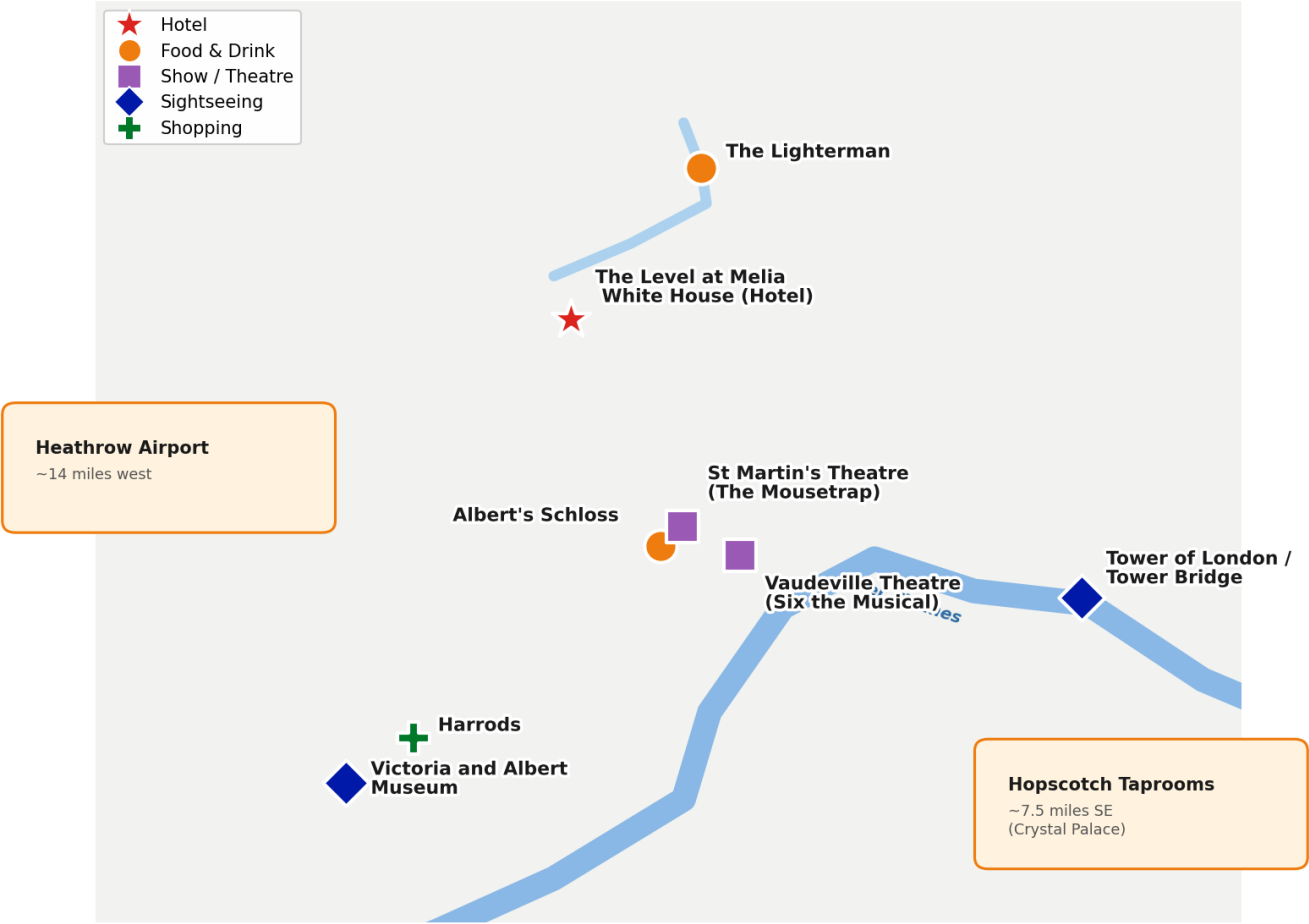
Via Palazzuolo, 50028 Tavarnelle Val di Pesa

Map

London

LONDON — TRIP MAP

Central London



Schematic diagram (not to scale, in the style of a transit map) - use the Google Maps links in the sheet for turn-by-turn directions.

Schematic map - approximate positions, not to scale

The Level at Melia White House

Hotel - approx. 2-3 min walk (~0.2 km) to Great Portland Street Underground station (Circle, Hammersmith & City, Metropolitan lines), directly opposite the hotel

Longford Street, Regents Park, London NW1 3UP

[Website](#)[Map](#)[I](#)

Heathrow Airport

Travel / Airport

Heathrow Airport, Hounslow TW6 1EW

☎ 0344 335 1801

[Map](#)[I](#)

Albert's Schloss

Food & Drink

20-24 Shaftesbury Avenue, London W1D 7EU

☎ 020 8165 0000

✉ eventslondon@albertsschloss.co.uk

[Menu](#)[Map](#)[Reviews](#)[I](#)

The Lighterman

Food & Drink

3 Granary Square, London N1C 4BH

☎ 020 3846 3400

[Menu](#)[Map](#)[Reviews](#)[I](#)

St Martin's Theatre (The Mousetrap)

Show / Theatre

West Street, London WC2H 9NZ

☎ 020 7836 1443

[Map](#)

Vaudeville Theatre (Six the Musical)

Show / Theatre

404 Strand, London WC2R 0NH

☎ 0330 333 4814

✉ boxoffice@nimaxtheatres.com

Map

I

Tower of London / Tower Bridge

Sightseeing

Tower of London, EC3N 4AB

☎ 020 3166 6646

Map

Reviews

I

Hopscotch Taprooms

Food & Drink

54 Westow Hill, London SE19 1RX

☎ +44 7394 072189

Website

Menu

Map

I

Harrods

Shopping

87-135 Brompton Road, Knightsbridge, London SW1X 7XL

☎ +44 (0)20 7730 1234

Map

I

Victoria and Albert Museum

Sightseeing

Cromwell Road, London SW7 2RL

☎ 020 7942 2000

Map

I

Harry's Knightsbridge

Food & Drink

27-31 Basil Street, Knightsbridge, London SW3 1BB

☎ +44 20 3940 1020

Website

Menu

Map

Reviews

Primark (Oxford Street)

Shopping

14-28 Oxford Street, Fitzrovia, London W1D 1AU

☎ 020 7580 5510

Map

I

Uniqlo (Oxford Street)

Shopping

311 Oxford Street, London W1C 2HP

Map

I

Waterstones Piccadilly (for Karen)

Shopping - Books

203-206 Piccadilly, London W1J 9HD

☎ 020 7851 2400

Map

I

Oxford Street

Shopping street

Oxford Street, London W1

Website

Map

I

ZTL / Limited Traffic Zones (Italy)

You asked about "LTZ" areas – in Italy these are officially called ZTL (Zona a Traffico Limitato), or Limited Traffic Zones. Every historic Italian city centre has one, and they're the single easiest way to rack up fines while self-driving.

A ZTL is a camera-enforced zone – usually the old walled/historic centre – where only residents, permit holders and registered vehicles may drive during posted hours. Drive through the wrong gate and a camera reads the plate; the fine (typically €80–335, sometimes one per gate crossed) goes to the hire company, who forwards it to us plus their own admin fee – and it can turn up months after we're home. Watch for the sign: a white circle with a red border reading "Zona Traffico Limitato".

ITALY — ZTL / LIMITED TRAFFIC ZONES



- Major city with ZTL / congestion zone (Milan, Rome)
- Town with a ZTL zone (Como, Venice, Bologna, Modena, Florence, Siena)
- Smaller ZTL / no-cars-at-all zone (Maranello, San Gimignano)
- ▲ Our Tuscany hotel, Tavarnelle Val di Pesa (for reference)

Schematic map - approximate positions, not to scale - see city notes below for hours and relevance to our route

Schematic map - approximate positions, not to scale

Rome (Centro Storico)

□ Italy's most famous ZTL - not on our drive route

Daytime hours Mon-Fri, with extended evening ZTL in some nightlife sectors on weekends - camera-enforced across the historic centre.

□ We don't collect the hire car until Civitavecchia, so this one's FYI only - but it's the zone every guide warns about first, and worth knowing about generally.

Milan - Area C

☐ Congestion charge + ZTL ring around the Duomo

Mon-Fri 7:30am-7:30pm, about €7.50/entry (higher on weekends), camera-enforced seven days a week from 2026.

☐ *The iQ Hotel Milano (Via Pirelli) sits just outside the Area C ring, so arriving/leaving the hotel should be fine - it only becomes a problem if we drive in towards the Duomo.*

Como & Cernobbio (Option A)

☐ Como old town ZTL - enforced daily, 9am-10pm

Covers the walled Città Murata, Piazza Duomo and Via Vittorio Emanuele II. The Cernobbio/Tremezzo lakeside road (SS340) itself is open, but narrow and often busy.

☐ *Best to park in a signed lot outside the old town (e.g. Autosilo Valduce) rather than drive in for Harry's Bar/the lakefront.*

Bologna (Option B breakfast stop)

☐ ZTL Centro Storico - every day, 7am-8pm

Camera-enforced ("Sirio" system) across the historic centre; a few streets are pedestrian-only around the clock.

☐ *Our Option B breakfast stop, Aroma Specialty Coffee on Via Portanova, sits inside this zone - better to park just outside and walk the last few minutes than drive to the door.*

Modena & Maranello (Option B)

☐ Modena's old town ZTL is effectively permit-holders-only

Modena's historic centre is restricted for most of the day; Maranello itself has no formal ZTL, but very heavy paid parking near the Ferrari Museum.

☐ *Best to follow the signed ring road/tangenziale around Modena rather than cut through its centre on the way to Maranello.*

Florence

☐ ZTL - 5 sectors, Mon-Fri 7:30am-8pm, Sat 7:30am-4pm

Free to drive Sundays and public holidays. Covers Piazza del Duomo, Piazza della Signoria and most of the historic core.

☐ *Not on our base route, but easy to stumble into if we detour into central Florence for a look.*

Siena

□ **Historic centre is effectively car-free**

The whole medieval core sits inside a strict ZTL – park in one of the signed "parcheggio scambiatore" lots outside the walls and walk in.

□ *Relevant if we make the short detour south from our hotel to see the Palio square (Piazza del Campo).*

San Gimignano

□ **No visitor cars inside the walls, ever (Apr-Oct)**

Five paid car parks (P1-P5) sit just outside the medieval gates – it's a walk up from there, whichever one we use.

□ *The 'medieval Manhattan' towers from our Day 12 Fun Facts – a natural detour from our Tuscany hotel, so worth knowing before we drive up.*

Venice (Option C)

□ **No cars at all in the historic centre - more a total ban than a ZTL**

The car has to be left on the mainland at Tronchetto or Piazzale Roma car parks; the centre itself is reached on foot or by vaporetto (water bus).

□ *Already flagged on our Option C route notes – the most extreme version of a 'limited traffic zone' in Italy.*

General rule of thumb: park in a signed paid car park outside the old walls/centre and walk in, rather than following the satnav to the door – it's almost always faster than dealing with a fine later.

Things to Do

Everything still to book or confirm, pulled together from across the itinerary.

Date	Item	Status	Notes	Booked?	Links
------	------	--------	-------	---------	-------

Sat 12 Sep

Book Vatican Necropolis
(Scavi Tour) - Tomb of St
Peter

///

searched.circling.supposed

TO BOOK

Guided
tour
beneath
St Peter's
Basilica
ending at
the tomb
believed
to hold St
Peter's
remains -
must be
booked
well in
advance
(small
groups,
no photos
allowed).
Slotted
into
Saturday
afternoon
(after the
Vatican
Museums/
Sistine
Chapel
tour and
lunch) as
one of
the free-
afternoon
options.

**Book
ahead -
popular,
limited
daily
slots.**



Visit

Rev

Sun 27 Sep

Confirm transfer to airport

TO
CONFIRM

Leaving
hotel
7:00pm
for
10:00pm
LHR
departure



Visit

Things to Take

Packing checklist. Tick boxes save in this browser only — they don't sync back to the spreadsheet, so keep the master list on the Things to Do tab in the workbook up to date separately.

Item	Packed?
Euro Power Adapter	☐
Passports with 6 months left	☐
Check on VPN support	☐
Hats for us all (for tours)	☐
Water (for tours)	☐
DJI Gimbal (Gary)	☐
Get some Pounds and some Euro's for OOPE	☐

☐ UK ETA Applications - tick off once each person has applied

Apply here: gov.uk/eta/apply - each of the 4 of us needs our own UK ETA before flying to London. Tick boxes save in this browser only.

Name	Applied?
Karen Nicholson	☐
Deb Gyde	☐
Thomas Akhurst	☐
Gary Nicholson	☐

☐ Passport Validity Check - tick off once each passport is confirmed valid

Passports need at least 6 months' validity remaining AT THE END of the trip (29 Sept 2026) - so valid until at least 29 March 2027. Tick boxes save in this browser only.

Name	Checked?
Karen Nicholson	☐
Deb Gyde	☐
Thomas Akhurst	☐
Gary Nicholson	☐

Deb & Tom's To-Do

A separate checklist just for Deb & Tom – kept apart from the main Things to Do list so it's easy to find.

Emergency Contacts

Still blank – please add at least one emergency contact each before we leave (see the matching boxes in the main Emergency Contacts section).

Deb Gyde & Thomas Akhurst

Person 1 - (add name)

Person 2 - (add name)

Person 3 - (add name)

Person 4 - (add name)

i Also worth saving: the G&K travel insurance 24/7 emergency line – Chubb Assistance, **+64 9 374 1775** (see the Travel Cover PDF in Travel Documents for full details).

International Driving Permit (IDP)

Whoever's driving in Italy needs a valid IDP alongside their normal licence. Tick boxes save in this browser only.

Name	Have IDP?	IDP Number
Deb Gyde	☐	



Still to Confirm

Open items from the main Things to Do list that affect the whole group, including Deb & Tom.

Date	Item	Status	Notes	Booked?	Links
Sat 12 Sep	Book Vatican Necropolis (Scavi Tour) - Tomb of St Peter /// searched.circling.supposed	TO BOOK	Guided tour beneath St Peter's Basilica ending at the tomb believed to hold St Peter's remains - must be booked well in advance (small groups, no photos allowed). Slotted into Saturday afternoon (after the Vatican Museums/ Sistine Chapel tour and lunch) as one of the free-afternoon options. Book ahead - popular, limited daily slots.	☐	Visit Rev

Sun 27 Sep

Confirm transfer to airport

TO
CONFIRM

Leaving
hotel
7:00pm
for
10:00pm
LHR
departure



Visit

Hotel Addresses

Every hotel on the trip, with address, phone and email – use Print for a paper copy or a browser "Save as PDF", or Email to send yourself/family a copy.

The Republic Hotel

Via Gaeta 61, 00185 Rome, Italy

☐ **11-14 Sept 2026 (check-out morning of the 14th for Civitavecchia/cruise embarkation)**

☐ **+39 06 8115 7001**

✉ **therepublic@aghotels.it**

☐ **Booking ref - Gary & Karen: 5179180 · Deb & Tom: 5179179**

€ **Mandatory fee:** City tourist tax – €7.50 per person, per night (up to 10 nights), payable directly to the hotel



Hotel Borgo di Cortefreda Relais

Via Roma 191, 50028 Tavarnelle Val di Pesa (FI), Italy

☐ **21-23 Sept 2026 (check-out morning of the 23rd for the drive to Milan)**

☐ **+39 055 807 3333**

✉ **info@borgodicortefreda.com**

☐ **Booking ref - Gary & Karen: 900422765 (hotel conf. 45873846) · Deb & Tom: 900422785 (hotel conf. 45873847)**

€ **Mandatory fee:** City tourist tax – €3.00 per person, per night (up to 7 nights), payable directly to the hotel



iQ Hotel Milano

Via Giovanni Battista Pirelli 5, 20124 Milan, Italy

☐ **23-24 Sept 2026 (check-out morning of the 24th for the flight to London)**

☐ **+39 02 8498 0810**

✉ **info@iqhotelmilano.it**

☐ **Booking ref - Gary & Karen: 9079750869671 (conf. 2385198897) · Deb & Tom: 9074737872483 (conf. 2385198904)**

€ **Mandatory fee:** City tourist tax – €10.00 per person, per night, payable directly to the hotel



The Level at Melia White House

Longford Street, Regent's Park, London NW1 3UP, United Kingdom

☐ **24-27 Sept 2026 (depart Heathrow the night of the 27th)**

☐ **+44 20 7391 3000**

✉ **melia.white.house@melia.com**

☐ **Great Portland Street station (Circle, Hammersmith & City, Metropolitan lines) - approx. 2-3 min walk (~0.2 km), directly opposite the hotel**

☐ **Booking ref - Gary & Karen: 702Lb92xxk · Deb & Tom: 702Hpxuze6**



Daily Quiz

A 5-question multi-choice quiz for every day of the trip, themed to wherever we are that day – Rome history, cruise trivia, French Riviera, Tuscany, London and more. Browse the questions below any time, or print two separate documents: one with just the questions, one with the answer key.

Questions

Day 2 · Fri 11 Sep · Rome Arrival

1. Which river runs through the middle of Rome?

A) The Po B) The Tiber C) The Arno D) The Danube

2. Rome is famously said to be built on how many hills?

A) Five B) Six C) Seven D) Nine

3. What is the name of the independent city-state entirely enclosed within Rome?

A) San Marino B) Monaco C) Vatican City D) Andorra

4. Which ancient structure is also known by its Latin name, the Amphitheatrum Flavium?

A) The Pantheon B) The Colosseum C) The Circus Maximus D) The Roman Forum

5. Legend says Rome was founded by twin brothers raised by a wolf. What were their names?

A) Castor and Pollux B) Romulus and Remus C) Brutus and Cassius D) Titus and Vespasian

Day 3 · Sat 12 Sep · Vatican & Sistine Chapel

1. Who painted the ceiling of the Sistine Chapel?

A) Leonardo da Vinci B) Raphael C) Michelangelo D) Botticelli

2. Roughly how long did it take Michelangelo to paint the Sistine Chapel ceiling?

A) About 1 year B) About 4 years C) About 10 years D) About 20 years

3. What is the name of Michelangelo's huge fresco on the Sistine Chapel's altar wall, painted decades after the ceiling?

A) The Creation of Adam B) The Last Supper C) The Last Judgment D) The School of Athens

4. What is the world's smallest country by area, which we're visiting today?

A) Monaco B) Vatican City C) San Marino D) Liechtenstein

5. What is the name of the huge square in front of St Peter's Basilica, ringed by Bernini's colonnades?

A) Piazza Navona B) Piazza del Popolo C) St Peter's Square D) Piazza di Spagna

Day 4 · Sun 13 Sep · Colosseum

1. In roughly what year did construction of the Colosseum finish?

A) 80 AD B) 200 AD C) 30 BC D) 500 AD

2. Roughly how many spectators could the Colosseum hold?

A) 5,000 B) 15,000 C) 50,000-80,000 D) 200,000

3. What was the underground network of tunnels and animal cages beneath the arena floor called?

A) The Catacombs B) The Hypogeum C) The Forum D) The Atrium

4. Which Roman emperor commissioned the Colosseum?

A) Nero B) Augustus C) Vespasian D) Julius Caesar

5. What stone makes up most of the Colosseum's outer structure?

A) Marble B) Travertine limestone C) Granite D) Brick only

Day 5 · Mon 14 Sep · Rome to the Cruise

1. What is the name of the ship we're boarding today?

A) Queen Mary 2 B) Queen Elizabeth C) Queen Victoria D) Queen Anne

2. Which shipping line operates Queen Victoria?

A) Cunard B) P&O C) Princess Cruises D) Royal Caribbean

3. Which Cunard liner sank after being torpedoed in 1915, helping draw the US into WWI?

A) Titanic B) Lusitania C) Britannic D) Mauretania

4. What year was the Cunard Line founded?

A) 1740 B) 1840 C) 1900 D) 1950

5. Which Italian port are we sailing from today?

A) Naples B) Genoa C) Civitavecchia D) Livorno

Day 6 · Tue 15 Sep · Sea Day

1. The Mediterranean Sea connects to the Atlantic Ocean via which strait?

A) Strait of Messina B) Strait of Gibraltar C) The Bosphorus D) Strait of Otranto

2. Which is the largest island in the Mediterranean?

A) Corsica B) Cyprus C) Sicily D) Sardinia

3. Approximately how deep is the Mediterranean's deepest point, the Calypso Deep?

A) About 500m B) About 2,000m C) About 5,200m D) About 10,000m

4. Which sea connects to the Mediterranean via the Dardanelles and Bosphorus straits?

A) The Red Sea B) The Black Sea C) The Caspian Sea D) The Adriatic Sea

5. What unit is traditionally used to measure a ship's speed at sea?

A) Miles per hour B) Knots C) Fathoms per hour D) Leagues per hour

Day 7 · Wed 16 Sep · Marseille, France

1. Marseille is France's ___ largest city.

A) Largest B) Second-largest C) Third-largest D) Fifth-largest

2. Marseille was founded by settlers from which ancient civilisation, around 600 BC?

A) Romans B) Phoenicians C) Greeks (Phocaeans) D) Etruscans

3. What is France's national anthem called, named after soldiers from Marseille who sang it marching to Paris in 1792?

A) La Vie en Rose B) La Marseillaise C) Non, Je Ne Regrette Rien D) Frère Jacques

4. What is the traditional Provençal fish stew Marseille is famous for?

A) Ratatouille B) Bouillabaisse C) Cassoulet D) Coq au vin

5. What is the fortified hilltop basilica overlooking Marseille's harbour called?

A) Notre-Dame de la Garde B) Sacré-Cœur C) Notre-Dame de Paris D) Sainte-Chapelle

Day 8 · Thu 17 Sep · Villefranche & Monaco

1. Monaco is the second-smallest country in the world. Which is the smallest?

A) San Marino B) Vatican City C) Liechtenstein D) Malta

2. Which royal family has ruled Monaco for over 700 years?

A) The Windsors B) The Grimaldis C) The Bourbons D) The Habsburgs

3. What famous annual motor race runs through the streets of Monaco?

A) Le Mans 24 Hours B) Monaco Grand Prix C) Dakar Rally D) Tour de France

4. Which Hollywood actress became Princess of Monaco in 1956, marrying Prince Rainier III?

A) Audrey Hepburn B) Grace Kelly C) Ingrid Bergman D) Elizabeth Taylor

5. Monaco residents famously pay no what?

A) Council rates B) Income tax C) Road tolls D) Import duty

Day 9 · Fri 18 Sep · Genoa, Italy

- 1. Which explorer, credited with reaching the Americas in 1492, was born in Genoa?**
A) Marco Polo B) Amerigo Vespucci C) Christopher Columbus D) Ferdinand Magellan
- 2. Genoa is the capital of which Italian region?**
A) Tuscany B) Liguria C) Piedmont D) Lombardy
- 3. Which world-famous basil sauce originated in Genoa?**
A) Marinara B) Pesto C) Alfredo D) Arrabbiata
- 4. Genoa's historic centre is often ranked among Europe's largest what?**
A) Medieval castles B) Medieval old towns C) Cathedrals D) Palace complexes
- 5. In the Middle Ages, Genoa was a powerful maritime republic rivalling which other Italian sea power?**
A) Naples B) Venice C) Palermo D) Bari

Day 10 · Sat 19 Sep · La Spezia & Pisa

- 1. The Leaning Tower of Pisa started leaning almost immediately, mainly because of what?**
A) An earthquake B) Soft, unstable ground C) A design flaw in the bells D) War damage
- 2. How many storeys does the Leaning Tower of Pisa have?**
A) 4 B) 6 C) 8 D) 12
- 3. What type of building is the Leaning Tower actually part of?**
A) A city hall B) A cathedral bell tower (campanile) C) A fortress D) A university
- 4. Which scientist, born in Pisa, is said (probably as legend) to have dropped balls from the tower to study gravity?**
A) Leonardo da Vinci B) Galileo Galilei C) Copernicus D) Archimedes
- 5. La Spezia sits at the gateway to which colourful stretch of Ligurian coastline, famous for five cliffside villages?**
A) Amalfi Coast B) Cinque Terre C) Costa Smeralda D) Riviera di Levante

Day 11 · Sun 20 Sep · Sea Day

1. **Which is traditionally considered the longest river in the world?**

A) Amazon B) Nile C) Yangtze D) Mississippi

2. **Which is the largest ocean on Earth?**

A) Atlantic B) Indian C) Arctic D) Pacific

3. **Which country has the most time zones?**

A) Russia B) USA C) France D) China

4. **What is the smallest continent by land area?**

A) Europe B) Australia/Oceania C) Antarctica D) South America

5. **Which mountain range forms part of the traditional boundary between Europe and Asia?**

A) The Alps B) The Urals C) The Pyrenees D) The Carpathians

Day 12 · Mon 21 Sep · Tuscany (Talamone & Chianti)

1. **What colour is the rooster on the seal of authentic Chianti Classico wine?**

A) Red B) White C) Black D) Gold

2. **Which grape variety is Chianti primarily made from?**

A) Nebbiolo B) Sangiovese C) Barbera D) Montepulciano

3. **In Dante's Divine Comedy, which section mockingly mentions Talamone, the port we're passing through today?**

A) Inferno B) Purgatorio C) Paradiso D) It isn't mentioned

4. **Tuscany's capital and the birthplace of the Renaissance is which city?**

A) Siena B) Pisa C) Florence D) Lucca

5. **What is the name for the low stone farmhouse-style accommodation common across the Tuscan countryside?**

A) Villa B) Agriturismo C) Palazzo D) Trattoria

Day 13 · Tue 22 Sep · Tuscany Free Day

1. **San Gimignano, near our hotel, is famous for its skyline of medieval what?**
A) Windmills B) Towers C) Bridges D) Domes
2. **How many of San Gimignano's original ~72 medieval towers still survive today?**
A) About 3 B) About 14 C) About 40 D) All 72
3. **Which Renaissance polymath was born in a small Tuscan town near Florence, sharing his name with it?**
A) Michelangelo Buonarroti B) Leonardo da Vinci C) Sandro Botticelli D) Donatello
4. **The Chianti wine region lies roughly between which two famous Tuscan cities?**
A) Florence and Siena B) Pisa and Lucca C) Florence and Rome D) Siena and Rome
5. **Which powerful banking family ruled Florence and patronised the Renaissance for generations?**
A) The Borgias B) The Medici C) The Sforza D) The Visconti

Day 14 · Wed 23 Sep · Milan (Options Day)

1. **Roughly how long did Milan's Duomo take to complete, from start to its final touches?**
A) About 10 years B) About 50 years C) Nearly 6 centuries D) 100 years
2. **Leonardo da Vinci's mural The Last Supper is housed in which Milan building?**
A) Milan Cathedral B) Santa Maria delle Grazie C) La Scala D) Castello Sforzesco
3. **Milan is considered, alongside Paris, one of the world capitals of which industry?**
A) Finance B) Fashion C) Film D) Publishing
4. **What is the name of Milan's world-famous opera house?**
A) La Fenice B) La Scala C) San Carlo D) Teatro Massimo
5. **If we take the Como option today, whose famous villa on Lake Como's shore might we spot?**
A) Elton John's B) George Clooney's C) Tom Cruise's D) Ed Sheeran's

Day 15 · Thu 24 Sep · London Arrival

1. What is the name of the river that flows through London?

A) The Severn B) The Thames C) The Avon D) The Mersey

2. Approximately how long is the River Thames?

A) 50 miles B) 100 miles C) 215 miles D) 400 miles

3. What is London's famous clock tower usually called, after the bell inside it?

A) Big Ben B) The Shard C) The Gherkin D) The Elizabeth Tower

4. Which London Underground line is coloured dark blue on the Tube map?

A) Circle line B) Piccadilly line C) Victoria line D) Central line

5. What is the collective name for London's famous red double-decker vehicles?

A) Trams B) Buses C) Tuk-tuks D) Trolleys

Day 16 · Fri 25 Sep · London (The Mousetrap)

1. The Mousetrap, which we're seeing tonight, is the world's longest-running what?

A) Musical B) Play C) Opera D) Ballet

2. Who wrote The Mousetrap?

A) Agatha Christie B) Arthur Conan Doyle C) Noël Coward D) J.B. Priestley

3. Which London theatre district is home to most of the famous long-running shows?

A) Shoreditch B) West End C) Camden D) South Bank

4. The Mousetrap first opened in the West End in which decade?

A) 1930s B) 1950s C) 1970s D) 1990s

5. Traditionally, audiences leaving The Mousetrap are asked to do what?

A) Sign a guestbook B) Keep the ending a secret C) Take a photo with the cast D) Write a review

Day 17 · Sat 26 Sep · London (Tower Bridge & Six)

- 1. How many wives did King Henry VIII have - the subject of tonight's show, Six?**
A) Four B) Five C) Six D) Seven
- 2. Which of his six wives was famously beheaded, and was the second wife?**
A) Catherine of Aragon B) Anne Boleyn C) Jane Seymour D) Catherine Howard
- 3. Tower Bridge, which we visit today, is often confused with which other London bridge?**
A) Millennium Bridge B) London Bridge C) Westminster Bridge D) Blackfriars Bridge
- 4. What famous fortress sits beside Tower Bridge, once used as a royal palace and prison?**
A) Windsor Castle B) The Tower of London C) Buckingham Palace D) Hampton Court
- 5. What valuable items are famously kept and guarded at the Tower of London?**
A) The Crown Jewels B) The original Magna Carta C) The Domesday Book D) Nelson's flagship

Answer Key

Hidden from normal browsing so the quiz stays a surprise – use Print Answers to check your scores.

London Tube Map

The official TfL Tube map, saved here so it's always at hand even offline.

 [CLICK HERE to view the Tube Map \(PDF\)](#)

Fun Facts by Day

Extra fun facts for the places we're seeing each day – on top of the ones shown in each day's Fun Facts box on screen.

Friday 11th September (Day 2)

Tucked inside Villa Borghese is a curious 1867 water clock, invented by the monk-scientist Giovan Battista Embriaco, which still keeps time today using only the flow and pressure of water – no electricity or batteries. — [Turismo Roma](#)

Cardinal Scipione Borghese amassed a private collection of over 800 sculptures and paintings by artists including Caravaggio, Bernini and Titian, which only became the public Galleria Borghese museum after the Italian state bought the estate from the family in 1902. — [Wikipedia](#)

Villa Borghese has a hydraulic 'water clock' (the Pincio Clepsydra) built in 1867-73 that has run continuously ever since, powered only by two seesawing basins of flowing water – it never needs winding. — [Through Eternity Tours](#)

Cardinal Scipione Borghese was such a ruthless art collector that he once had the painter Domenichino thrown in prison until he handed over a painting the cardinal wanted for his gallery. — [RomeHints](#)

Caravaggio's Madonna and Child with St Anne was rejected by St Peter's Basilica because church officials thought the Madonna looked too much like a real woman off the street – Cardinal Scipione Borghese snapped it up for his own collection instead. — [Sightseeing Experience Magazine](#)

The building now known as Casa del Cinema inside the gardens was once a dairy serving cream and custard, before it became a glitzy 1930s restaurant and later a Dolce Vita-era dance club called 'La Lucciola'. — [Turismo Roma](#)

Saturday 12th September (Day 3)

A ten-year restoration of the Sistine Chapel ceiling, completed in 1990 and sponsored by Japan's Nippon Television, stripped away centuries of soot, glue and candle grease to reveal Michelangelo's original vivid colours hidden underneath. — [Wikipedia](#)

Michelangelo became chief architect of St Peter's Basilica in 1547 at the age of 71, but only lived to see the drum of its dome completed; his design was finished by Giacomo della Porta and Domenico Fontana in 1590, 26 years after his death. — [Wikipedia](#)

Michelangelo hated painting the Sistine Chapel ceiling so much he wrote a grumbling poem about it, complaining his stomach was 'squashed under his chin' and that he'd grown a goiter from the strain of looking up for months. — [Dutch Fine Paintings](#)

A later painter named Daniele da Volterra was hired to paint loincloths and drapery over the nude figures in Michelangelo's Last Judgment – earning him the permanent nickname 'Il Braghettone', or 'The Breeches-Maker'. — [Wikipedia](#)

In 1972 a man attacked Michelangelo's Pietà in St Peter's Basilica with a hammer, shouting he was Jesus Christ; the statue was restored and now sits behind bulletproof glass. — [EWTN Vatican](#)

The gold letters running around the base of St Peter's dome look like modest, ordinary lettering from the floor – each one is actually about 7 feet tall, roughly the height of an adult man. — [EWTN Vatican](#)

Sunday 13th September (Day 4)

The Colosseum's opening games in 80 AD reportedly included a naumachia, a staged naval battle, with the arena flooded for small ships – once the underground hypogeum was built under Emperor Domitian, further flooding became impossible and the practice stopped. — [Wikipedia](#)

The amphitheatre wasn't officially called the Colosseum in ancient times – it was the Flavian Amphitheatre – and the popular name actually comes from the Colossus of Nero, a giant bronze statue over 30 metres tall that once stood beside it. — [Wikipedia](#)

Beneath the Colosseum's arena floor was the hypogeum, a maze of tunnels and cages with pulley-operated lifts – gladiators and wild animals could pop up through trapdoors, seemingly out of nowhere, right in front of the crowd. — [Through Eternity Tours](#)

Before the underground hypogeum existed, the Colosseum could be flooded for mock naval battles called naumachiae, with small warships fighting it out in a man-made lake inside the arena. — [National Geographic](#)

In one bizarre event, the arena floor was landscaped like a forest and stocked with deer, boar and ostriches – spectators were handed tickets and let loose to hunt the animals themselves and take the meat home. — [All That's Interesting](#)

The Colosseum we see today is a bare stone skeleton, but in Roman times it was covered in polished marble and bronze details, making it gleam rather than look like a ruin. — [The Colosseum](#)

Monday 14th September (Day 5)

Civitavecchia's harbour fortress, Forte Michelangelo, was designed by the architect Bramante in 1508 and completed in 1537 under the supervision of Michelangelo himself, and it still stands guard over the port today. — [Port of Rome - Civitavecchia](#)

In 1696, Pope Innocent XII declared Civitavecchia a free port, exempting trading ships from certain taxes – a status that helped it grow into Rome's principal seaport. — [Britannica](#)

The French novelist Stendhal – famous for giving his name to 'Stendhal syndrome', the fainting fits caused by overwhelming art – once served as the French consul in Civitavecchia. — [Roma Experience](#)

Civitavecchia's harbour fortress is popularly called 'Fort Michelangelo', but that was never its official name – it was christened Fortress Giulia after Pope Julius II, who commissioned it; Michelangelo is only credited with the top tower. — [Cabinet](#)

In 1972, workers in Civitavecchia found frescoes hidden under layers of lime and wallpaper that turned out to be near-exact copies of Raphael's frescoes from the Vatican's Room of Heliodorus – nobody has ever figured out why they're there. — [Port Mobility Civitavecchia](#)

When Queen Victoria was officially named by the Duchess of Cornwall in 2007, the champagne bottle swung at the bow refused to smash – considered a maritime bad omen – so a backup bottle had to be released to finish the job. — [UPI](#)

Tuesday 15th September (Day 6)

Queen Victoria was christened in Southampton on 10 December 2007 by Camilla, Duchess of Cornwall, and set sail on her maiden voyage to the Canary Islands the very next day. — [Wikipedia](#)

The custom of afternoon tea dates back to the 1840s, credited to Anna, 7th Duchess of Bedford, who began taking tea and a light snack in her rooms to bridge the gap between lunch and dinner – a habit Queen Victoria herself later helped make fashionable. — [British Museum](#)

The roaring lion on the Golden Lion pub's signage traces back to the artwork on the launch programme for the original Queen Elizabeth in 1938 – Cunard's mascot has been guarding the ship's pub ever since. — [Paul's Beer & Travel Blog](#)

The Golden Lion pubs on Cunard ships serve beers brewed exclusively for the line, including an odd one called 'Breakfast' – a biscotti-flavoured stout. — [Paul's Beer & Travel Blog](#)

Tucked among Cunard's white-tie ballrooms and formal dining rooms is a proper English pub complete with a dartboard, karaoke nights and pub quizzes – a deliberately unpretentious contrast to the rest of the ship. — [Cunard](#)

Wednesday 16th September (Day 7)

Marseille's signature bouillabaisse traces back to a simple fisherman's stew the ancient Greeks called kakavia; in 1980 the city's restaurateurs even drew up an official Bouillabaisse Charter defining the authentic recipe and ingredients. — [National Geographic](#)

Marseille's Vieux Port was once spanned by a pioneering transporter bridge, inaugurated in 1905, which carried passengers and vehicles across the harbour entrance on a suspended gondola until German forces destroyed it in 1944. — [Wikipedia](#)

There's a Marseille saying that 'it was the sardine that blocked the port' - a real 1780 incident where a warship called the Sartine ran aground at the harbour mouth got garbled over time into a legend about a giant fish plugging the port. — [Connexion France](#)

Coffee first entered France through Marseille in 1644, and the city opened its first coffeehouse in 1671 - a full year before Paris got one. — [All About Coffee](#)

Thursday 17th September (Day 8)

In 1297, the Grimaldi family seized Monaco's fortress when François Grimaldi disguised himself as a Franciscan monk to sneak armed men inside - the origin of the sword-wielding monk still shown on Monaco's coat of arms today. — [Wikipedia](#)

Prince Rainier III's 1956 marriage to Hollywood actress Grace Kelly at Monaco's Saint Nicholas Cathedral was watched by more than 30 million television viewers worldwide, dubbed the 'wedding of the century'. — [History.com](#)

Monaco has no airport, so getting there means arriving by helicopter, superyacht or train - yet the tiny 2-square-kilometre country still packs in a network of public tunnels, escalators and lifts to move people up and down its cliffside terrain. — [Trafalgar](#)

Monaco's royal couple are both genuine Olympians - Prince Albert II competed in bobsleigh at five consecutive Winter Olympics, while Princess Charlene won swimming medals for South Africa before becoming a princess. — [Trafalgar](#)

Monaco is watched over by more than 560 CCTV cameras and has roughly one police officer for every 60 residents, giving it one of the highest security-personnel densities of any country on Earth. — [Trafalgar](#)

Friday 18th September (Day 9)

The word "jeans" traces back to Genoa itself: French traders called the sturdy cotton fabric woven there for sailors' trousers "bleu de Gênes" (blue of Genoa), later shortened to "jean".

— [Merriam-Webster](#)

From the 11th century until Napoleon dissolved it in 1797, Genoa was the seat of its own maritime superpower, the Republic of Genoa, whose fleets and banks once rivalled Venice's.

— [Wikipedia](#)

Genoa's medieval cathedral, San Lorenzo, still has an unexploded WWII naval shell embedded in its side wall – it crashed through during a 1941 bombardment and simply never went off.

— [Atlas Obscura](#)

Beneath Genoa's streets lies a hidden network of WWII-era escape tunnels and bomb shelters, including a 150-metre passage burrowed under the Doge's Palace. — [myCityHunt](#)

Genoa's harbour lighthouse, La Lanterna, can claim the title of the tallest traditional lighthouse in the world, depending on how you measure it. — [Atlas Obscura](#)

Palazzo San Giorgio, once home to one of the oldest banks in the world, is also where Marco Polo is said to have dictated his famous travel memoirs. — [Atlas Obscura](#)

Saturday 19th September (Day 10)

The tower was already sinking before it even looked crooked: by the time builders reached the second floor in 1178, the soft subsoil beneath its shallow 3-metre foundation had begun to give way, decades before the famous lean became obvious. — [Wikipedia](#)

Legend says Galileo Galilei, who lived in Pisa, dropped two cannonballs of different masses from the tower around 1589-92 to prove they fall at the same speed – but the only source is a biography written by his student decades later, and historians still dispute whether it happened.

— [Wikipedia](#)

The Leaning Tower of Pisa's largest bell weighs around 3,600kg – about the same as a full-grown female African elephant. — [The Fact Site](#)

In 1944, a 23-year-old American sergeant was ordered to check the tower for German snipers before possibly calling in an artillery strike – he couldn't bring himself to destroy something so beautiful, and the tower survived the war. — [The Fact Site](#)

Pisa's famous tilt isn't unique – the bell tower of the nearby Church of St Nicola leans too, thanks to the same soft ground. — [Fact City](#)

The tower's bells haven't rung properly in over 100 years – partly because one of them, the 'Bell of the Traitor', traditionally tolled whenever a criminal was executed. — [Fact City](#)

Sunday 20th September (Day 11)

Queen Victoria was the first Cunard ship to feature West End-style private theatre boxes, in her three-storey Royal Court Theatre – an innovation later copied on sister ship Queen Elizabeth. — [Cunard](#)

Each year, guests and crew aboard Queen Victoria get through around 1.5 million fresh eggs and close to a million cups of tea. — [Cunard](#)

Queen Victoria has the first two-storey library ever built at sea, stocked with around 6,000 books, journals and periodicals. — [Chris Frame's Cunard Page](#)

The ship's Winter Garden has a retractable glass roof that can be opened to the sky – a colonial-style conservatory built right into a working ocean liner. — [Chris Frame's Cunard Page](#)

Queen Victoria's six main suites are each named after a historic Cunard liner – Mauretania, Laconia, Aquitania, Berengaria, Carpathia and Caronia. — [Chris Frame's Cunard Page](#)

Monday 21st September (Day 12)

Talamone's Etruscan temple, built in the 4th century BC to honour the god Tinia, once bore a dramatic terracotta pediment depicting the myth of the "Seven Against Thebes"; the surviving reliefs are now housed in Florence's Archaeological Museum. — [In Vacanza all'Argentario](#)

San Gimignano grew rich on saffron: medieval merchants exported its "red gold" as far as Alexandria and Damietta, and the profits helped fund the stone tower-houses that still define the skyline. — [Visit Tuscany](#)

The 1280 Torre Chigi in San Gimignano has its front door on the first floor – residents climbed a ladder to get in and pulled it up at night so rival families couldn't attack them in their sleep. — [Torciano Magazine](#)

Talamone doubled as a Tuscan hideaway in the James Bond film Quantum of Solace – 007 arrives by boat near the medieval Torre di Talamonaccio on the coast. — [James Bond Lifestyle](#)

Admiral Horatio Nelson dropped anchor off Talamone in June 1798 while hunting for Napoleon's fleet, just weeks before his decisive victory at the Battle of the Nile. — [My Kind of Italy](#)

Tuesday 22nd September (Day 13)

The name "Chianti" first appears in writing as early as 1398, in a notarial document referring to wine from the area – centuries before the modern Chianti Classico appellation existed.

— [Consorzio Vino Chianti Classico](#)

In 1716, Grand Duke Cosimo III de' Medici issued a decree formally defining the boundaries of the Chianti wine-producing zone, making it one of the earliest legally delimited wine regions in the world. — [Consorzio Vino Chianti Classico](#)

Renaissance master Giorgio Vasari painted the black rooster into his 1565 'Allegory of Chianti' ceiling panel in Florence's Palazzo Vecchio, cementing it as the region's symbol centuries before it appeared on a wine label. — [Chianti Classico Consorzio](#)

The Chianti Classico black rooster trademark is so tightly policed that, since 2005, a bottle without the rooster on its label legally isn't allowed to call itself Chianti Classico at all.

— [Chianti Classico Consorzio](#)

Wednesday 23rd September (Day 14)

The golden Madonnina statue atop Milan's Duomo secretly doubles as a giant lightning rod – the metal halberd she holds was engineered to protect the cathedral from lightning strikes.

— [Duomo di Milano](#)

From 1939, Milan's golden Madonnina was covered in grey-green camouflage cloth for five years during the Second World War, so Allied bombers couldn't use her golden glint to pinpoint the city. — [Duomo di Milano](#)

The Galleria's floor mosaics depict four cities of the newly unified Kingdom of Italy as animals – Turin as a bull, Rome as a wolf, Florence as a lily, and Milan as its own red cross.

— [The Art Post Blog](#)

Wednesday 23rd September (Day 14) - Option A - Lake Como & Harry's Bar

The Roman writer Pliny the Younger owned two villas on Lake Como which he nicknamed "Comedy" and "Tragedy" – one perched high with sweeping views, the other so close to the water he claimed he could fish from his bedroom window. — [Wikipedia](#)

Julius Caesar conquered the Como area in 49 BC and resettled it with 5,000 colonists, founding "Novum Comum"; the Romans named the lake itself "Larius", the root of its modern name, Como. — [Lake Como Tours](#)

Villa d'Este in Cernobbio started life in 1568 as a cardinal's summer retreat, later passed through the hands of a ballerina, a Napoleonic general and an exiled queen, and only became a hotel in 1873. — [Historic Hotels of the World](#)

From parts of Cernobbio you genuinely can't tell where Italy ends and Switzerland begins – the town blends into Chiasso just across the invisible border on the forested slopes of Mount Bisbino. — [Lake Como Travel](#)

Harry's Bar in Cernobbio was opened in 1973 by Piero Sacchi, who wanted to bring the American cocktail-bar trend to Lake Como – its decor has barely changed since. — [Harry's Bar Cernobbio](#)

Wednesday 23rd September (Day 14) - Option B - Ferrari Maranello

The Ferrari Museum in Maranello opened on 18 February 1990 – deliberately chosen as the birthday of founder Enzo Ferrari, known as "the Drake", who had died two years earlier in 1988. — [VisitModena](#)

Enzo Ferrari personally test-drove every car his factory produced, but for his own daily journeys he had a soft spot for four-seaters – a preference that ran from the 1960 250 GT 2+2 to the 456 GT he approved in 1988. — [Ferrari.com](#)

The Ferrari Museum's futuristic entrance was designed by Renzo Piano, the same architect behind the Pompidou Centre in Paris – a design flourish for a factory that started out with a modest 1947 gate. — [Ferrari.com](#)

Next to the museum runs the 'Strada della Storia' (History Trail), a red pedestrian path through the park with plaques tracing a decade of Ferrari and Maranello history each. — [Maranello Plus](#)

Visitors to the museum can try a real Formula 1 pit-stop wheel change against the clock – the same task F1 crews do in under 2-3 seconds during a race. — [Ferrari.com Museums](#)

Maranello sits deep in Italy's balsamic vinegar country, and several local tour operators combine a Ferrari Museum visit with a traditional balsamic vinegar tasting tour – supercars and 12-year-aged vinegar, back to back. — [Expedia](#)

Wednesday 23rd September (Day 14) - Option C - Venice

The Republic of Venice was an independent maritime power for more than 1,100 years, from 697 AD until Napoleon deposed the last doge, Ludovico Manin, in 1797.

— [World History Encyclopedia](#)

The enclosed Bridge of Sighs, built around 1600, connects the Doge's Palace interrogation rooms to the old prisons; its name comes from the sighs of condemned prisoners glimpsing their last view of Venice through its stone-barred windows. — [Britannica](#)

Venice's Acqua Alta bookshop keeps its stock safe from flooding canals by storing books inside full-size gondolas, bathtubs and even a rowing boat – when the water rises, the 'shelves' simply float. — [Rosemary and Pork Belly](#)

The city is built on more than 100 small islands, held up by wooden piles driven into the lagoon mud – starved of oxygen, the wood never rotted and instead petrified into something as hard as stone over the centuries. — [Our Escape Clause](#)

Tucked in Venice is the Scala Contarini del Bovolo, a spiralling external staircase so distinctive it gave the noble family who built it the nickname 'Bovolo' – Venetian dialect for 'snail'.

— [Atlas Obscura](#)

Lazzaretto Nuovo, one of Venice's lagoon islands, was used as a plague quarantine station centuries ago and is linked to local legend of the so-called 'Vampire of Venice' – a skeleton found buried with a brick wedged in its jaw. — [Atlas Obscura](#)

Thursday 24th September (Day 15)

Regent's Canal, which runs past The Lighterman, was designed by architect John Nash – the same man behind Regent Street, Regent's Park and Buckingham Palace – and opened to great fanfare in 1820. — [King's Cross](#)

Granary Square, where The Lighterman sits, was once a Victorian canal basin where barges unloaded wheat for London's bakers; today the same spot features over 1,000 individually choreographed fountains. — [King's Cross](#)

In 1874 a barge loaded with gunpowder exploded under Macclesfield Bridge on Regent's Canal, killing four people, destroying the bridge and reportedly terrifying the animals at nearby London Zoo. — [London Museum](#)

The Coal Drops Yard arches near King's Cross weren't always shops and restaurants – in the Victorian era, gangs of famously tough, muscular women worked there unloading up to 30 wagon-loads of glass bottles a day for a bottle merchant. — [King's Cross](#)

Long before its boutique-shop makeover, the grimy Victorian coal-drop arches were home to the nightclub Bagley's, which packed in up to 2,500 clubbers on a Saturday night at the height of London's warehouse rave scene. — [King's Cross](#)

Friday 25th September (Day 16)

The Mousetrap began life as a short BBC radio play called 'Three Blind Mice', which Agatha Christie wrote as an 80th-birthday gift for Queen Mary in 1947, before she expanded it into the stage play in 1952. — [Agatha Christie](#)

The V&A's National Art Library holds more than 750,000 books, photographs and drawings, including works connected to Leonardo da Vinci's notebooks. — [Victoria and Albert Museum](#)

In March 1974 The Mousetrap moved from the Ambassadors Theatre to the St Martin's Theatre next door – and pulled off the entire transfer over a single weekend without missing one single performance. — [Wikipedia](#)

Agatha Christie was so sure The Mousetrap wouldn't last that she predicted it might run eight months. It has now passed 30,000 performances and is still the longest-running show of any kind in the world. — [Wikipedia](#)

The V&A's collection includes an antique French chair reputed to be haunted – visitors and staff have long claimed its cushion mysteriously deflates several times a day, as if someone invisible keeps sitting down. — [Time Out London](#)

Among the V&A's oddest objects is Tippoo's Tiger, a life-size 18th-century wooden automaton of a tiger mauling a British soldier – originally fitted with an organ mechanism that made the soldier's arm flail and produced groaning sounds. — [Time Out London](#)

Saturday 26th September (Day 17)

Hard Rock Cafe's now-famous memorabilia collection began right there in London in 1979, when regular customer Eric Clapton gave the cafe a signed Fender guitar; the venue today also houses 'The Vault', London's only rock-and-roll museum. — [Hard Rock International](#)

Six the Musical's writers modelled each of Henry VIII's wives on a real pop star – Catherine of Aragon channels Beyoncé, Anne Boleyn is Avril Lavigne/Lily Allen, Jane Seymour is Adele, Anne of Cleves is Nicki Minaj/Rihanna, and Katherine Howard is Ariana Grande/Britney Spears. — [BBC Newsbeat](#)

The Tower of London's ravens are technically enlisted members of the armed forces and can be formally 'dismissed' for misconduct – Raven George was sacked in 1986 for destroying television aerials and exiled to a zoo in Wales. — [Wikipedia](#)

Anne Boleyn's now-iconic space buns in Six the Musical weren't scripted – original West End cast member Millie O'Connell simply wore her hair that way at a 2018 preview, the creative team loved it, and it became the character's permanent look. — [Beano](#)

Sunday 27th September (Day 18)

Heathrow handled just 63,000 passengers in its first full year of operation in 1946; by 2025 that figure had grown to a record 84.5 million passengers in a single year. — [Aerospace Global News](#)

The Castle's current building on Cowcross Street, Farringdon, is Grade II listed and dates to 1865, sitting just off historic Smithfield Market in the City of London's square mile. — [CAMRA](#)

Despite terminals numbered 2 through 5, Heathrow has no Terminal 1 in use today - it opened in 1968 and was permanently closed in 2015 after 47 years of service. — [Fact City](#)

If Heathrow's control tower ever went out of action, a secret windowless backup replica of the tower's visual control room, hidden away from the airfield, can take over and keep up to 70% of flights running. — [Surrey Live](#)

Heathrow's Animal Reception Centre processes an extraordinary menagerie every year - around 28,000 fish, 2,000 birds and up to 200,000 reptiles pass through the airport. — [Surrey Live](#)

Nearby Farringdon has an oddly split identity: since 1394 it's been divided into 'Farringdon Within' and 'Farringdon Without', depending on which side of the old Roman London Wall each half fell on. — [London x London](#)

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Travel Documents

Key trip documents, saved here so they're always at hand – open on screen or scan the QR code with your phone.

Travel Docs



Car Docs



ETA Confirmation (Gary)



G&K Travel Insurance



Travel Cover



Six the Musical Booking



QV Deck Plans



☐ International Driving Permit (IDP) Check

Whoever's driving in Italy needs a valid IDP alongside their normal licence. Tick boxes save in this browser only.

Name	Have IDP?	IDP Number
Karen Nicholson	☐	
Deb Gyde	☐	
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